

Selected Topics in Probability Theory

Lecture by J.Č.

Notes by D.F.

Last updated on September 29, 2026

Vorwort

Der nachfolgende Text ist meine Mitschrift zur Vorlesung „Selected Topics in Probability Theory“. Die Notizen sind auf Englisch abgefasst, also in der Sprache der Vorlesung. Die Vorlesung basiert auf folgender Literatur:

- G. Grimmett: Percolation, Springer 2000
- G. Grimmett: Probability on Graphs 2010
- [H. Duminil-Copin: Introduction to percolation theory](#)
- B. Bollobás and O. Riordan: Percolation, CUP 2007
- M. Barlow: Random Walks and Heat Kernels on Graphs, CUP 2017
- A.-S. Sznitman: Topics in occupation times and the Gaussian free field, EMS 2012

Diese Notizen sind weder fertiggestellt noch korrekturgelesen. Insbesondere im mittleren Teil habe ich einfach die handgeschriebenen Notizen des Professors eingefügt. Auch am Ende fehlen noch Vorlesungen.

Die letzte inhaltliche Änderung wurde am 6. Juni 2026 vorgenommen. Der $\text{\LaTeX}$ -Quellcode kann [hier](#) heruntergeladen werden (vorsicht: Code-Qualität ist schlecht und das Projekt ist sehr chaotisch aufgebaut).

Contents

0	Introduction: What this lecture is about	3
1	Bernoulli Percolation	4
1.1	Definition and Basics	4
1.2	Critical probability	8
1.3	Harris-FKG-inequality	11
1.4	BK inequality	13
1.5	Russo's formula	18
1.6	Ergodicity and Mixing	20
2	Uniqueness of infinite clusters	23
2.1	Applications of the uniqueness of infinite clusters	26
3	Subcritical phase	29
4	Random Walks in Random Environment	63
4.1	Reminders about Markov-Chains	63
4.2	Introduction to Random Walks in Random Environment	66
4.3	More Ergodic Theory	72
4.4	Sinai's model: non standard limit laws	78
5	Random Walks on Weighted Graphs	84
5.1	Dirichlet (Energy)-form	87
6	Random walks and electrical resistance	94
6.0.1	Transience, Recurrence and rough isometries	100

0 Introduction: What this lecture is about

[todo: Muss noch abgetippt werden]

1 Bernoulli Percolation

1.1 Definition and Basics

We start with a few reminders from graph theory.

Definition 1.1. A (unoriented) graph is a tuple $\mathcal{G} = (\mathcal{V}, \mathcal{E})$ where $\mathcal{V}$ is the set of *vertices/sites* and $\mathcal{E}$ is the set of *edges/bonds*, i.e.,

$$\mathcal{E} \subseteq \{\{x, y\} \mid x, y \in \mathcal{V}\}.$$

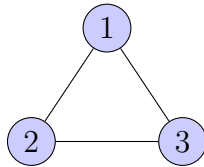
If $e = \{x, y\} \in \mathcal{E}$ is an edge we call x, y *endpoints*. In this case we say that x, y are *neighbours* in the graph $\mathcal{G}$ and write $x \sim y$.

We will mostly denote edges by e, f and vertices by x, y, z .

Remark. Graphs are almost always represented in pictorial way. For example the graph $\mathcal{G} = (\mathcal{V}, \mathcal{E})$ with

$$\mathcal{V} = \{1, 2, 3\}, \quad \mathcal{E} = \{\{1, 2\}, \{2, 3\}, \{3, 1\}\}$$

may be represented by



Throughout the following chapter (and the whole lecture) we will mostly use a certain type of graph called *hypercubic lattice*, that is $\mathcal{G} = (\mathbb{Z}^d, \mathcal{E}_d)$, where

$$\mathcal{E}_d = \{\{x, y\} \mid \|x - y\|_1 = 1\}$$

(see Figure 1.1).

Definition 1.2. Let $\mathcal{G} = (\mathcal{V}, \mathcal{E})$ be a graph. A path from $x \in \mathcal{V}$ to $y \in \mathcal{V}$ of length ℓ is a sequence $\gamma = (\gamma_0, \dots, \gamma_\ell)$ such that $\gamma_0 = x$, $\gamma_\ell = y$ with $\{\gamma_i, \gamma_{i+1}\} \in \mathcal{E}$. If γ_i are distinct

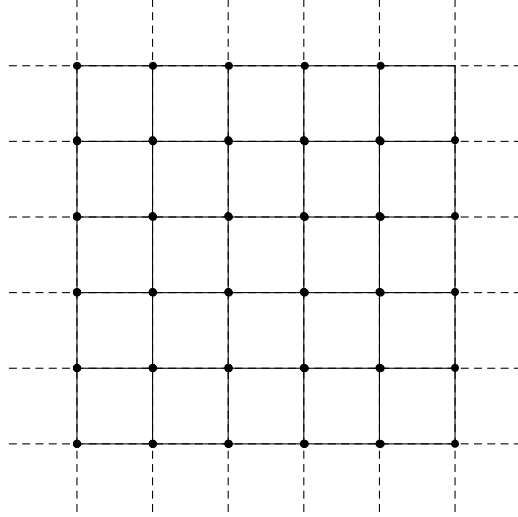


Figure 1.1: Graphical representation of $(\mathbb{Z}^2, \mathcal{E}_d)$.

we call the path *self-avoiding*. The distance between two points $x, y \in \mathcal{V}$ is given by

$$d(x, y) = \inf \{ \text{length}(\gamma) \mid \gamma \text{ is a (self-avoiding) path from } x \text{ to } y \} .$$

On $\mathcal{G} = (\mathbb{Z}^d, \mathcal{E}_d)$ the graph distance coincides with the distance induced by the 1-norm $\|\cdot\|_1$.

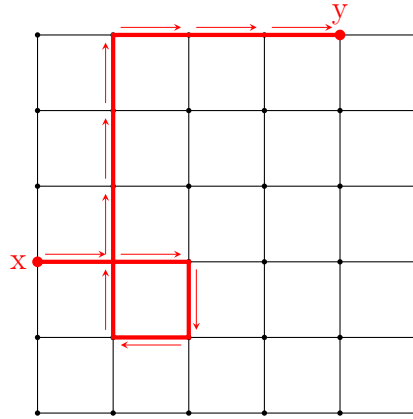


Figure 1.2: This is *not* a self-avoiding path, because we have a loop

Definition 1.3. Let $\mathcal{G} = (\mathcal{V}, \mathcal{E})$ be a graph and let $A \subseteq \mathcal{V}$. We define

$$\begin{aligned} \partial A &:= \{x \in A \mid \exists y \in A^c \text{ s.t. } x \sim y\}, & \text{the boundary of } A, \\ \partial A &:= \{x \in A \mid \exists y \in A^c \text{ s.t. } x \sim y\}, & \text{the external boundary of } A, \\ \Delta A &:= \{e \in \mathcal{E} \mid e = \{x, y\}, x \in A, y \in A^c\} & \text{the set of edges crossing the boundary} \end{aligned}$$

and if $\mathcal{G} = (\mathbb{Z}^d, \mathcal{E}_d)$,

$$\Lambda_n = [-n, n]^d \cap \mathbb{Z}^d.$$

We now introduce the probability space associated with percolation: Let $\mathcal{G} = (\mathcal{V}, \mathcal{E})$ be a graph, $\Omega = \{0, 1\}^{\mathcal{E}}$ which we call the *percolation configuration*. Given a realization $\omega \in \Omega$, if $\omega(e) = 1$ we say that the edge e is *open* (in ω) otherwise, if $\omega(e) = 0$ we say that e is *closed* (in ω). Let $\mathcal{A}$ be the σ -algebra on Ω , generated by events depending on the state of only finitely many edges (cylinder σ -algebra). Moreover, given $p \in [0, 1]$ we define the *percolation measure* by

$$\mathbb{P}_p = \mu^{\otimes E}, \quad \text{where} \quad \mu(\{1\}) = 1 - \mu(\{0\}) = p.$$

This measure is characterized as follows: let $e_1, \dots, e_n \in \mathcal{E}$ and $\omega_1, \dots, \omega_n \in \{0, 1\}$, then

$$\mathbb{P}_p \left(\bigcap_{i=1}^n \{\omega(e_i) = \omega_i\} \right) = p^{\sum_{i=1}^n \omega_i} (1-p)^{\sum_{i=1}^n (1-\omega_i)}.$$

This construction corresponds to opening and closing edges of the graph $\mathcal{G}$ independently according to a Bernoulli-distribution with parameter p .¹ We denote

$$\{x \leftrightarrow y\} := \{\omega \in \Omega : \text{there is an open path from } x \text{ to } y \text{ in } \omega\}.$$

An open path is a path that only contains open edges. For $A, B \subseteq \mathcal{V}$ we define

$$\{A \leftrightarrow B\} := \bigcup_{x \in A} \bigcup_{y \in B} \{x \leftrightarrow y\}$$

and, if the graph $\mathcal{G}$ is infinite,

$$\{x \leftrightarrow \infty\} = \bigcap_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \{\exists y \in \mathcal{V} : d(x, y) = n, x \leftrightarrow y\}.$$

Exercise 1.4. Show that these sets are events.

¹That is, the family of random variables $(X_e)_{e \in \mathcal{E}}$ with $X_e : \Omega \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ given by $X_e(\omega) = e(\omega)$ for $\omega \in \Omega$ is i.i.d..

Definition 1.5. Given a realization $\omega \in \Omega$, a connected component of

$$(\mathcal{V}, \{e \in \mathcal{E} \mid \omega(e) = 1\})$$

is called *cluster*. For $x \in \mathcal{V}$ we write $\mathcal{C}_x = \mathcal{C}_x(\omega)$ for the cluster containing x .

A big part of percolation theory is to study the behaviour of the map

$$[0, 1] \ni p \mapsto \mathbb{P}_p(x \leftrightarrow y).$$

Is this map continuous? Increasing? etc. In order to do this we have to introduce an ordering on Ω : Given $\eta, \omega \in \Omega$ we define

$$\omega < \eta \quad \text{if } \omega(e) \leq \eta(e) \text{ for all } e \in \mathcal{E}.$$

This is clearly not a total order! Using this ordering we can talk about increasing or decreasing functions: A function $f : \Omega \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ is *increasing* if $f(\omega) \leq f(\eta)$ for all $\omega < \eta$. Similarly, an event $A \in \mathcal{A}$ is increasing if $\omega \mapsto \mathbf{1}_A(\omega)$ is an increasing function. This is equivalent to (check this as an exercise)

$$\omega \in A, \eta > \omega \implies \eta \in A.$$

Example 1.6. Show the following: The event $\{x \leftrightarrow y\}$ is increasing, as well as $\{|\mathcal{C}_x| \geq 17\}$. The event $|\mathcal{C}_x| = 10$ is neither increasing nor decreasing.

Proposition 1.7. Let $(\Omega, \mathcal{A}, \mathbb{P}_p)$ be the probability space we just introduced. The following holds:

- (a) Let $A \in \mathcal{A}$ be an increasing event, then the map $[0, 1] \ni p \mapsto \mathbb{P}_p(A)$ is non-decreasing.
- (b) If $f : \Omega \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ is increasing, then the map $[0, 1] \ni p \mapsto \mathbb{E}_p[f]$ is non-decreasing.

Proof. We only prove (b) as it implies (a). To this end, let $(U_e)_{e \in \mathcal{E}}$ be a family of i.i.d. random variables on a probability space $(\hat{\Omega}, \Sigma, \mu)$ that are uniformly distributed on $[0, 1]$. Now, define $X_e^p(\hat{\omega}) = \mathbf{1}_{U_e(\hat{\omega}) \leq p}(\hat{\omega}) \in \{0, 1\}$ for each $e \in \mathcal{E}$, $\hat{\omega} \in \hat{\Omega}$. Then for $p \in [0, 1]$ fixed, $(X_e^p)_{e \in \mathcal{E}}$ is a collection of i.i.d. random variables with

$$\mu(X_e^p = 1) = \mu(U_e \leq p) = \int_{-\infty}^p \mathbf{1}_{[0,1]}(t) dt = p.$$

That is, the distribution of $X^p = (X_e^p)_{e \in \mathcal{E}}$ is $\mathbb{P}_p$.

If $p < p'$ then $X_e^p \leq X_e^{p'}$ pointwise and thus for any increasing function $f : \Omega \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ that is also integrable (or non-negative)

$$\mathbb{E}_p[f] = \int_{\hat{\Omega}} f(X^p(\hat{\omega})) \mu(d\hat{\omega}) \leq \int_{\hat{\Omega}} f(X^{p'}(\hat{\omega})) \mu(d\hat{\omega}) = \mathbb{E}_{p'}[f],$$

where $\Omega = [0, 1]^{\mathcal{E}}$ and we regard X^p as a function $\hat{\Omega} \rightarrow \Omega$. This concludes the proof. $\square$

1.2 Critical probability

We define our next object of interest, the *percolation probability* $\theta(p)$, by

$$\theta(p) := \mathbb{P}_p(0 \leftrightarrow \infty) = \mathbb{P}_p(|\mathcal{C}_x| = \infty) = \lim_{n \rightarrow +\infty} \mathbb{P}_p(0 \leftrightarrow \partial\Lambda_n)$$

Note that $0 \leftrightarrow \partial\Lambda_n$ is an event as it depends only on finitely many edges meaning that all of the involved sets are measurable, i.e., all probabilities are well defined.

In the following the goal is to study the critical value

$$p_c := \inf\{p \in [0, 1] : \theta(p) > 0\}.$$

Question 1.8. Does $0 < p_c < 1$ occur?

Exercise 1.9. Prove that in $d = 1$,

$$\theta_1(p) = \begin{cases} 0, & \text{if } p < 1 \text{ and} \\ 1, & \text{if } p = 1. \end{cases}$$

Consider the event

$$I = \{\omega \in \Omega \mid \omega \text{ contains an infinite cluster}\} = \bigcup_{x \in \mathbb{Z}^d} \{|\mathcal{C}_x| = +\infty\}. \quad (1.1)$$

What is the probability of I ?

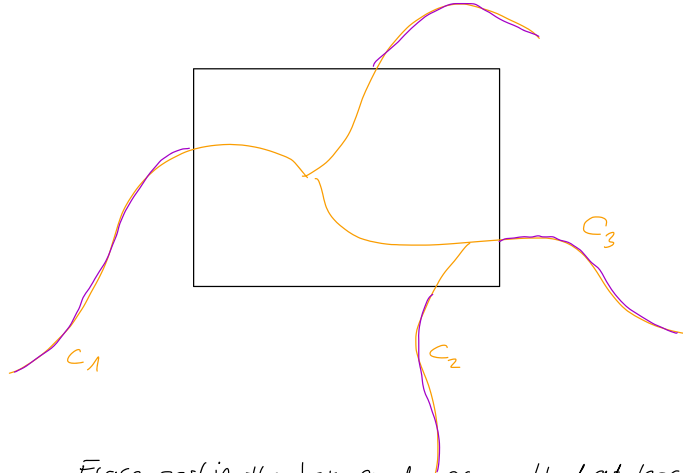
Proposition 1.10. Consider percolation on $\mathcal{G} = (\mathbb{Z}^d, \mathcal{E}_d)$ and let I be given by (1.1). The following statements hold:

- (a) It holds that $\mathbb{P}_p(I) \in \{0, 1\}$.
- (b) $\mathbb{P}_p(I) = 0$ if and only if $\theta(p) = 0$.

Proof. (a): Enumerate edges of $\mathcal{E}_d$ by increasing distance from the origin and write $\mathcal{E}_d = \{\omega_1, \omega_2, \dots\}$. Define

$$I_n := \{\omega \in \Omega \mid \text{there is infinite cluster in } \mathbb{Z}^d \setminus \Lambda_n\}$$

We now claim that $I = I_n$. Indeed, if we show this, the claim follows by Kolmogorov's 0-1-law. The implication $I \supseteq I_n$ is obvious. To prove the opposite inclusion assume that $\omega \in I$ is fixed. Close all edges in Λ_n , which divides our initial infinite cluster into sub-clusters $C_1, \dots, C_n$. Then at least one of the resulting clusters has to be infinite (note that the cluster divides into finitely many sub-clusters, because all, because else



Erasc part in the box and prove that at least one
of the remaining clusters is infinite and that the number
of clusters that are generated by erasing is finite.

Figure 1.3:

we would have infinitely many clusters connected to Λ_n which is not possible as $\Delta\Lambda_n$ is finite). This shows that $\omega \in I_n$ (also see Figure 1.2)

(b): We estimate

$$\begin{aligned}
 \theta(p) &= \mathbb{P}_p(|\mathcal{C}_0| = \infty) \\
 &\leq \mathbb{P}_p(I) \\
 &= \mathbb{P}_p\left(\bigcup_{x \in \mathbb{Z}^d} \{|\mathcal{C}_x| = \infty\}\right) \\
 &\leq \sum_{x \in \mathbb{Z}^d} \mathbb{P}_p(|\mathcal{C}_x| = \infty) \\
 &\stackrel{(!)}{=} \sum_{x \in \mathbb{Z}^d} \theta(p),
 \end{aligned}$$

where (!) follows from the translation invariance of $\mathbb{P}_p(|\mathcal{C}_x| = \infty)$. From this the claimed equivalence follows. $\square$

To prove the next theorem we need to introduce the concept of dual graphs.

Dual graphs. Let $\mathcal{G} = (\mathcal{V}, \mathcal{E})$ be a *planar* graph (that is a graph that can be drawn in the plane without intersecting edges). A region in the plane that is enclosed by vertices of the graph we call *face of the graph* $\mathcal{G}$. The dual graph of $\mathcal{G}$, $\mathcal{G}^* = (\mathcal{V}^*, \mathcal{E}^*)$ has an edge for each pair of faces in $\mathcal{G}$ that are separated from each other by an edge, and a self-loop when the same face appears on both sides of an edge (see Figure 1.2).

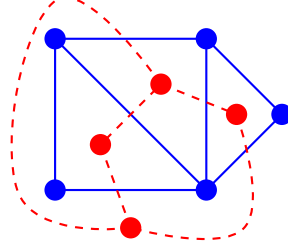


Figure 1.4: Graph in blue and in red its dual graph.

Claim. There is a bijection between $\mathcal{E}$ and $\mathcal{E}^*$ via $e \mapsto e^*$. This is achieved by mapping each edge to the dual edges that crosses it.

Theorem 1.11. Consider percolation on $\mathcal{G} = (\mathbb{Z}^d, \mathcal{E}_d)$. For $d \geq 2$, $p_c(d) \in (0, 1)$.

Proof. Step 1. We show that $\theta_d(p) = 0$ for any $p \leq \frac{1}{2d}$ which implies that $p_c(d) \geq \frac{1}{2d}$. Let

$$\mathcal{P}_n := \{\gamma : \gamma \text{ is a self-avoiding path starting in } 0 \text{ of length } n\}$$

and observe that for all $n \in \mathbb{N}$,

$$\{|\mathcal{C}_0| = \infty\} \subseteq \{\exists \gamma \in \mathcal{P}_n \text{ where all edges of } \gamma \text{ are open}\}$$

which implies by monotonicity of the measure

$$\theta(p) = \mathbb{P}_p(|\mathcal{C}_0| = \infty) \leq \mathbb{P}_p(\exists \gamma \in \mathcal{P}_n, \gamma \text{ is open}) \leq \sum_{\gamma \in \mathcal{P}_n} \underbrace{\mathbb{P}_p(\gamma \text{ is open})}_{=p^n} = p^n |\mathcal{P}_n|$$

for all $n \in \mathbb{N}$. Noting that 0 has $2d$ neighbours and every γ_i has $2d - 1$ neighbours that aren't used to build the path γ we obtain the upper bound

$$|\mathcal{P}_n| \leq (2d)(2d - 1)^{n-1}.$$

Plugging this into the above line and letting $n \rightarrow +\infty$ with $p \leq \frac{1}{2d}$, we obtain that $\theta(p) = 0$.

Step 2. Let $d = 2$. We claim that for any $p > \frac{3}{4}$, $\theta_2(p) > 0$ (which again implies that $p_c(2) \leq \frac{3}{4}$). We will use something called *Peierls argument*.

Note that $\mathbb{Z}^2$ is self-dual (that is $\mathbb{Z}^2$ is its own dual). We now define a *dual configuration* living on the dual graph. Let $\omega \in \Omega$. Define

$$\omega^*(e^*) = 1 - \omega(e) = \begin{cases} 1, & \text{if } \omega(e) = 0 \\ 0, & \text{if } \omega(e) = 1 \end{cases}$$

If $\omega \sim \mathbb{P}_p$, then $\omega^* \sim \mathbb{P}_{1-p}$ and if $\mathcal{C}_0$ is finite, then there is a cycle in ω^* surrounding 0 (we are not going to show this, the reader is advised to carefully check this as an exercise). Now,

$$\begin{aligned} 1 - \theta(p) &= \mathbb{P}_p(|\mathcal{C}_0| < \infty) \\ &= \mathbb{P}_p \left(\bigcup_{n \in \mathbb{N}_0} \{ \omega^* \text{ contains an open cycle of length } n \text{ surrounding } 0 \} \right) \\ &\leq \sum_{n \in \mathbb{N}_0} \underbrace{\mathbb{P}_p(\dots)}_{(1-p)^n} \\ &\leq \sum_{n \in \mathbb{N}} (1-p)^n \cdot \# \{ \text{cycles around } 0 \text{ of length } n \}. \end{aligned}$$

If n is odd or $n = 2$ there are no such cycles. A cycle of length n intersects the positive x -axis at most at distance $n/2$ from the origin, that is we have at most $n/2$ possibilities to cross. Moreover, in every step we have at most 3 possibilities to continue our path, thus

$$\# \{ \text{cycles around } 0 \text{ of length } n \} \leq \frac{n}{2} \cdot 3^{n-1}.$$

Using all these observations one obtains (in the sum we have $2k = n$)

$$1 - \theta(p) \leq \sum_{k \geq 2} (1-p)^{2k} k \cdot 3^{2k-1} < 1$$

if $p > \frac{3}{4}$ from which the claim follows.

Step 3 . We claim

$$p_c(d) \leq p_c(2) \quad \text{for all } d \geq 2. \tag{1.2}$$

Using that $\mathbb{Z}^2$ can be embedded in $\mathbb{Z}^d$ for $d \geq 2$ we have that

$$\mathbb{P}_p(|\mathcal{C}_0| = \infty) \geq \mathbb{P}_p(|\mathcal{C}_0 \cap \mathbb{Z}^2| = \infty). \quad \square$$

1.3 Harris-FKG-inequality

To motivate our next result consider two events A, B . What can we say about the probability of the intersection $\mathbb{P}(A \cap B)$?

As an example take $x, y, u, v \in \mathbb{Z}^d$ and let $e \in \mathcal{E}$ be an edge. One would expect

$$\mathbb{P}_p(x \leftrightarrow y) \leq \mathbb{P}_p(x \leftrightarrow y \mid e \text{ open}) \quad \text{or} \quad \mathbb{P}_p(x \leftrightarrow y) \leq \mathbb{P}_p(x \leftrightarrow y \mid u \leftrightarrow v).$$

Theorem 1.12 (Harris-FKG-inequality). Let $p \in [0, 1]$. The following holds:

- (a) If A, B are increasing events then $\mathbb{P}_p(A \cap B) \geq \mathbb{P}_p(A)\mathbb{P}_p(B)$.
- (b) If $f, g \in L^2(\mathbb{P}_p)$ are increasing then $\mathbb{E}_p[fg] \geq \mathbb{E}_p[f]\mathbb{E}_p[g]$.

Remark. • If we replace by f by $-f$ and g by $-g$ we can also put decreasing and the equality still holds.

- The proof does not use the geometry of $\mathbb{Z}^d$, it only uses the properties of the product measure. However, FKG even holds for some non-product measure.

Proof of Theorem 1.12. We only show (b), as it implies (a).

Step 1. Assume that f, g only depend on finitely many edges. We enumerate the edges $\mathcal{E}_d = \{e_1, e_2, \dots\}$ and write $\omega_i := \omega(e_i)$. If $f, g : \{0, 1\}^n \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ are increasing we claim that

$$\mathbb{E}_p[f(\omega_1, \dots, \omega_n)g(\omega_1, \dots, \omega_n)] \geq \mathbb{E}_p[f(\omega_1, \dots, \omega_n)]\mathbb{E}_p[g(\omega_1, \dots, \omega_n)]. \quad (1.3)$$

We prove this claim by induction: For $n = 1$, $a, b \in \{0, 1\}$ we have

$$(f(a) - f(b))(g(a) - g(b)) \geq 0$$

so multiplying by $\mathbb{P}_p(\omega_1 = a)\mathbb{P}_p(\omega_1 = b) \geq 0$ and summing over all a, b gives us

$$2(\mathbb{E}_p[fg] - \mathbb{E}_p[f]\mathbb{E}_p[g]) \geq 0.$$

Assume that (1.3) holds for $n \leq k$. Then, using that ω_i are independent, and writing $\omega = (\omega_1, \dots, \omega_{k+1}) = (\omega', \omega_{k+1})$, as well as $\tilde{f}(k) = \mathbb{E}_p[f(\omega', k)]$ and $\tilde{g}(k) = \mathbb{E}_p[g(\omega', k)]$ for $k \in \{0, 1\}$ we find

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbb{E}_p[(f \cdot g)(\omega)] &= p \cdot \mathbb{E}_p[(f \cdot g)(\omega', 1)] + (1 - p) \cdot \mathbb{E}_p[(f \cdot g)(\omega', 0)] \\ &\geq p \cdot \mathbb{E}_p[f(\omega', 1)]\mathbb{E}_p[g(\omega', 1)] + (1 - p) \cdot \mathbb{E}_p[f(\omega', 0)]\mathbb{E}_p[g(\omega', 0)] \\ &= \mathbb{E}_p[\tilde{f}\tilde{g}] \\ &\geq \mathbb{E}_p[\tilde{f}]\mathbb{E}_p[\tilde{g}] \\ &= \mathbb{E}_p[f]\mathbb{E}_p[g]. \end{aligned}$$

Step 2. Take $f, g \in L^2(\mathbb{P}_p)$ possibly not depending on finitely many edges and set

$$f_n := \mathbb{E}_p[f \mid \sigma(\omega_1, \dots, \omega_n)] \quad \text{and} \quad g_n = \mathbb{E}_p[g \mid \sigma(\omega_1, \dots, \omega_k)].$$

Then f_n, g_n only depend on $\omega_1, \dots, \omega_n$ and are increasing. Also f_n, g_n , $n \in \mathbb{N}$ are martingales bounded in $L^2(\mathbb{P}_p)$ so evoking the martingale convergence theorem we find

$$f_n \xrightarrow{L^2} f, \quad g_n \xrightarrow{L^2} g.$$

Since convergence in L^2 implies convergence in L^1 we obtain, using the previous step,

$$\mathbb{E}_p[fg] = \lim_{n \rightarrow +\infty} \mathbb{E}_p[f_n g_n] \geq \lim_{n \rightarrow +\infty} \mathbb{E}_p[f_n]\mathbb{E}_p[g_n] = \mathbb{E}_p[f]\mathbb{E}_p[g]. \quad \square$$

The next corollary is also very useful:

Corollary 1.13 (square-root-trick). For n increasing events $A_1, \dots, A_n \in \mathcal{A}$ it holds

$$\max_{k=1, \dots, n} \mathbb{P}_p(A_k) \geq 1 - \left(1 - \mathbb{P}_p(A_1 \cup \dots \cup A_n)\right)^{1/n}.$$

Proof. Using Theorem 1.12 inductively we get

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbb{P}_p(A_1 \cup \dots \cup A_n) &= 1 - \mathbb{P}_p(A_1^c \cap \dots \cap A_n^c) \\ &\leq 1 - \mathbb{P}_p(A_1^c) \dots \mathbb{P}_p(A_n^c) \\ &\leq 1 - \left(1 - \max_{k=1, \dots, n} \mathbb{P}_p(A_k)\right)^n, \end{aligned}$$

and the claim follows by rearranging. $\square$

Application: percolation on $\mathbb{Z}^2$. Consider percolation on $(\mathbb{Z}^2, \mathcal{E}_2)$. Consider a rectangle and the event that there is a path from left to right in that rectangle. We denote this event by



We want to compare this event to the event that the path from left to right ends up in the upper half of the square denoted by



Note that, by symmetry, this has the same probability that the path ends up in the lower half. Using the square-root-trick, Corollary 1.13 we obtain the following implication:

$$\mathbb{P}_p \left(\left[\text{path from left to right} \right] \right) \geq 1 - \varepsilon \implies \mathbb{P}_p \left(\left[\text{path from left to right ending in upper half} \right] \right) \geq 1 - \sqrt{\varepsilon}.$$

1.4 BK inequality

In various situations the FKG inequality is useless since it goes in the wrong direction. We thus need a complementary opposite inequality, which of course cannot hold for the intersection $A \cap B$ of two increasing events A, B . We are, thus, going to define a new event, so called disjoint occurrence of A, B , denoted by $A \circ B$. It is useful to start with an example.

Example 1.14. Consider four vertices $x, y, u, v \in \mathcal{V}$ and consider the event that there exist γ_1, γ_2 two disjoint paths connecting x, y and u, v . It seems plausible that the fact that we cannot use the same edges for connecting x, y and u, v makes the probability of the event smaller than $\mathbb{P}_p(x \leftrightarrow y)\mathbb{P}_p(u \leftrightarrow v)$. Informally we can write this as

$$\mathbb{P}_p \left(\underbrace{\left(\begin{array}{c} u \quad v \\ x \quad y \end{array} \right)}_{\text{disjoint paths}} \right) \leq \mathbb{P}_p(x \leftrightarrow y)\mathbb{P}_p(u \leftrightarrow v)$$

Definition 1.15. Let $A \in \mathcal{A}$ and $\omega \in \Omega$. A set $I \subseteq \mathcal{E}$ is a *witness of A in ω* if

$$\omega \in A \text{ and } \omega' \in \Omega \text{ s.t. } \omega|_I = \omega'|_I \implies \omega' \in A.$$

Remark. Note that I may depend on ω .

Essentially, a witness is a specific subset of edges whose state is sufficient to prove that a particular event has occurred.

Example 1.16.

- If γ is a path from x to y and ω is such that all edges of γ are open, then the set containing all edges of γ is a witness of $\{x \leftrightarrow y\}$.
- If $\omega \in A$, then $\mathcal{E}$ is always a witness for A in ω .

Exercise 1.17. (a) Find a witness for $|\mathcal{C}_0| = 3$, $|\mathcal{C}_0| \geq 3$.

(b) If A is increasing, $\omega \in A$, then there is I witnessing A in ω such that $\omega|_I \equiv 1$.

Next, we introduce the concept of events or sets occurring disjointly (denoted by the symbol $\circ$) which formalizes the idea that two events happen simultaneously in a random configuration, but for completely independent and non-overlapping reasons.

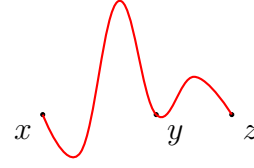
Definition 1.18. Let $A, B \in \mathcal{A}$. Set

$$A \circ B := \left\{ \omega \in \Omega \mid \exists I, J \subseteq \mathcal{E} \text{ disjoint s.t. } \begin{array}{l} I \text{ witnesses } A \text{ in } \omega \\ J \text{ witnesses } B \text{ in } \omega \end{array} \right\}.$$

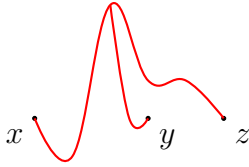
When $A \circ B$ occurs, we say A, B occur *disjointly*.

Example 1.19. • $\{e \text{ is open}\} \circ \{f \text{ is open}\} = \begin{cases} \emptyset, & \text{if } e = f \\ \{e, f \text{ are open}\}, & \text{else} \end{cases}$.

• The set $\{x \leftrightarrow y\} \circ \{y \leftrightarrow z\}$ contains



but not



In order to understand these concepts the next exercise might be helpful.

Exercise 1.20. Show the following statements:

- (a) It holds that $A \circ B \subseteq A \cap B$ for any $A, B \in \mathcal{A}$.
- (b) If A and B depend on disjoint sets of edges, then $A \circ B = A \cap B$.
- (c) If A is increasing and B is decreasing, then $A \circ B = A \cap B$.

Hint: Note that one inclusion is already proven in (a).

- (d) If A and B are increasing, then

$$A \circ B = \left\{ \omega \in \Omega \mid \exists I, J \text{ disjoint, } \omega|_{I \cup J} \equiv 1 \text{ and } \begin{array}{l} I \text{ witnesses } A \text{ in } \omega, \\ J \text{ witnesses } B \text{ in } \omega \end{array} \right\}.$$

Hint: You only need to show that given $\omega \in A \circ B$ you can find I, J such that I, J are disjoint witnesses of A, B respectively and $\omega|_{I \cup J} \equiv 1$.

Next theorem gives our desired complementary inequality to FKG.

Theorem 1.21. Let A, B be events (depending on finitely many edges). Then

$$\mathbb{P}_p(A \circ B) \leq \mathbb{P}_p(A)\mathbb{P}_p(B)$$

Proof. We only show the theorem for increasing events as this is complicated enough. Let $A, B \subseteq \{0, 1\}^{\mathcal{E}}$ increasing and $\mathcal{E} = \{e_1, \dots, e_n\}$ finite. We "duplicate" edges by adding to every e_i a parallel edge e'_i like

1 Bernoulli Percolation



Throughout the proof we assume that all edges in witnessing sets are always open. We consider percolation on the "duplicated graph". Configurations are $\bar{\omega} = (\omega, \omega')$ with

$$\begin{aligned}\omega &= (\omega_1, \dots, \omega_n) = (\omega(e_1), \dots, \omega(e_n)) \\ \omega' &= (\omega'_1, \dots, \omega'_n) = (\omega(e'_1), \dots, \omega(e'_n)).\end{aligned}$$

Denote by $\bar{\mathbb{P}}_p$ the corresponding measure and set $\bar{\mathcal{E}} = \mathcal{E} \cup \mathcal{E}'$.

We set

$$\omega^{(i)} := (\omega'_1, \dots, \omega'_i, \omega_{i+1}, \dots, \omega_n)$$

which interpolates between $\omega^{(0)} = \omega$ and $\omega^{(n)} = \omega'$. Moreover, we define

$$\begin{aligned}\bar{A}_i &:= \{\bar{\omega} \mid \omega^{(i)} \in A\} \\ \bar{B} &:= \{\bar{\omega} \mid \omega \in B\}.\end{aligned}$$

Now, note that

$$\bar{\mathbb{P}}_p(\bar{A}_n \circ \bar{B}) = \bar{\mathbb{P}}_p(\bar{A}_n) \bar{\mathbb{P}}_p(\bar{B}) = \mathbb{P}_p(A) \mathbb{P}_p(B),$$

where we used in the first equality that $\bar{A}_n$ depends on ω' and $\bar{B}$ on ω , so $\bar{A}_n \circ \bar{B} = \bar{A}_n \cap \bar{B}$. Using that $\bar{A}_0$ and $\bar{B}$ only depend on ω ,

$$\bar{\mathbb{P}}_p(\bar{A}_0 \circ \bar{B}) = \mathbb{P}_p(A \circ B).$$

Hence, BK is equivalent to

$$\bar{\mathbb{P}}_p(\bar{A}_n \circ B) \geq \bar{\mathbb{P}}_p(\bar{A}_0 \circ \bar{B}).$$

We thus show

$$\boxed{\text{for all } i = 1, \dots, n, \quad \bar{\mathbb{P}}_p(\bar{A}_{i-1} \circ \bar{B}) \leq \bar{\mathbb{P}}_p(\bar{A}_i \circ \bar{B}).} \quad (1.4)$$

We will decompose $\bar{A}_{i-1} \circ \bar{B}$: Let

$$C_1 := \left\{ \exists I, J \subseteq \bar{\mathcal{E}} \setminus \{e_i, e'_i\} \text{ disjoint, open s.t. } \begin{array}{l} I \text{ witnesses } \bar{A}_{i-1} \text{ in } \bar{\omega} \text{ and} \\ J \text{ witnesses } \bar{B} \text{ in } \bar{\omega} \end{array} \right\},$$

i.e., the event " $\bar{A}_{i-1} \circ B$ " occurs regardless of ω_i .

$$C_2 := C_1^c \cap \left\{ \exists I, J \subseteq \bar{\mathcal{E}} \setminus \{e_i, e'_i\} \text{ disjoint, open s.t. } \begin{array}{l} I \text{ witnesses } \bar{A}_{i-1} \text{ in } \bar{\omega} \text{ and} \\ J \cap \{e_i\} \text{ witnesses } \bar{B} \text{ in } \bar{\omega}^{e_i} \end{array} \right\},$$

1 Bernoulli Percolation

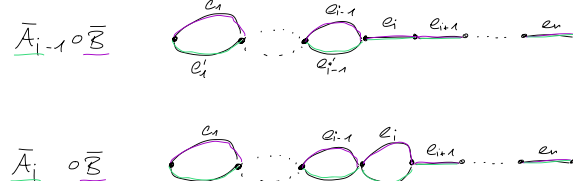


Figure 1.5: Edges "used" by $\bar{A}_{i-1} \circ \bar{B}$ and $\bar{A}_i \circ B$

where $\bar{\omega}^{e_i}$ is given by

$$(\bar{\omega}^{e_i})_f = \begin{cases} \bar{\omega}, & \text{if } f \neq e_i \\ 1, & \text{if } f = e_i. \end{cases}$$

The event C_2 is described by the following: If $\omega_i = 1$, then there is a witness for $\bar{B}$ using e_i and a disjoint witness for $\bar{A}_{i-1}$, if $\omega_i = 0$, $\bar{A}_{i-1} \cap \bar{B}$ does not occur. Lastly, define

$$C_3 := C_1^c \cap C_2^c \cap \left\{ \exists I, J \subseteq \bar{\mathcal{E}} \setminus \{e_i, e'_i\} \text{ disjoint, open s.t. } \begin{array}{l} I \cup \{e_i\} \text{ witnesses } \bar{A}_{i-1} \text{ in } \bar{\omega}^{e_i} \text{ and} \\ J \text{ witnesses } \bar{B} \text{ in } \bar{\omega} \end{array} \right\},$$

that is, the only way $\bar{A}_{i-1} \circ \bar{B}$ occurs is that $\omega_i = 1$ and the witness for $\bar{A}_{i-1}$ uses e_i .

Now, observe that C_1, C_2, C_3 are independent of ω_i and ω'_i and that

$$\bar{A}_{i-1} \circ \bar{B} = C - 1 \cup (C_2 \cap \{\omega_i = 1\}) \cup (C_3 \cap \{\omega_i = 1\}),$$

which is a disjoint union. Hence

$$\bar{\mathbb{P}}_p(\bar{A}_{i-1} \circ \bar{B}) = \bar{\mathbb{P}}_p(C_1) + p(\bar{\mathbb{P}}_p(C_2) + \bar{\mathbb{P}}_p(C_3)). \quad (1.5)$$

Similarly,

$$\bar{A}_i \circ \bar{B} \supseteq C_1 \cup (C_2 \cap \{\omega_i\}) \cup (C_3 \cap \{\omega'_i = 1\}).$$

This is only an inclusion as it could also be that the witnesses for $\bar{A}_i$ and $\bar{B}$ both contain e'_i . Hence,

$$\bar{\mathbb{P}}_p(\bar{A}_i \circ B) \geq \bar{\mathbb{P}}_p(C_1) + p(\bar{\mathbb{P}}_p(C_2) + \bar{\mathbb{P}}_p(C_3)). \quad (1.6)$$

As (1.5) and (1.6) imply (1.4) we conclude the proof. $\square$

Corollary 1.22. Consider percolation on $\mathbb{Z}^d$. Then

$$\mathbb{P}_p(x \leftrightarrow y \circ y \leftrightarrow z) \leq \mathbb{P}_p(x \leftrightarrow y) \mathbb{P}_p(y \leftrightarrow z).$$

Proof. Note that we need to be careful here as $x \leftrightarrow y$ depends on infinitely many edges contrary to the statement of Theorem 1.21. Note that

$$\{x \leftrightarrow y\} = \bigcup_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \{x \overset{\Lambda_n}{\leftrightarrow} y\},$$

which is a union of increasing sets. Using Theorem 1.21 and passing to the limit $n \rightarrow +\infty$ we conclude. $\square$

1.5 Russo's formula

If A is increasing, then by monotonicity

$$[0, 1] \ni p \mapsto \mathbb{P}_p(A)$$

is increasing. In the following we will discuss Russo's formula which allows us to take the derivative of this map. To this end, we need another definition:

Definition 1.23. Let $A \in \mathcal{A}$ be an event, $\omega \in \Omega$ and $e \in \mathcal{E}$. We say that e is pivotal for A in ω if

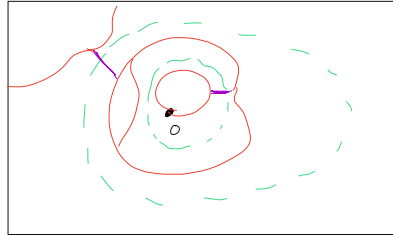
$$\mathbf{1}_A(\omega_e) \neq \mathbf{1}_A(\omega^e),$$

where

$$\omega_e(f) = \begin{cases} \omega(f), & f \neq e \\ 0, & f = e \end{cases} \quad \text{and} \quad \omega^e(f) = \begin{cases} \omega(f), & f \neq e \\ 1, & f = e. \end{cases}$$

The edge e is pivotal for A in ω if changing $\omega(e)$ decides if $\omega \in A$.

Example 1.24. Consider $A = \{0 \leftrightarrow \partial\Lambda_n\}$ and ω as on the figure:



*The two edges marked — are pivotal for A in ω .
They are the only edges open in ω crossing "blocking surfaces"
marked in green.*

Remark. Note that the event " e is pivotal" is independent of $\omega(e)$.

Theorem 1.25 (Russo). Let A be an increasing event depending only on the state of edges in a finite set $\mathcal{E}_0 \subseteq \mathcal{E}$. Then

$$\frac{d}{dp} \mathbb{P}_p(A) = \sum_{e \in \mathcal{E}_0} \mathbb{P}_p(e \text{ is pivotal for } A) = \mathbb{E}_p[\#\text{edges pivotal for } A].$$

Remark. When A depends on the state of infinitely many edges, then $p \mapsto \mathbb{P}_p(A)$ does not need to be differentiable (or even continuous). Consider, e.g., $A = \{0 \leftrightarrow \infty\}$ on

$(\mathbb{Z}, \mathcal{E}_1)$.

Proof of Theorem 1.25. As A depends only on edges in $\mathcal{E}_0$, we consider $\Omega = \{0, 1\}^{\mathcal{E}_0}$, view A as $A \subseteq \Omega$ and for $\omega \in \Omega$ set

$$|\omega| := |\{e \in \mathcal{E}_0 \mid \omega(e) = 1\}| = \sum_{e \in \mathcal{E}_0} \omega(e).$$

Note that Ω and A are finite. Then

$$p \mapsto \mathbb{P}_p(A) = \sum_{\omega \in A} p^{|\omega|} (1-p)^{|\mathcal{E}_0| - |\omega|}$$

is a polynomial in p and differentiable as such. We write $\mathcal{E}_0 = \{e_1, \dots, e_n\}$ and $\omega_i = \omega(e_i)$. For $p_i \in [0, 1]$ for $i = 1, \dots, k$ and $\omega \in \Omega$ we set

$$\mathbb{P}_{p_1, \dots, p_k}(\omega) := \prod_{i=1}^k p_i^{\omega_i} (1-p_i)^{1-\omega_i},$$

that is $\mathbb{P}_p(\omega) = \mathbb{P}_{p, \dots, p}(\omega)$. Moreover set

$$f(p_1, \dots, p_k) := \mathbb{P}_{p_1, \dots, p_k}(A) = \sum_{\omega \in A} \prod_{i=1}^k p_i^{\omega_i} (1-p_i)^{1-\omega_i}, \text{ so}$$

Then we have that

$$\frac{d}{dp} \mathbb{P}_p(A) = \frac{d}{dp} f(p, \dots, p) = \sum_{i=1}^k \partial_{p_i} f(p, \dots, p). \quad (1.7)$$

But,

$$\begin{aligned} \partial_{p_i} f(p, \dots, p) &= \frac{\partial}{\partial p_i} \left(\sum_{\omega \in A} \mathbf{1}_A(\omega) \left(\prod_{j \neq i} p_j^{\omega_j} (1-p_j)^{1-\omega_j} \right) p_i^{\omega_i} (1-p_i)^{1-\omega_i} \right) \Bigg|_{p_1, \dots, p_n = p} \\ &= \sum_{\omega \in \Omega} \mathbf{1}_A(\omega) \left(\prod_{j \neq i} p^{\omega_j} (1-p)^{1-\omega_j} \right) \cdot \left(\mathbf{1}_{\omega_i=1} - \mathbf{1}_{\omega_i=0} \right) \end{aligned} \quad (1.8)$$

Consider $\omega' \in \{0, 1\}^{\mathcal{E}_0 \setminus e_i}$ with $\omega = (\omega', \omega_i)$.

- If ω' is such that $(\omega', 0) \in A$, $(\omega', 1) \in A$, then contributions of $(\omega', 1)$ and $(\omega', 0)$ cancel each other out.
- If $(\omega', 0) \notin A$, $(\omega', 1) \in A$ (that is e_i is pivotal for A in ω) only $\mathbf{1}_{\omega_i \neq 1}$ remains.
- If $(\omega', 0) \notin A$ and $(\omega', 1) \notin A$ we get 0.
- The case $(\omega', 0) \in A$ and $(\omega', 1) \notin A$ is impossible since A is increasing.

Hence, we get

$$\begin{aligned} (1.8) &= \sum_{\omega \in \Omega} \mathbf{1}\{e_i \text{ is pivotal for } A \text{ in } \omega, \omega_i = 1\} \prod_{i \neq j} (p^{\omega_i} (1-p)^{1-\omega_i}) \\ &= \mathbb{P}_p(e_i \text{ is pivotal for } A). \end{aligned}$$

Inserting this back into (1.7) completes the proof. $\square$

Example 1.26 (Application of the previous theorem). Let A be an increasing event. Then, noting that the events " e is pivotal for A " and " e is open" are independent we have

$$\begin{aligned}
 \frac{d}{dp} \mathbb{P}_p(A) &= \sum_{e \in \mathcal{E}_0} \mathbb{P}_p(e \text{ is pivotal for } A) \\
 &= \frac{1}{p} \sum_{e \in \mathcal{E}_0} \mathbb{P}_p(e \text{ is pivotal for } A, e \text{ is open}) \\
 &= \frac{1}{p} \sum_{e \in \mathcal{E}_0} \mathbb{P}_p(\{e \text{ is pivotal for } A\} \cap A) \\
 &= \frac{1}{p} \sum_{e \in \mathcal{E}_0} \mathbb{P}_p(e \text{ is pivotal for } A \mid A) \mathbb{P}_p(A) \\
 &= \frac{1}{p} \mathbb{E}_p[\text{number of pivotal edges for } A \mid A] \cdot \mathbb{P}_p(A).
 \end{aligned}$$

One has thus obtained a differential equation for $\mathbb{P}_p(A)$. Solving this differential equation, i.e., by integrating this over $p \in [p_1, p_2]$, we obtain

$$\mathbb{P}_{p_2}(A) = \mathbb{P}_{p_1}(A) \exp \left\{ \int_{p_1}^{p_2} \frac{1}{p} \mathbb{E}_p[\#\text{pivotal} \mid A] dp \right\}.$$

Using the trivial bound $\#\text{pivots} \leq |\mathcal{E}_0|$ we deduce

$$\mathbb{P}_{p_2}(A) \leq \mathbb{P}_{p_1}(A) \left(\frac{p_2}{p_1} \right)^{|\mathcal{E}_0|}.$$

Note that the coupling, FKG, BK and Russo work on *any* graph, not just $\mathbb{Z}^d$.

1.6 Ergodicity and Mixing

We now work on $\mathcal{G} = (\mathbb{Z}^d, \mathcal{E}_d)$ and formalize the "translation invariance". The additive group $(\mathbb{Z}^d, +)$ acts

- on $\mathbb{Z}^d$ by the usual translation,
- on $\mathcal{E}_d$ by $z \cdot \{x, y\} = \{x + z, y + z\}$.
- on $\Omega = \{0, 1\}^{\mathcal{E}_d}$ by $(z \cdot \omega)\{x, y\} = \omega(\{x - z, y - z\})$. Note that e is open in ω iff $z \cdot e$ is open in ω .
- on $\mathcal{A}$ via $z \cdot A = \{z \cdot \omega : \omega \in A\}$.

Lemma 1.27 ($\mathbb{P}_p$ is translation invariant). For any $A \in \mathcal{A}$ and for any $z \in \mathbb{Z}^d$

$$\mathbb{P}_p(z \cdot A) = \mathbb{P}_p(A).$$

Proof. Define the translated measure $(z \cdot \mathbb{P}_p)(A) := \mathbb{P}_p(z \cdot A)$. Consider A that depends on the state of finitely many elements (cylinder events) i.e., we take

$$A = \bigcap_{i=1}^n \{\omega \in \Omega : \omega(e_i) = \omega_i\}, \quad e_1, \dots, e_n \in E, \quad \omega_1, \dots, \omega_n \in \{0, 1\}, \quad (1.9)$$

so we have that

$$(z \cdot \mathbb{P}_p)(A) = p^{\sum_{i=1}^n \omega_i} (1-p)^{\sum_{i=1}^n (1-\omega_i)} = \mathbb{P}_p(A).$$

Since the sets of the form A from (1.9) make up a π -system we conclude by Dynkin's lemma. $\square$

Proposition 1.28 (Mixing). Consider percolation on $\mathbb{Z}^d$ and let $A, B \in \mathcal{A}$. Then

$$\lim_{\|z\|_1 \rightarrow +\infty} \mathbb{P}_p(A \cap (z \cdot B)) = \mathbb{P}_p(A) \mathbb{P}_p(B).$$

We first need a lemma, approximating the above by cylinder events.

Lemma 1.29. For any $A \in \mathcal{A}$ and $\varepsilon > 0$ there exists A_ε of the form (1.9) (we denote the collection of all such sets as $\mathcal{C}$) such that $\mathbb{P}_p(A \Delta A_\varepsilon) \leq \varepsilon$.

Proof. Define

$$\mathcal{D} := \{A \in \mathcal{A} : \forall \varepsilon > 0 \exists A_\varepsilon \in \mathcal{C} \text{ s.t. } \mathbb{P}_p(A \Delta A_\varepsilon) \leq \varepsilon\}.$$

Then one can prove that $\Omega \in \mathcal{D}$, $\mathcal{C} \subseteq \mathcal{D}$ and $\mathcal{D}$ is a λ -system so we conclude by Dynkin's lemma. $\square$

Proof of Proposition 1.28. Fix $\varepsilon > 0$ and $A_\varepsilon, B_\varepsilon \in \mathcal{A}$ such that

$$\mathbb{P}_p(A \Delta A_\varepsilon), \mathbb{P}_p(B \Delta B_\varepsilon) \leq \varepsilon.$$

As $A_\varepsilon, B_\varepsilon \in \mathcal{C}$, the formula holds for them. So we have for z large,

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbb{P}_p(A \cap (z \cdot B)) &\leq \mathbb{P}_p(A_\varepsilon \cap (z \cdot B)) + 2\varepsilon \\ &= \mathbb{P}_p(A_\varepsilon) \mathbb{P}_p(B_\varepsilon) + 2\varepsilon \\ &\leq \mathbb{P}_p(A) \mathbb{P}_p(B) + 4\varepsilon. \end{aligned}$$

The lower bound follows analogously. $\square$

Theorem 1.30. Let $A \in \mathcal{A}$ be invariant, that is $z \cdot A = A$ for any $z \in \mathbb{Z}^d$. Then $\mathbb{P}_p(A) \in \{0, 1\}$.

Proof. Since $A = z \cdot A$ we have by Proposition 1.28,

$$\mathbb{P}_p(A) = \lim_{\|z\|_1 \rightarrow +\infty} \mathbb{P}(A \cap (z \cdot A)) = \mathbb{P}_p(A)\mathbb{P}_p(A). \quad \square$$

Example 1.31. • Obviously $\{\omega \in \Omega : \omega \text{ contains infinite cluster}\} = I$ is translation invariant so by our previous theorem we have $\mathbb{P}_p(I) \in \{0, 1\}$.

- Define $I_k := \{\omega \in \Omega : \omega \text{ contains exactly } k \text{ infinite clusters}\}$, $k \in \mathbb{N}_0 \cup \{\infty\}$ is again translation invariant. So also $\mathbb{P}_p(I_k) \in \{0, 1\}$. This means the random variable

$$N(\omega) = \# \text{of infinite clusters in } \omega.$$

is $\mathbb{P}_p$ -a.s. constant. We will cover this in more depth in the next chapter.

Question 1.32. Find k such that $\mathbb{P}_p(N = k) = 1$.

2 Uniqueness of infinite clusters

We have already proved that an infinite cluster exists with positive probability for $p > p_c$ (c.f. Proposition 1.10). It is thus natural to ask how many of these clusters exists. Surprisingly, $\mathbb{P}_p$ -a.s. there exists at most one such cluster.

Theorem 2.1 (Aizuman, Kesten, Newman, 1987). For any $d \in \mathbb{N}$, $p \in [0, 1]$ consider Bernoulli-percolation on $(\mathbb{Z}^d, E_d)$. Let N denote the number of infinite clusters in $\mathbb{Z}^d$. Then either

- $\mathbb{P}_p(N = 0) = 1$ or
- $\mathbb{P}_p(N = 1) = 1$.

That is, if $p < p_c$ we have a.s. no infinite cluster and if $p_c > p$ we a.s. have an infinite cluster.

The proof we will show here is due to Burton and Keave (1989).

Proof. Throughout the proof assume that $p \in (0, 1)$. If $p = 0$ there $\mathbb{P}_p$ -a.s. does not exist an infinite cluster and if $p = 1$, $\mathbb{P}_p$ -a.s. every edge is open. We already know that there exists $k \in \mathbb{N}_0 \cup \{\infty\}$ such that $\mathbb{P}_p(N = k) = 1$.

Step 1 Prove $k \in \{0, 1, \infty\}$. Suppose that $1 < k < \infty$ meaning $\mathbb{P}_p(N = 1) = 0$. Define the event

$$F_n := \{\omega \in \Omega : \text{all } k \text{ infinite clusters in } \omega \text{ touch the box } \Lambda_n\}.$$

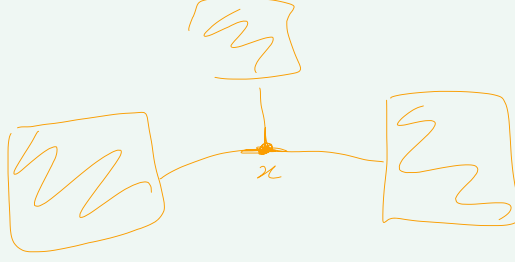
We already know that $\lim_{n \rightarrow +\infty} \mathbb{P}_p(F_n) = 1$ so there exists $n \in \mathbb{N}$ such that $\mathbb{P}_p(F_n) \geq \frac{1}{2}$. Now,

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbb{P}_p(N = 1) &\geq \mathbb{P}_p(F_n \cap \{\text{all edges in } \Lambda_n \text{ are open}\}) \\ &= \mathbb{P}_p(F_n) \mathbb{P}_p(\text{all edges in } \Lambda_n \text{ are open}) \\ &\geq \frac{1}{2} \cdot p^{|E(\Lambda_n)|} > 0 \end{aligned}$$

if $p > 0$.

which is a contradiction.

Definition 2.2. $x \in \mathbb{Z}^d$ is a *trifurcation* in ω if



- x is incident to exactly 3 open edges in ω .
- if these 3 edges are removed from ω , $\mathcal{C}_x$ separates into 3 infinite clusters.

Denote

$$T_x := \{\omega \in \Omega : x \text{ is trifurcation in } \omega\}$$

Step 2 If $\mathbb{P}_p(N \geq 3) > 0$ then $\mathbb{P}_p(T_0 > 0)$.. Define

$$B_n := \{x \in \mathbb{Z}^d : \|x\|_1 \leq n\}$$

$$E_n := \{\text{at least 3 infinite clusters touch } B_n\}$$

$$E_n(x, y, z) := \{\text{outside of } B_n, \mathcal{C}_x, \mathcal{C}_y, \mathcal{C}_z \text{ are infinite and disjoint}\}.$$

For n large,

$$0 < \mathbb{P}_p(E_n) = \mathbb{P}_p \left(\bigcup_{\substack{x, y, z \in \partial B_n \\ x \neq y \neq z}} E_n(x, y, z) \right) \leq \sum_{x, y, z \in \partial B_n} \mathbb{P}_p(E_n(x, y, z))$$

so there exists $n \in \mathbb{N}$ and $x, y, z \in \partial B_n$ such that $\mathbb{P}_p(E_n(x, y, z)) > 0$. For n large enough we can for any $x, y, z \in \partial B_n$ we can find disjoint paths $\gamma_x, \gamma_y, \gamma_z$ such that γ_v connects v to 0 in B_n for all $v = x, y, z$. Also, note that this works on B_n but not in Λ_n .

Then

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbb{P}_p(T_0) &\geq \mathbb{P}_p(E_n(x, y, z) \cap \{\gamma_x, \gamma_y, \gamma_z \text{ are open and all other edges in } B_n \text{ are closed}\}) \\ &= \mathbb{P}_p(E_n(x, y, z))\mathbb{P}_n(\dots) > 0, \end{aligned}$$

using that the sets are independent.

Step 3: For any $p \in (0, 1)$, $\mathbb{P}_p(N = \infty) = 0$. We assume by contradiction that $\mathbb{P}_p(N = \infty) = 1$. By the previous step $\mathbb{P}_p(T_0) = \text{const} > 0$. Define the random variable

$$\mathcal{T}_n(\omega) := \sum_{x \in \Lambda_n} \mathbf{1}_{T_x}(\omega),$$

which is the number of trifurcations. Computing the expectation of $\mathcal{T}_n$ gives

$$\mathbb{E}_p[\mathcal{T}_n] = \sum_{x \in \Lambda_n} \mathbb{P}_p(x \text{ is trifurcation}) = |\Lambda_n| \cdot \mathbb{P}_p(T_0) = \mathcal{O}(n^d). \quad (2.1)$$

We claim

$$\forall \omega \in \Omega \quad |\mathcal{T}_n(\omega)| \leq |\partial \Lambda_n| = \mathcal{O}(n^{d-1}). \quad (2.2)$$

If we prove this we get a contradiction to (2.1) and can conclude the proof. To prove this claim fix $\omega \in \Omega$ and let $F_0 = \{e_1, \dots, e_n\}$ be the edges of $\bigcup_{x \in \mathcal{T}_n(\omega)} \mathcal{C}_x \cap \Lambda_n$. We will apply a peeling procedure as follows: Define iteratively

$$F_i := \begin{cases} F_{i-1} \setminus \{e_i\}, & \text{if } e_i \text{ belongs to a cycle in } F_{i-1}, \\ F_{i-1}, & \text{else} \end{cases} \quad \text{for } i = 1, \dots, n.$$

The resulting object F_n is a forest. From F_n remove repeatedly vertices that are not $\partial \Lambda_n$ and have degree one in the graph induced by F_n . Repeat this until no such vertex is left. To conclude we need the following simple lemma from graph theory:

Lemma 2.3. Let $\mathcal{G} = (\mathcal{V}, \mathcal{E})$ be a finite tree. Define

$$N_k := \{x \in \mathcal{V} : \deg(x) = k\}$$

$$N_{\geq k} = \{x \in \mathcal{V} : \deg(x) \geq k\}.$$

Then $|N_1| \geq 2 + |N_{\geq 3}| \geq |N_{\geq 3}|$.

After peeling $N_1 \subseteq \partial \Lambda_n$ and $N_{\geq 3} \supseteq \mathcal{T}_n$. So applying the above lemma to every component of the peeled forest yields

$$|\mathcal{T}_n| \leq |N_{\geq 3}| \leq |N_1| \leq |\partial \Lambda_n|.$$

This concludes the proof of the theorem. $\square$

Proof of Lemma 2.3. Observe that $|\mathcal{V}| = |\mathcal{E}| + 1$. Moreover,

$$2|\mathcal{E}| = \sum_{x \in \mathcal{V}} \deg(x) \geq |N_1| + 2|N_2| + 3|N_{\geq 3}|.$$

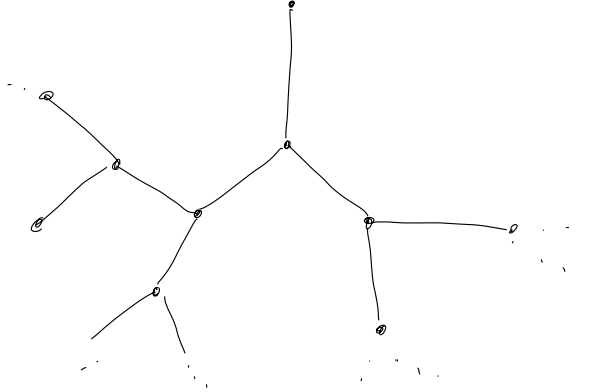
Also,

$$2|\mathcal{E}| = 2(|\mathcal{V}| - 1) = 2|N_1| + 2|N_2| + 2|N_{\geq 3}| - 2.$$

Subtract the equations:

$$|N_1| \geq |N_{\geq 3}| + 2. \quad \square$$

Percolation on $\mathbb{T}^d$. Let $\mathbb{T}^d$ denote an infinite tree where every vertex has degree 3.



Then one can prove that there exist $0 < p_1 < p_2 < 1$ such that

$$\mathbb{P}_p(N = 0) = 1, \quad \text{for } p < p_1$$

$$\mathbb{P}_p(N = \infty) = 1 \quad \text{for } p_1 < p < p_2$$

and

$$\mathbb{P}_p(N = 1) = 1, \quad \text{for } p > p_2.$$

The reason why the above proof does not work here is that the surface of the ball grows proportionally to the volume on $\mathbb{T}^d$.

2.1 Applications of the uniqueness of infinite clusters

We apply the uniqueness of infinite clusters to show several other interesting results. We start with a technical lemma. First for $k \in \{1, \dots, n\}$ define

$$K_{k,n} = \# \text{ of disjoint clusters in } \Lambda_n \text{ connecting } \partial\Lambda_n \text{ and } \partial\Lambda_k \quad \text{and} \\ U_{k,n} := \{K_{k,n} \leq 1\}.$$

[todo: Image in the lecture notes]

Remark. The event $U_{k,n}$ is neither decreasing nor increasing as an event. However, $\mathbb{P}_p(U_{k,n})$ is increasing in n and decreasing in k (Exercise: check this).

Lemma 2.4. For any $\varepsilon > 0$ and $k \in \mathbb{N}$ there exists $n = n(k, \varepsilon) < +\infty$ such that

$$\mathbb{P}_p(U_{k,n}) > 1 - \varepsilon, \quad \text{for any } p \in [0, 1].$$

2 Uniqueness of infinite clusters

Proof. Fix $\varepsilon > 0$, $k \in \mathbb{N}$. Define

$$O_n := \{p \in [0, 1] \mid \mathbb{P}_p(U_{k,n}) > 1 - \varepsilon\}$$

which is open in $[0, 1]$ because the map $p \mapsto \mathbb{P}_p(U_{k,n})$ is continuous as $U_{k,n}$ depends only on finitely many edges. Then $O_n \subseteq O_{n+1}$ by the last remark. By the uniqueness of the infinite cluster (that is if it exists) we have

$$\text{for any } p \in [0, 1] \text{ there exist } n(p) \geq k \text{ such that } \mathbb{P}_p(U_{k,n(p)}) > 1 - \varepsilon.$$

(If the above statement is not true one must have two infinite clusters). By this we have that

$$[0, 1] = \bigcup_{m \geq k} O_m$$

since $[0, 1]$ is compact so there exists a finite sub-covering $(O_{m_i})_{i=1}^{i_0}$. The claim then follows by taking $n = \max_{i=1, \dots, i_0} m_i$ (because O_n are increasing sets we then have $O_n = [0, 1]$). $\square$

Continuity of $\theta(p)$. We will show that $p \mapsto \theta(p)$ is continuous on $[0, 1] \setminus \{p_c\}$. Obviously θ is continuous on $[0, p_c)$ but the other part is shown by the following theorem.

Theorem 2.5. The map $p \mapsto \theta(p)$ is continuous on $(p_c, 1]$.

Proof. Define $\theta_n(p) := \mathbb{P}_p(0 \leftrightarrow \partial\Lambda_n)$. Since the event $0 \leftrightarrow \partial\Lambda_n$ depends only on finitely many edges θ_n is continuous. Also $\theta(p) = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \theta_n(p)$ (which is a decreasing limit) so $\theta(p)$ is upper semicontinuous and since θ is decreasing, θ is left continuous (we won't need this in the proof).

Fix $p_0 > p_c$ arbitrary. We will show that $\theta_n \rightarrow \theta$ uniformly on $(p_0, 1]$. To this end, fix $\varepsilon > 0$ and pick $k \in \mathbb{N}$ large such that $\mathbb{P}_p(\partial\Lambda_k \leftrightarrow \infty) > 1 - \varepsilon$. Also pick $n > k$ large such that $\mathbb{P}_p(U_{k,n}) > 1 - \varepsilon$ for any $p \in [0, 1]$. Then

$$\begin{aligned} \theta(p) &\geq \mathbb{P}_p(\{0 \leftrightarrow \partial\Lambda_n\} \cap \{\partial\Lambda_k \leftrightarrow \infty\} \cap U_{k,n}) \\ &\geq \mathbb{P}_p(0 \leftrightarrow \partial\Lambda_n) - 2\varepsilon. \end{aligned}$$

From this we obtain that $\theta_n(p) \geq \theta(p) \geq \theta_n(p) - 2\varepsilon$ which is true for any p . Thus θ_n converges uniformly on $(p_0, 1]$. This concludes the proof. $\square$

Box crossings.

Proposition 2.6. Let $p \in [0, 1]$ be such that $\theta(p) > 0$. Then

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow +\infty} \mathbb{P}_p(\exists \text{ path from left to right in } \Lambda_n) = 1.$$

[todo: Bild 15]

2 Uniqueness of infinite clusters

Proof. Let $\varepsilon > 0$ and pick k large such that $\mathbb{P}_p(\Lambda_k \leftrightarrow \infty) \geq 1 - \varepsilon$. (possible because we are in the supercritical phase). Then for any $k \geq n$,

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbb{P}_p(\Lambda_k \leftrightarrow \partial\Lambda_n) &= \mathbb{P}_p([\text{todo : Bild 16}]) \\ &\geq 1 - \varepsilon.\end{aligned}$$

By the square root trick this implies that [\[todo: Bild 17\]](#)

[\[todo: Bild 18\]](#)

□

3 Subcritical phase

Since $\theta(p) = 0$ for $p < p_c$ we know by the above proof that $\theta_n(p) \searrow 0$ for $p < p_c$. However, we know nothing about the speed of this convergence.

Theorem 3.1 (Menshikov, 1987, Aizenmann-Busky, 1987). The following two statements hold:

1. For any $p < p_c$ there exists $c = c(p)$ such that

$$\mathbb{P}_p(0 \leftrightarrow \partial\Lambda_n) \leq e^{-cn} \quad \text{for all } n \in \mathbb{N}$$

2. For all $p > p_c$ we have the *mean field lower bound*

$$\theta(p) \geq \frac{1}{2}(p - p_c).$$

From this one deduces the following corollary whose proof is left as an exercise to the reader.

Corollary 3.2. For any $p < p_c$ we have

$$\chi(p) := \mathbb{E}_p[\#\{x : x \leftrightarrow 0\}] < +\infty$$

Remark. Historically, people studied

$$p'_c = \inf\{p \in [0, 1] : \chi(p) = +\infty\}$$

The previous theorem implies that $p'_c = p_c$ (show this as an exercise).

The proof we are presenting is due to H. Dummil-Copin and V. Tassion. We first need a few definitions and lemmas.

Definition 3.3. Let $S \subseteq \mathbb{Z}^d$ be a finite set with $0 \in S$. We define

$$\varphi_p(S) := p \sum_{\{x,y\} \in \Delta S} \mathbb{P}_p(0 \overset{S}{\leftrightarrow} x).$$

If $0 \notin S$ we set $\varphi_p(S) = 0$.

3 Subcritical phase

Remark. Note that the event " $\{x, y\}$ is open" is independent of $0 \xleftrightarrow{S} x$ for all $\{x, y\} \in \Delta S$ and has probability p . This implies that

$$\begin{aligned}\varphi_p(S) &= \sum_{\{x,y\} \in \Delta S} \mathbb{P}_p(\{x, y\} \text{ open}, 0 \xleftrightarrow{S} x) \\ &= \mathbb{E}_p[\text{number of edges in } \Delta S \text{ connected to } 0].\end{aligned}$$

Lemma 3.4. Suppose there is a finite set $S \subseteq \mathbb{Z}^d$ with $0 \in S$ and $\varphi_p(S) < 1$. Then there exists $c = c(p)$ such that

$$\theta_n(p) < e^{-cn} \quad \text{for all } n \in \mathbb{N}.$$

Proof. Assume we have such S . Fix $k \in \mathbb{N}$ such that $S \subseteq \Lambda_k$. If $\{0 \leftrightarrow \partial\Lambda_{n \cdot k}\}$ occurs then there exists an edge $\{x, y\} \in \Delta S$ such that

$$0 \xleftrightarrow{S} x, \quad \{x, y\} \text{ is open and } y \leftrightarrow \partial\Lambda_{n \cdot k},$$

which are all events occuring disjointly. Now, using van-de Berg/Kesten inequality (Theorem 1.21),

$$\begin{aligned}\theta_{nk}(p) &= \mathbb{P}_p(0 \leftrightarrow \partial\Lambda_{nk}) \\ &\leq \sum_{xy \in \Delta S} \mathbb{P}_p(\{x \xleftrightarrow{S} 0\} \circ \{xy \text{ open}\} \circ \{y \leftrightarrow \partial\Lambda_{nk}\}) \\ &\leq \sum_{xy} \mathbb{P}_p(0 \xleftrightarrow{S} x, xy \text{ open}) \underbrace{\mathbb{P}_p(y \leftrightarrow \partial\Lambda_{nk})}_{\leq \mathbb{P}_p(y \leftrightarrow \partial(y + \Lambda_{(n-1)k})) = \mathbb{P}_p(0 \leftrightarrow \partial\Lambda_{(n-1)k})} \\ &\leq \underbrace{\varphi_p(S)}_{< 1} \mathbb{P}_p(0 \leftrightarrow \partial\Lambda_{(n-1)k}).\end{aligned}$$

Iterate this to get the exponential decay. □

First we need another lemma:

Lemma 3.5. Let $\mathcal{S}_n := \{x \in \Lambda_n \mid x \not\leftrightarrow \partial\Lambda_n\}$. Then

$$\theta'_n(p) = \frac{1}{p(1-p)} \mathbb{E}_p[\varphi_p(\mathcal{S}_n)] \quad \text{for all } p \in [0, 1], n \in \mathbb{N}.$$

Proof. Define $\mathcal{E}_n := \{\{x, y\} \mid x, y \in \Lambda_n\}$ and $A := \{0 \leftrightarrow \partial\Lambda_n\}$. Note that $\omega(e)$ and the event " e is pivotal for A " are independent. Using Russo's formula (Theorem ??) we find

$$\begin{aligned}\theta'_n(p) &= \sum_{e \in \mathcal{E}_n} \mathbb{P}_p(e \text{ is pivotal for } A) \\ &= \frac{1}{1-p} \sum_{e \in \mathcal{E}_n} \mathbb{P}_p(e \text{ is closed}, e \text{ is pivotal for } A) \\ &= \frac{1}{1-p} \sum_{e \in \mathcal{E}_n} \mathbb{P}_p(A^c \cap \{e \text{ is pivotal for } A\}) = \dots\end{aligned}$$

3 Subcritical phase

Now, note that $A^c = \{0 \in \mathcal{S}_n\} = \bigcup_{S \subseteq \Delta_n, 0 \in S} \{\mathcal{S}_n = S\}$, thus

$$\dots = \frac{1}{1-p} \sum_{\substack{S \subseteq \Delta_n \\ \bar{S} \ni 0}} \sum_{e \in \mathcal{E}_n} \mathbb{P}_p(\mathcal{S}_n = S, e \text{ pivotal for } A).$$

If e is pivotal for A in ω and closed if and only if

- one of the endpoints of e is connected to 0,
- the other endpoint one is connected to $\partial\Lambda_n$ and
- 0 is not connected to $\partial\Lambda_n$ in the configuration ω_e , where $\omega_e(f) = \omega(e)\mathbf{1}_{e \neq f}$.

On the other hand on $\{\mathcal{S}_n = S\}$, e is pivotal for A in ω if and only if

- $e \in \Delta S$ and
- one vertex is connected to 0 in S .

We deduce that

$$\begin{aligned} \theta'_n(p) &= \frac{1}{1-p} \sum_{\substack{S \subseteq \Delta_n \\ \bar{S} \ni 0}} \sum_{\{x,y\} \in \Delta S} \mathbb{P}_p(0 \xleftrightarrow{S} x, \mathcal{S}_n = S) \\ &= \frac{1}{1-p} \sum_{\substack{S \subseteq \Delta_n \\ \bar{S} \ni 0}} \sum_{\{x,y\} \in \Delta S} \mathbb{P}_p(0 \xleftrightarrow{S} x) \mathbb{P}_p(\mathcal{S}_n = S) \\ &= \frac{1}{1-p} \mathbb{E}_p \left[\frac{1}{p} \varphi_p(\mathcal{S}_n) \right] \end{aligned}$$

This concludes the proof of the lemma. $\square$

Proof of Theorem 3.1. We will show that

$$\tilde{p}_c := \sup \left\{ p \in [0, 1] \mid \exists S \subseteq \mathbb{Z}^d \text{ finite}, 0 \in S \text{ s.t. } \varphi_p(S) < 1 \right\} = p_c.$$

To this end, note first that Lemma 3.4 gives us that $\tilde{p}_c \leq p_c$ by letting $n \rightarrow +\infty$. To show the reverse inequality, fix $p > \tilde{p}_c$. If $\theta_n(p) \geq \frac{1}{2}$ we trivially deduce $\theta_n(p) \geq \frac{1}{2}(p - \tilde{p}_c)$. Otherwise we have $\theta_n(q) < \frac{1}{2}$ for all $q \in [\tilde{p}_c, p]$. Using Lemma 3.5,

$$\theta'_n(q) = \underbrace{\frac{1}{q(1-q)}}_{\geq 1} \mathbb{E}_q[\varphi_p(\mathcal{S}_n)] \geq \mathbb{E}_q[\mathbf{1}_{0 \in \mathcal{S}_n}] = \mathbb{P}_q(0 \in \mathcal{S}_n) = 1 - \theta_n(q)$$

and thus

$$\theta_n(p) \geq \frac{1}{2}(p - \tilde{p}_c)$$

Taking $n \rightarrow +\infty$ we deduce for any $p > \tilde{p}_c$,

$$\theta(p) \geq \frac{1}{2}(p - \tilde{p}_c) > 0$$

and thus $p_c \leq \tilde{p}_c$. This concludes the proof. $\square$

3 Subcritical phase

(5.4) Thm (a) $\Theta_n(p) = \mathbb{P}_p(0 \leftrightarrow \partial\Delta_n)$ decays exponentially in n $\forall p < p_c$

(b) $\forall p > p_c: \Theta(p) \geq \frac{1}{2}(p - p_c)$

(5.6) Lem If $\exists S \subseteq \mathbb{Z}^d$ finite, $0 \in S$, $\varphi_S(p) < 1$ then $\forall n$ $\Theta_n(p) < e^{-cn}$

Define $\tilde{p}_c := \sup \{p \mid \varphi_S(p) < 1\}$. Goal: prove $\tilde{p}_c = p_c$ (actually we only need " $\geq$ ")

First we need another lemma:

(5.7) Lem Let $\mathcal{I}_n := \{x \in \Delta_n \mid x \leftrightarrow \partial\Delta_n\}$. Then

$$\Theta'_n(p) \geq \frac{1}{p(1-p)} \mathbb{E}_p \left[\varphi_p(\mathcal{I}_n) \right] \quad \forall p \in [0, 1], \forall n \in \mathbb{N}.$$

pf: Define $E_n := \{ \{x, y\} \mid x, y \in \Delta_n \}$, $A := \{0 \leftrightarrow \partial\Delta_n\}$. By Russo,

$$\Theta'_n(p) = \sum_{e \in E_n} \mathbb{P}_p(e \text{ is pivotal for } A) \quad \text{Note } w(e) \perp e \text{ pivotal}$$

$$= \sum_e \frac{1}{1-p} \mathbb{P}_p(\underbrace{e \text{ is closed, } e \text{ pivotal for } A}_{\substack{\text{independent} \\ \downarrow \\ = \mathbb{P}_p(A^c \cap \{e \text{ pivotal for } A\})}}) = \dots$$

Note that $A^c = \{0 \notin \mathcal{I}_n\} = \bigcup_{\substack{S \subseteq \Delta_n \\ 0 \notin S}} \{\mathcal{I}_n = S\}$ so

$$\dots = \frac{1}{1-p} \sum_{\substack{S \subseteq \Delta_n \\ 0 \notin S}} \sum_{e \in E_n} \mathbb{P}_p(e \text{ pivotal for } A, \mathcal{I}_n = S)$$

If e is pivotal for A in ω then

-) one of the vertices of e is connected to 0
-) the other one is connected to Δ_n
-) there is no connection of $0, \partial\Delta_n$ in ω_e .

On $\mathcal{I}_n = S$, e is pivotal iff

-) $e \in \Delta \mathcal{I}_n$

3 Subcritical phase

•) one vertex of e must be connected to 0 in S .

$$\Rightarrow \Theta_n'(p) = \frac{1}{1-p} \sum_{S \in \Delta_n} \sum_{\substack{x, y \in \Delta S \\ 0 \in S}} \mathbb{P}_p(0 \leftrightarrow x, \mathcal{I}^n = S)$$

$G(w(e), e = \{x, y\})$ at least one of x, y is in S
 $\in G(w(e), e = \{x, y\}, x, y \in S)$ independent!

$$= \frac{1}{1-p} \sum_{S \in \Delta_n} \underbrace{\sum_{\substack{x, y \in \Delta S \\ 0 \in S}} \mathbb{P}_p(0 \leftrightarrow x)}_{= \frac{1}{p} \varphi_p(S)} \mathbb{P}_p(\mathcal{I}^n = S)$$

$$= \frac{1}{p(1-p)} \mathbb{E}_p[\varphi_p(\mathcal{I}^n)].$$

Proof of (5.4). $\forall p > p_c, \forall n \in \mathbb{N}$

$$\Theta_n'(p) \geq \underbrace{\frac{1}{p(1-p)}}_{\geq 1} \mathbb{E}_p[\underbrace{\varphi_p(\mathcal{I}^n)}_{\geq 1 \text{ if } 0 \in \mathcal{I}^n}] \geq \mathbb{P}_p(0 \in \mathcal{I}^n) = 1 - \Theta_n(p)$$

Fix $p > \tilde{p}_c$. If $\Theta_n(p) \geq \frac{1}{2}$ then $\Theta_n(p) \geq \frac{1}{2}(p - \tilde{p}_c)$. If

$\Theta_n(p) < \frac{1}{2}$ then $\Theta_n(q) < \frac{1}{2} \forall q \in [\tilde{p}_c, p]$

$$\begin{aligned} \Rightarrow \forall q \in [\tilde{p}_c, p]: \Theta_n'(q) &\geq \frac{1}{2} \\ \xRightarrow{\text{integrate}} \Theta_n(p) &\geq \frac{1}{2}(p - \tilde{p}_c) \\ \xrightarrow{n \rightarrow +\infty} \Theta(p) &\geq \frac{1}{2}(p - \tilde{p}_c). \end{aligned}$$

so $\forall p > \tilde{p}_c \exists$ a.s. an infinite cluster $\Rightarrow \tilde{p}_c \geq p_c$.

$\tilde{p}_c > p_c$ is not possible because if there's a p between them this p has exponential decay $\Rightarrow \Theta(p) = 0$. $\square$

Corollary Penberg: we know $p^n \leq \Theta_n(p) \leq e^{-cn}$. Can we prove

$$\Theta_n(p) \sim e^{-cn}$$

(6.1) Prop $e_1 = (1, 0, 0, \dots, 0)$. Consider $\left(\lim_{n \rightarrow +\infty} \frac{1}{n} \log \mathbb{P}_p(0 \leftrightarrow ne_1) \right)^{1/n} =: \xi(p, d)$: correlation length

3 Subcritical phase

this quantity is well defined and $< +\infty$. This basically says

$$\mathbb{P}_p(0 \leftrightarrow n e_1) = e^{-\frac{n}{2}(1+o(1))}$$

Fekete's lemma $(u_n)_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \subseteq [-\infty, +\infty)$ $u_{n+m} \leq u_n + u_m$ (sub-additivity)

$$\Rightarrow \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \frac{u_n}{n} = \inf_n \frac{u_n}{n}.$$

Pf of (6.1) $\mathbb{P}_p(0 \leftrightarrow (n+m)e_1) \geq \mathbb{P}_p(0 \leftrightarrow m e_1, m \leftrightarrow (n+m)e_1)$

FKG
+ translation
invariance

$$\geq \mathbb{P}_p(0 \leftrightarrow m e_1) \mathbb{P}_p(0 \leftrightarrow n e_1)$$

Define $u_m = -\log \mathbb{P}_p(0 \leftrightarrow m e_1)$ and the result follows by Fekete. ■

ξ is kinda the largest expected local cluster "radius".

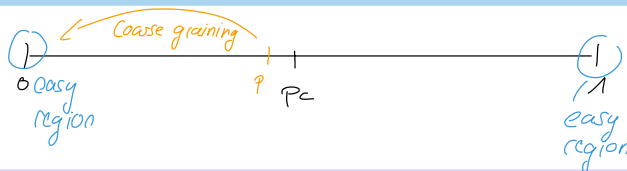
Exponential decay for volume

$$C_0 = \{x : x \leftrightarrow 0\}, \quad \mathbb{P}_p(|C_0| \geq n) = ?$$

$$|C_0| \geq n \Rightarrow \text{diam}_{\ell^\infty} C_0 \geq n^{1/d}$$

$$(5.4) \Rightarrow \mathbb{P}_p(|C_0| \geq n) \leq e^{-c n^{1/d}}$$

(6.3) Thm $p < p_c$. $\exists c = c(p, d) > 0$ s.t. $\mathbb{P}_p(|C_0| \geq n) = e^{-cn}$.



(6.4) Lemma Set $\mathcal{d}_n := \{C \subseteq \mathbb{Z}^d \mid 0 \in C, C \text{ connected}, |C| = n\}$

(lattice animals). $|\mathcal{d}_n| \leq 16^{dn}$

Pf As on Exo 4(b). (by hardcore combinatorics) ■

Pf of (6.3) Fix k large s.t. $\mathbb{P}_p(\Lambda_k \leftrightarrow \partial \Lambda_{2k}) \leq \left(\frac{1}{16^d e}\right)^{k^{d-1}}$

3 Subcritical phase

(possible because of exponential decay)

Define $G_k := (V_k, E_k)$, $V_k = 2k \mathbb{Z}^d$, $E_k = \{ \{2kx, 2ky\} : \|x-y\|_1 = 1 \}$
 For $u \in V_k$, $\eta(u) := \begin{cases} 1 & \text{if } u \in \Lambda_k(u) \\ 0 & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$
 where $\Lambda_k(u) \longleftrightarrow 2\Lambda_{2k}(u)$ is a box centered at u .

By translation invariance, $\mathbb{P}_p(\eta(u)=1) \leq \left(\frac{1}{16^d} e\right)^{\frac{1}{3^d}}$. Problem: $\eta(u)$'s are not independent.

• $\|u-w\|_\infty \geq 4k \Rightarrow \text{int } \Lambda_{2k}(u) \cap \text{int } \Lambda_{2k}(w) = \emptyset \Rightarrow \eta(u) \perp \eta(w)$.

$\bar{C}_0(w) := \{u \in V_k \mid C_0 \cap \Lambda_k(w) \neq \emptyset\}$

- $|C_0| \leq |\Lambda_k| |\bar{C}_0|$
- $|\bar{C}|$ is connected in G_k

$\forall \bar{C} \subseteq V_k$ there are $v_1, \dots, v_n \in V_k \setminus \bar{C}$ s.t.

- $m \geq \frac{|\bar{C}|}{3^d}$
- $i \neq j \Rightarrow \|v_i - v_j\|_\infty \geq 4k$.

For $|\bar{C}| \geq 2$

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbb{P}_p[\bar{C}_0 = \bar{C}] &\leq \mathbb{P}_p[\forall n \in \bar{C} : \eta(u)=1] \leq \mathbb{P}_p[\underbrace{\forall i \leq n : \eta(v_i)=1}_{\text{independent}}] \\ &= \prod_{i=1}^n \mathbb{P}_p(\eta(v_i)=1) = \mathbb{P}_p(\eta(v_1)=1)^n \leq \left(\left(\frac{1}{16^d} e\right)^{\frac{1}{3^d}}\right)^n \\ &\leq 16^{-d|\bar{C}|} e^{-|\bar{C}|} \end{aligned}$$

For $n \geq 2|\Lambda_k|$

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbb{P}_p(|C_0| \geq n) &\leq \mathbb{P}_p(|\bar{C}_0| \geq \frac{n}{|\Lambda_k|}) \\ &= \sum_{N \geq \frac{n}{|\Lambda_k|}} \sum_{\substack{\bar{C} : \bar{C} \ni 0 \\ |\Lambda_k| |\bar{C}| = N}} \mathbb{P}_p(\bar{C}_0 = \bar{C}) = \sum_N \underbrace{|\mathcal{C}_N|}_{\leq 16^{dN}} \cdot 16^{-dN} e^{-N} \end{aligned}$$

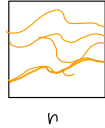
[todo: Lecture 07]

3 Subcritical phase

Continuation of the proof of thm (7.4):

Case 2: $\mathbb{P}_p\left(\left[\square_n\right]_n\right) \geq 1 - (1-x)^{1/3}$

Consider

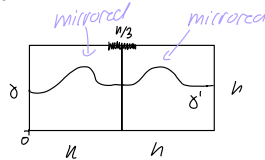


and let Γ' denote the lowest crossing of $^n [0, n]^2 \cap \mathbb{Z}^2$ and $\Gamma' = \emptyset$ if there is no crossing. (Note Γ' is well defined) because we are in 2d think about it!

If γ is a (possibly closed!) L-R-path, the event $\{\Gamma' = \gamma\}$ is measurable (because it depends on finitely many edges)

$$\mathcal{R}(\gamma) := \{e \text{ edge in } [0, n]^2 \mid e \subseteq \gamma \text{ or below } \gamma\}$$

Fix such γ .



$$E_\gamma := \left\{ \left[\frac{\gamma_n}{6}, \frac{\gamma_n}{6} \right] \times \{n\} \right\} \longleftrightarrow \gamma \text{ in } \left[\frac{n}{2}, \frac{3n}{2} \right] \times [0, n] \text{ above } \gamma \cup \gamma'$$

$$E_{\gamma'} := \text{---} \gamma' \text{---}$$

Observe that $E_\gamma, E_{\gamma'} \perp \{\Gamma' = \gamma\}$ and

$$\mathbb{P}_p(E_\gamma \cup E_{\gamma'}) \geq \mathbb{P}_p\left(\left[\square_n\right]_n\right) \geq 1 - (1-x)^{1/3}$$

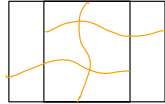
By square root trick: $\mathbb{P}_p(E_\gamma) = \mathbb{P}_p(E_{\gamma'}) \geq 1 - (1-x)^{1/2}$

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbb{P}_p\left(\left[\square_n\right]_n\right) &\geq \sum_{\gamma \text{ LR crossings of } [0, n]^2} \mathbb{P}_p\left(\Gamma' = \gamma, \underbrace{\left[\square_n\right]_n}_{\geq E_\gamma}\right) \\ &\geq \sum_{\gamma} \underbrace{\mathbb{P}_p(\Gamma' = \gamma)}_{\mathbb{P}_p\left(\left[\square_n\right]_n\right) - x} \underbrace{\mathbb{P}_p(E_\gamma)}_{\geq 1 - (1-x)^{1/2}} \\ &\geq 1 - (1-x)^{1/2} \end{aligned}$$

3 Subcritical phase

$$\mathbb{P}_p \left(\left[\text{diagram} \right]_n \right) \geq \mathbb{P}_p \left(\left[\text{diagram} \right] \cap \left[\text{diagram} \right] \right)$$

$$\stackrel{\text{FKG}}{\geq} \left(x(1-(1-x)^{1/2}) \right)^2 =: y$$



To force connection in overlapping rectangle

We need: L-R connection in both and

T-B connection in intersection

$$\text{FKG: } \mathbb{P}_p \left(\left[\text{diagram} \right]_n \right) \geq y^2 x.$$

$\frac{5n/3}{\text{diagram}}$

→ iterate this $\Rightarrow$ Result.



Critical behaviour in $d=2$:

Here always $\phi = \phi_c(2^2) = \frac{1}{2}$, we write $\mathbb{P}$ for $\mathbb{P}_{\frac{1}{2}}$.

(8.1) Theorem: There is $c > 0$ s.t.
 $\forall n \geq 1 \quad c \leq \mathbb{P} \left(\text{red path in } \square_n \right) \leq \mathbb{P} \left(\text{red path in } \square_{3n} \right) \leq 1-c$

Proof: • first inequality: (7.3) $\Rightarrow x := \mathbb{P} \left(\text{red path in } \square_n \right) \geq \frac{1}{2}$.
 $\xrightarrow{\text{RSW}} \mathbb{P} \left(\text{red path in } \square_{3n} \right) \geq c > 0$.

• 2nd inequality: trivial

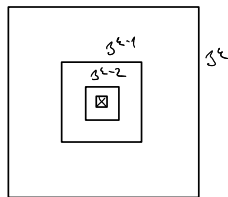
• 3rd - 4th: $\mathbb{P} \left(\text{red path in } \square_{3n} \right) \stackrel{\text{duality}}{=} 1 - \mathbb{P} \left(\text{blue path in } \square_{3n+1} \right) \leq 1 - c' < 1$
 no connection LR similarly to 1st ineq. $\Rightarrow$ T-B connection in dual $\square$

(8.1) Corollary [Upper bound on 1-arm probability]
 $\forall n \geq 1 \quad \Theta_n(\frac{1}{2}) = \mathbb{P}(0 \leftrightarrow \partial \square_n) \leq \frac{1}{n^c}$

Proof: $\mathbb{P} \left(\text{blue path in } \square_{3n} \right) \geq \mathbb{P} \left(\text{blue path in } \square_{3n} \text{ with } \square_n \text{ inside} \right) \stackrel{\text{FKG}}{\geq} c^4 =: c_0$
 (8.1)

Hence $\mathbb{P} \left(\text{red path in } \square_{3n} \right) = 1 - \mathbb{P} \left(\text{blue path in } \square_{3n} \right) \leq 1 - c_0$.

Further: $\mathbb{P}(0 \leftrightarrow \partial \square_{3^k}) \leq \mathbb{P} \left(\bigcap_{i=0}^{k-1} \{ \partial \square_{3^i} \leftrightarrow \partial \square_{3^{i+1}} \} \right)$
 independent over i
 $= (1 - c_0)^k$



Choose $k = \lfloor \log_3 n \rfloor$ for $n \geq 3$. This finishes the proof $\square$

3 Subcritical phase

8/2

(8.3) Conjecture $\exists c \in (0, \infty)$ s.t. $\Theta_n(p) \sim \frac{c}{n^{5/48}}$

Rem: The exponent $n^{5/48}$ should not depend on 2-dim. lattice
It has been proved only for site percolation on triangular lattice.

Rem: It is easy to see that $\Theta_n(p) \geq \frac{1}{2n}$
 $(nP(0 \leftrightarrow \partial I_n) \geq P(\text{red box}_{n-1}) = \frac{1}{2})$

here $p_c^{\text{site}}(\mathbb{T}) = 1/2$ due to Smirnov

Remark on critical exponents:

It is believed that many properties of percolation models at the criticality or near the criticality should be "universal", that is should not depend on the lattice/model details, but on the dimension d . (The value p_c of course depend on the model/lattice)

E.g. one expects:

$\Theta(p) \asymp (p - p_c)^{\beta}$ (β) - only dependent on d $p \downarrow p_c$
 $\chi(p) := E_p(|C_0|_{|C_0| < \infty}) \asymp |p - p_c|^{-\gamma}$ $p \rightarrow p_c$
 $\kappa(p) := E_p(|C_0|^{-1})$ $\kappa''(p) \asymp |p - p_c|^{-1-\alpha}$ $p \rightarrow p_c$
 $\xi(p) = \text{corr. length} \asymp |p - p_c|^{-\nu}$ $p \rightarrow p_c$
 $P_{p_c}(|C| = n) \asymp n^{-1-\frac{1}{\delta}}$ $n \rightarrow \infty$
 $P_{p_c}(0 \leftrightarrow \partial I_n) \asymp n^{-1-\frac{1}{\beta}}$ $n \rightarrow \infty$
 $P_{p_c}(0 \leftrightarrow x) \asymp |x|^{2-d-\eta}$ $|x| \rightarrow \infty$

- Their existence is mostly proved for $d \geq 11$ (or more)
or in $d=2$ on triangular lattice.
- They are expected* to satisfy various relations: * or proved (assuming existence)
 $\gamma = \nu(2-\xi)$; $d\xi = \delta+1$; $d\nu = 2-d$, ...
- For $d \geq 1$ they agree with exponents on trees, can be computed
 $\alpha = -1, \beta = 1, \gamma = 1, \delta = 2, \xi = \frac{1}{2}, \eta = 0, \nu = \frac{1}{2}$.
 (see Grimmett, Chapters 9-10)

3 Subcritical phase

8/3

(8.4) Corollary: (A universal arm exponent) There is $c \in (0,1)$ s.t.

$$\forall n \geq 1 \quad c \frac{1}{n} \leq \mathbb{P} \left(\begin{array}{c} \text{Diagram: A square with side length } n. \text{ The bottom boundary is at } y=0. \text{ The left boundary is at } x=-n/2. \text{ The right boundary is at } x=n/2. \text{ A green path starts at } (-n/2, 0) \text{ and goes up. A red path starts at } (n/2, 0) \text{ and goes up. The paths are disjoint.} \end{array} \right) \leq \frac{1}{c} \frac{1}{n}$$

Proof sketch:

$$A_x = \left\{ \begin{array}{c} \text{Diagram: A square with side length } 3n. \text{ The bottom boundary is at } y=0. \text{ The left boundary is at } x=-3n. \text{ The right boundary is at } x=3n. \text{ A green path starts at } (x, 0) \text{ and goes up. A red path starts at } (x, 0) \text{ and goes up. The paths are disjoint.} \end{array} \right\}$$

Lower bound: $\frac{1}{4} \stackrel{\text{indep}}{\leq} \mathbb{P} \left(\begin{array}{c} \text{Diagram: Two squares of side length } 3n. \text{ The left square has a green path starting at } (-3n, 0) \text{ and going up. The right square has a red path starting at } (3n, 0) \text{ and going up.} \end{array} \right)$

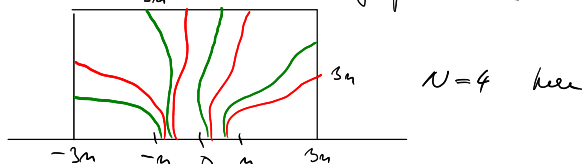
union bound $\leq \sum_{|x| \leq 3n} \mathbb{P}(A_x) \stackrel{\text{inv.}}{=} (6n+1) \mathbb{P}(A_0)$

$\Rightarrow \mathbb{P} \left(\begin{array}{c} \text{Diagram: A square with side length } n. \text{ The bottom boundary is at } y=0. \text{ The left boundary is at } x=-n/2. \text{ The right boundary is at } x=n/2. \text{ A green path starts at } (-n/2, 0) \text{ and goes up. A red path starts at } (n/2, 0) \text{ and goes up. The paths are disjoint.} \end{array} \right) \geq \mathbb{P}(A_0) \geq \frac{c}{n}.$

** Consider the leftmost and the rightmost*

translation invariance

Upper bound: $N := \#$ disjoint open paths from $[-n, n] \times \{0\}$ to $\partial 1_{3n}$ in the half plane $\{\mathbb{R} \times [0, \infty)\} \cap \mathbb{Z}^2$.



Observe: $\sum_{|x| \leq n} \mathbb{1}_{A_x} \leq N.$

Hence: $(2n+1) \mathbb{P}(A_0) \leq \mathbb{E}[N] = \sum_{k \geq 0} \mathbb{P}(N \geq k)$

$$= \sum_{k \geq 0} \mathbb{P} \left(\underbrace{(N \geq 1) \circ (N \geq 1) \circ \dots \circ (N \geq 1)}_{k\text{-times}} \right)$$

$$\stackrel{\text{BK}}{\leq} \sum_{k \geq 0} \mathbb{P}(N \geq 1)^k = \frac{1}{1 - \mathbb{P}(N \geq 1)} = \frac{1}{1 - \mathbb{P} \left(\begin{array}{c} \text{Diagram: A square with side length } n. \text{ The bottom boundary is at } y=0. \text{ The left boundary is at } x=-n/2. \text{ The right boundary is at } x=n/2. \text{ A green path starts at } (-n/2, 0) \text{ and goes up. A red path starts at } (n/2, 0) \text{ and goes up. The paths are disjoint.} \end{array} \right)} \leq \frac{1}{c}$$

$$\Rightarrow \mathbb{P}(A_0) \leq \frac{c}{n} \quad \square$$

^{the proof}
We will skip this in the lectures

8/4

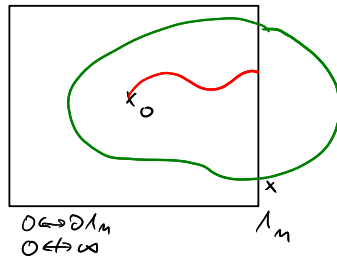
Supercritical behaviour in $d=2$

key observation: $p > p_c(\mathbb{Z}^2) \rightarrow 1-p < p_c(\mathbb{Z}^{2*})$
 $\forall p > p_c \quad \forall x \in \mathbb{Z}^{2*} \quad \mathbb{P}\left(\boxed{x} \xleftrightarrow{2n}\right) \leq e^{-c_n}$

(3.5) Theorem: (Exp. decay of radius of a finite cluster)
 Let $p \in (p_c, 1)$. There are constants $0 < c_1 < c_0$ s.t.
 $e^{-c_0 n} \leq \mathbb{P}_p(0 \leftrightarrow \partial \Lambda_n, 0 \nleftrightarrow \infty) \leq e^{-c_1 n}$

Proof: LB: $\mathbb{P}_p(0 \leftrightarrow \partial \Lambda_n, 0 \nleftrightarrow \infty) \geq \mathbb{P}_p\left(\boxed{0} \xleftrightarrow{2(n+1)+2} n\right)$
 $\geq p^{(n+1)+2} (1-p)^{2(n+1)+2} \geq e^{-c_0 n}$

UB:



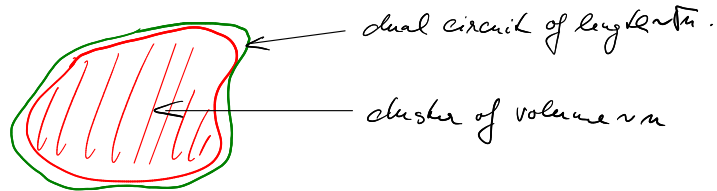
$\mathbb{P}_p(0 \leftrightarrow \partial \Lambda_n, 0 \nleftrightarrow \infty)$
 $\leq \mathbb{P}_p(\exists \text{ dual open circuit intersecting } \partial \Lambda_n \text{ of diameter } \geq n)$
 $\leq \mathbb{P}_p(\exists x \in \partial \Lambda_n: x \xleftrightarrow{>n} \partial \Lambda_n^c(x))$
 $\leq c n e^{-c n} \leq e^{-c_1 n} \text{ for } n \text{ large} \quad \square$

(3.6) Theorem: [Stretched exp. decay of volume]

Let $p \in (p_c, 1)$

$$\forall n \geq 1 \quad e^{-c_0 \sqrt{n}} \leq \mathbb{P}_p(n \leq |C_0| < \infty) \leq e^{-c_1 \sqrt{n}}$$

Idea:



Proof: Upper bound: $|C_0| \geq n \Rightarrow 0 \leftrightarrow \partial \Lambda_{\frac{\sqrt{n}}{3}}$

$$\mathbb{P}(n \leq |C_0| < \infty) \leq \mathbb{P}(0 \leftrightarrow \partial \Lambda_{\frac{\sqrt{n}}{3}}) \leq e^{-c_1 \sqrt{n}}$$

Lower bound Set $k = \lceil \frac{4n}{\theta(p)} \rceil$, $N = \sum_{x \in I_k} 1_{x \leftrightarrow \partial I_k}$. Then

$$E_p(N) = \sum_{x \in I_k} P_p(x \leftrightarrow \partial I_k) \geq |I_k| \cdot \theta(p)$$

Hence

$$P\left(\underbrace{|I_k| - N}_{\geq 0} \geq (1 - \frac{\theta(p)}{2})|I_k|\right) \stackrel{\text{Markov}}{\leq} \frac{1 - \theta(p)}{1 - \frac{\theta(p)}{2}} \leq 1 - \frac{\theta(p)}{2}.$$

$$E(\cdot) \leq |I_k|(1 - \theta(p))$$

and thus $P_p(N \geq \frac{\theta(p)}{2}|I_k|) \geq \frac{\theta(p)}{2}$

Now let $F = \left\{ \begin{array}{c} \text{grid} \\ I_k \end{array} \right\}$

$$P_p(F) = p^{|I_k|} (1-p)^{|I_k|} \geq e^{-ck}$$

Hence

$$P_p(|C_0| \geq n) \geq P_p(|C_0| \geq \frac{\theta(p)}{2}|I_k|) \geq \frac{4n}{\theta(p)} \text{ by def of } k.$$

$$\begin{aligned} &\geq P_p(0 \leftrightarrow \partial I_k, N \geq \frac{\theta(p)}{2}|I_k|, F) \\ &\stackrel{\text{indep}}{=} P_p(F) P_p(0 \leftrightarrow \partial I_k, N \geq \frac{\theta(p)}{2}|I_k|) \\ &\stackrel{F \in \mathcal{C}}{\geq} e^{-ck} \cdot \theta(p) \cdot \theta(p)/2 \geq e^{-4\sqrt{k}} \quad \square \end{aligned}$$

CONFORMAL INVARIANCE OF CRITICAL PERCOLATION (2D)

Motivation: We know $\forall k \geq 1 \exists 0 < c_1(k) < c_2(k) < 1$.

$$C_1(k) \leq P_{pc} \left(\underbrace{\hspace{1.5cm}}_{km} \right) \leq C_2(k)$$

Conclusion:

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} P_{P_C} \left(\underbrace{\quad}_{L_n} \right) = c(c) \text{ exists.}$$

Actually, more is conjectured to be true $\rightarrow$ conformal invariance

History: - Conjectured in physics literature in 1992, confirmed by numerics.

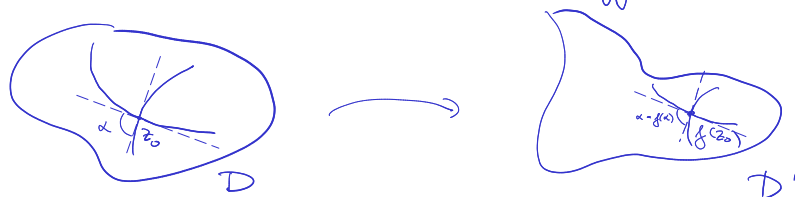
- A "formula" (see below) proposed by Cady (1992)
- Proved by Smirnov (2001) on triangular lattice

Short excursion to complex analysis

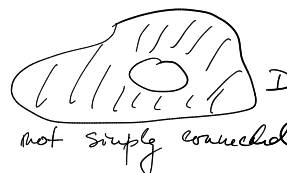
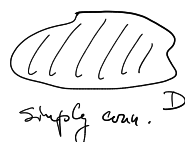
- Domain = non-empty connected open subset of $\mathbb{C}$
- For D, D' domains, conformal map from D to $D' =$
 $=$ bijection $f: D \rightarrow D'$, analytic on D , $\forall z \in D \quad f'(z) \neq 0$.
 (consequence: the inversion $f^{-1}: D' \rightarrow D$ is analytic on D')

Recall: f is analytic $\rightarrow \forall z_0 \in D$ $f(z) = f(z_0) + \underbrace{f'(z_0)}_{\substack{\text{translation} \\ \text{rotation + scaling}}}(z - z_0) + \dots$

$\rightarrow f$ preserves angles $\rightarrow$ terminology "conformal"



- D domain is Simply Connected if D and $\mathbb{C} \setminus D$ are connected
 $\iff D$ "has no holes"



CONFORMAL INVARIANCE OF CRITICAL PERCOLATION (2D)

Motivation: We know $k \geq 1 \implies 0 < c_1(k) < c_2(k) < 1$.

$$C_1(k) \leq P_{pc} \left(\underbrace{\hspace{1.5cm}}_{k\mu} \right) \leq C_2(k)$$

Conclusion:

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} P_{P_n} \left(\boxed{\begin{array}{c} \text{red curve} \\ \text{blue curve} \end{array}}_{L_n} \right) = c(\epsilon) \text{ exists.}$$

Actually, more is conjectured to be true $\rightarrow$ conformal invariance

History:- Computed in physics literature in 1992, confirmed by univers.

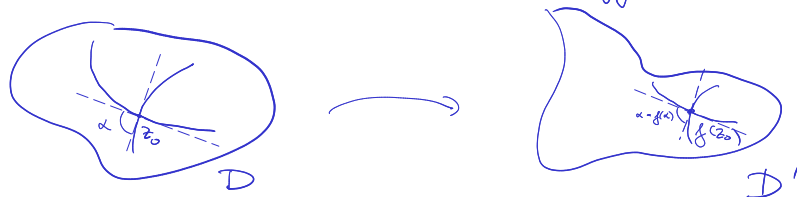
- A "formula" (see below) proposed by Cady (1992)
- Proved by Smirnov (2001) on triangular lattice

Short excursion to complex analysis

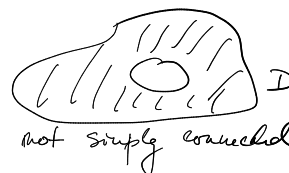
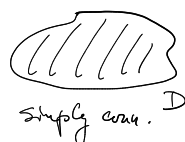
- Domain = non-empty connected open subset of $\mathbb{C}$
- For D, D' domains, conformal map from D to $D' =$
 $=$ bijection $f: D \rightarrow D'$, analytic on D , $\forall z \in D \quad f'(z) \neq 0$.
 (consequence: the inversion $f^{-1}: D' \rightarrow D$ is analytic on D')

Recn: f is analytic $\rightarrow \forall z_0 \in D$ $f(z) = f(z_0) + \underbrace{f'(z_0)}_{\substack{\text{translation} \\ \text{rotation + scaling}}} (z - z_0) + \dots$

$\rightarrow f$ preserves angles $\rightarrow$ terminology "conformal"



- D domain is Simply Connected if D and $\mathbb{C} \setminus D$ are connected
 $\iff D$ "has no holes"



(9.1) Theorem: (Riemann mapping theorem)

Let $D \neq \mathbb{C}$ be a simply connected domain, $z \in D$. Then there is a unique conformal map $f: D \rightarrow \mathbb{D} = \{z: |z| \leq 1\}$ (disk) so that $f(z) = 0$, $f'(z) > 0$ (that is $f'(z) \in \mathbb{R}_+$)

(We do not prove this theorem)

Consequences: • there are as many conformal maps $f: D \rightarrow \mathbb{D}$

- $\forall D, D' \neq \mathbb{C}$ simply connected there are infinitely many conformal maps $f: D \rightarrow D'$.

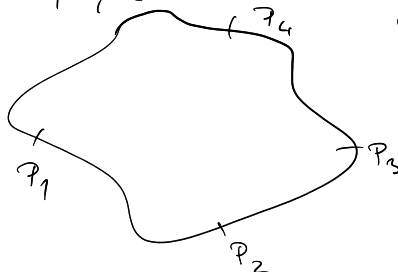
- D domain: ∂D - boundary of D ; $\bar{D}$ - closure of $D = D \cup \partial D$
- D is a Jordan domain if ∂D is a Jordan curve
 $= \partial D = \gamma(S^1)$ where $S^1 = \mathbb{R}/\mathbb{Z}$ unit circle
 γ : continuous injection.



D Jordan $\Rightarrow D$ simply connected, $D \neq \mathbb{C}$

(9.2) Theorem (Carathéodory) D, D' Jordan domains, $f: D \rightarrow D'$ conformal.
 f can be uniquely extended to a cont. bijection of $\bar{D}$ and $\bar{D}'$.

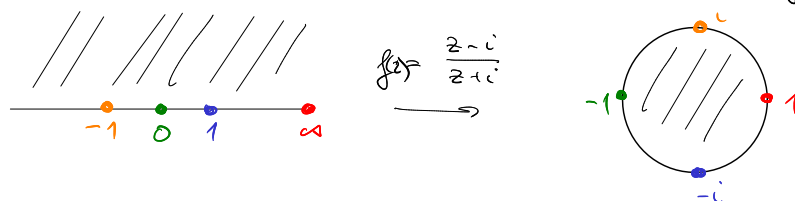
- k -marked domain $(D; p_1, \dots, p_k) =$ Jordan domain D with k points $p_1, \dots, p_k$ on its boundary, ordered anti-clockwise



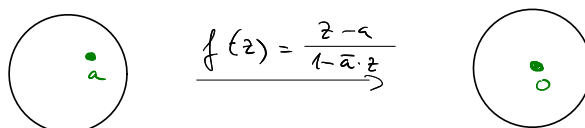
- 4-marked domain.

(9.3) Theorem: If (D, P_1, P_2, P_3) , (D', P'_1, P'_2, P'_3) are 3-marked domains then there is a unique conformal map $f: D \rightarrow D'$ such that its extension satisfies $P'_i = f(P_i)$, $i=1,2,3$.

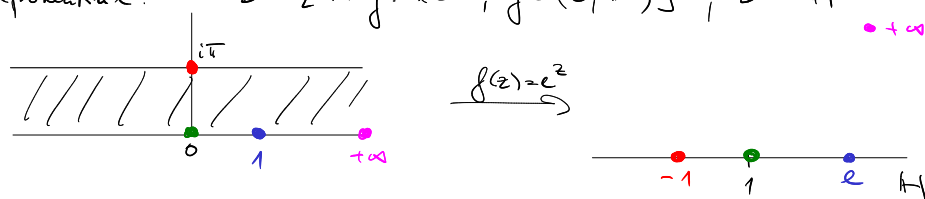
Examples: • $D = H = \{z: \text{Im}(z) > 0\}$, $D' = \mathbb{D}$ (Caley transform)



• Möbius automorphism $D = D' = \mathbb{D}$



• Exponential: $D = \{x+iy: x \in \mathbb{R}, y \in (0, \pi)\}$, $D' = H$



Conformal invariance conjecture:

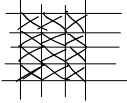
← topological rectangle

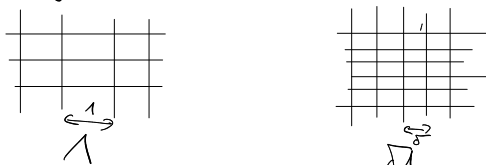
• $D_4 = (D, P_1, P_2, P_3, P_4)$, $D'_4 = (D', P'_1, P'_2, P'_3, P'_4)$ are conformally equivalent if there is conformal map $f: D \rightarrow D'$ s.t. $P'_i = f(P_i)$ $\forall i=1, \dots, 4$.
(f is either unique, or it does not exist by (9.3))

• $A_i :=$ arc of ∂D joining P_i with P_{i+1} ($P_5 = P_0$)

3 Subcritical phase

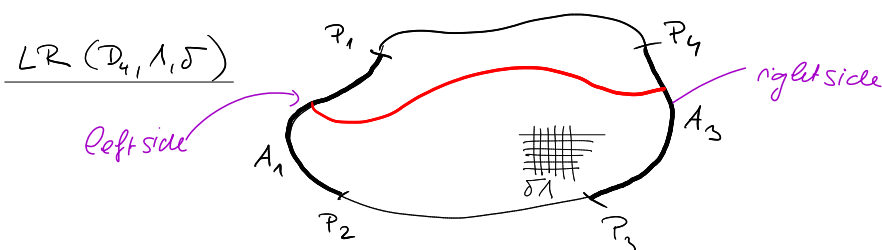
9/4

Λ - any lattice (square, triangular, hexagonal, , ...)
 $\delta\Lambda$ - scaling of Λ by factor δ



• $P_{p, \Lambda}^{\text{site/bond}}$ - site/bond Percolation on Λ with parameter $p \in [0, 1]$

• $p_c^{\text{bond/site}}(\Lambda) = \inf \{ p : P_{p, \Lambda}^{\text{site/bond}}(0 \longleftrightarrow \infty) > 0 \}$.



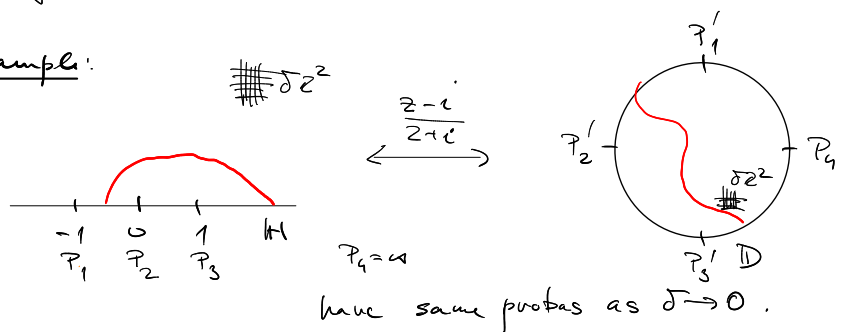
(9.4) Conjecture: The limit

$$\lim_{\delta \downarrow 0} P_{p_c(\Lambda)}(LR(D_4, 1, \delta)) = p(D_4) \in (0, 1)$$

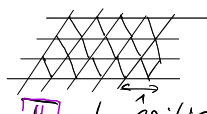
for every Jordan D . If D_4, D_4' are conf. equivalent, then $p(D_4) = p(D_4')$.

Rem: • If $p > p_c$ (or $p < p_c$) then the limit is 1 (resp. 0)
 • By RSW, if the limit exists, it must be in $(0, 1)$.

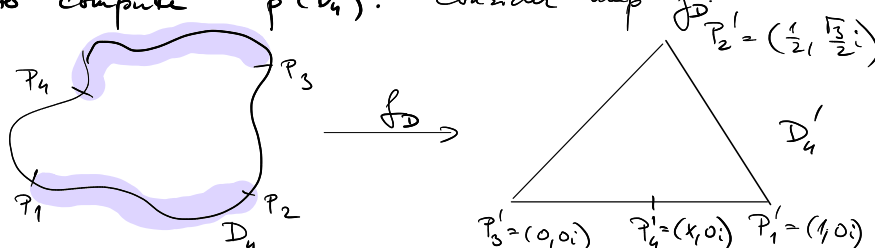
Example:



Smirnov's theorem:

Let $\mathbb{T}$ be the triangular lattice 
 $P = P_{p_c}^{\text{site}}(\mathbb{T})$ — site per. on $\mathbb{T}$ at criticality.

(9.5) Theorem (Smirnov 2001) For every 4-sided domain D_4
 $\lim_{\delta \rightarrow 0} P(\mathcal{LR}(D_4, \mathbb{T}, \delta)) = p(D_4)$
exists and is conformally invariant.

How to "compute" $p(D_4)$: Consider map f_D 

s.t. f_D maps D to equilateral triangle, fixes

$$f_D(p_1) = 1, f_D(p_2) = \frac{1}{2} + \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}i, f_D(p_3) = 0.$$

these two domains are conformally equivalent. (since we choose p_4 accordingly)

(9.6) Theorem: (Cardy's formula in Carleson formulation)

(i) On marked triangle D'_4

$$p(D'_4) = x$$

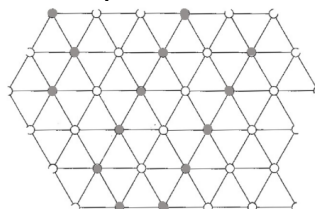
(ii) D_4 arbitrary, then $p_4(D_4) = f_D(p_4)$.

We now discuss the ingredients of the proofs of (9.5), (9.6).

Representation by hexagonal tilings:

here:

$$p = \frac{1}{2}$$

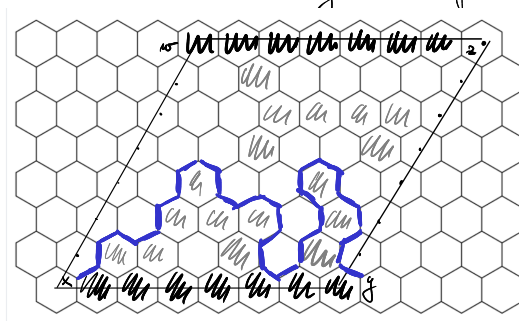


T (triangular)



H (hexagonal)

- Site percolation on T is better drawn as tilings of hexagons.
- There is even better duality than for $\mathbb{Z}^2$.



- there is either LR open crossing or TB closed crossing of any "rectangle." (consider the exploration as on the figure)
- in the rectangle on the figure $P_{\frac{1}{2}}(LR) = \frac{1}{2}$, for symmetry reasons.

- As in Kesten's theorem one can show that.

(9.7) Proposition:

$$\phi_c^{\text{site}}(T) = \frac{1}{2}$$

RSW theorem can be proved as well.

(9.8) Proposition: $\forall k \geq 1, m \in \mathbb{N} \quad \exists 0 < c_1(k) < c_2(k) < 1$ s.t.

$$c_1(k) \leq P_{\frac{1}{2}, T}^{\text{site}} \left(\left| \begin{array}{c} \text{rectangle of size } km \times km \\ \text{with a red path from left to right} \end{array} \right| \right) \leq c_2(k)$$

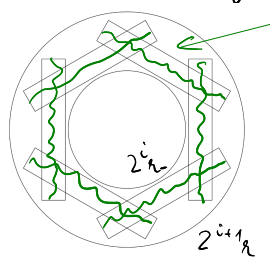
This can be used to show:

(9.9) Lemma: Let A be the annulus in $\mathbb{C}$, $A = \{z \in \mathbb{C} : r_- < |z| < r_+\}$.
There is $\alpha > 0$ s.t. for any $\delta < r_-/1000$ (say).

$$\mathbb{P}_{\frac{1}{2}} \left(\text{Diagram of annulus with a red path and a shaded region} \right) \leq \left(\frac{r_-}{r_+} \right)^\alpha$$

Proof sketch: • Let $(A_i)_{i=0}^{k-1}$ be a sequence of concentric annuli.
 A_i has inner radius $2^i r_-$, outer radius $2^{i+1} r_-$.
 $k = \lfloor \log_2 \frac{r_+}{r_-} \rfloor$. ($\Rightarrow A_i \subset A \ \forall i=0, \dots, k-1$)

• In every A_i , consider 6 rectangles as on the figure



closed crossings.

event E_i

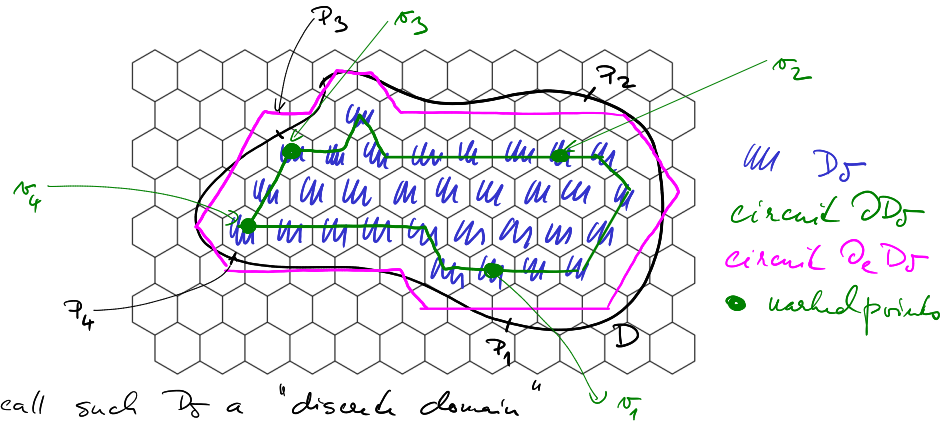
$$\bullet \mathbb{P}(E_i) \stackrel{\text{FKG}}{\geq} \mathbb{P}(\text{Diagram of rectangle with a green path})^c \geq c^6$$

$$\bullet \mathbb{P}\left(\text{Diagram of annulus A with a red path}\right) \leq \mathbb{P}_\Phi \left(\bigcap_{i=0}^{k-1} E_i^c \right) \leq (1 - c^6)^k \leq \left(\frac{r_-}{r_+} \right)^\alpha. \quad \square$$

Color switching lemma:

For domain D_4 we consider its discrete approximation D_5 in H (or Π) s.t.

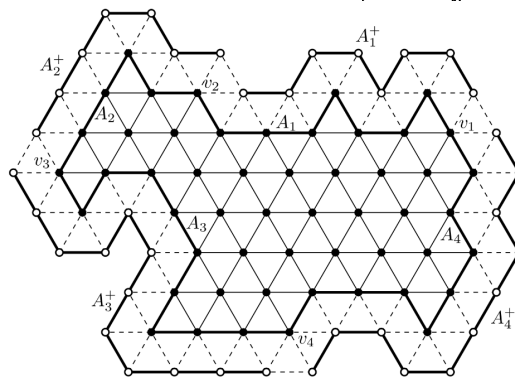
- union of the "hexagons in D_5 " is simply connected in $\mathbb{C}$
- ∂D_5 and $\partial_e D_5$ (inner and exterior boundary of D_5 in D_5) correspond to circuits in Π

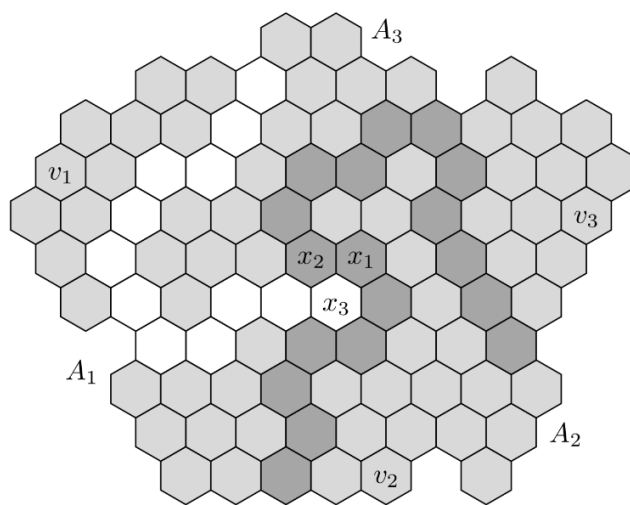


we call such D_5 a "discrete domain"

- v_i - points in ∂D_5 corresponding to P_i
Assume that every v_i has two neighbours in $\partial_e D_5$

- A_i - path of ∂D_5 between v_i, v_{i+1} - both included
- We partition $\partial_e D_5$ into sets A_i^+ s.t.
 A_i^+ is a path in $\partial_e D_5$ starting next to v_i
ending next to v_{i+1} ,





This lecture will provide a very high level proof of Smirnov's theorem.

10/1

Smirnov's theorem:

We study site percolation on $\delta\mathbb{T}$ ($= \delta \times$ triangular lattice)

D - Jordan domain in $\mathbb{C}$

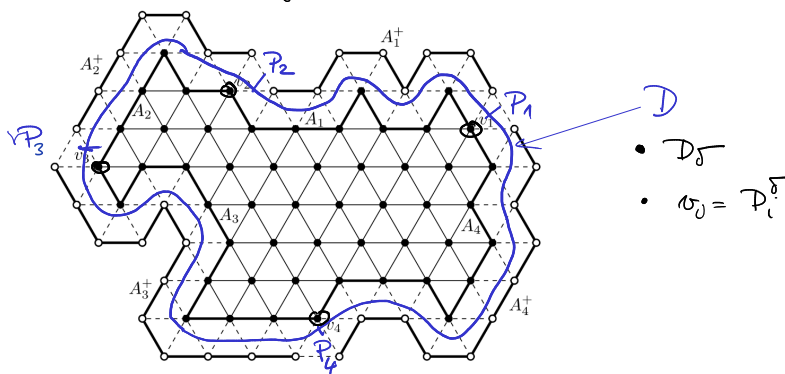
$D_4 = (D, p_1, \dots, p_4)$ - D marked with 4 points

Theorem: For every D_4

- $\lim_{\delta \downarrow 0} P_{\frac{1}{2}} \left(\text{loop } \gamma \text{ around } D_4 \right) = p(D_4)$
- $D_4 \mapsto p(D_4)$ is conformally invariant.

Color switching:

We approximate D_4 by a "discrete" domain.

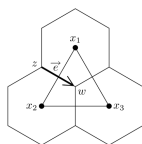


A_i - arc in ∂D_δ between $p_i^\delta, p_{i+1}^\delta$
 A_i^+ - arc in $\partial_e D_\delta$ (are disjoint)

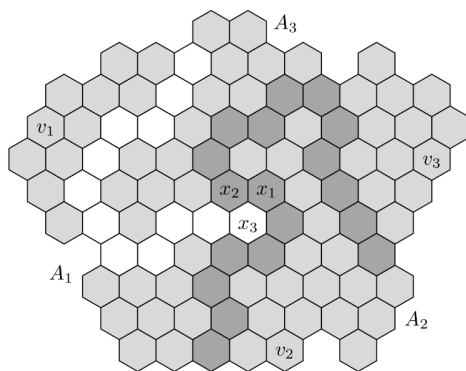
Ditto for 3-marked domain: have only $A_1, \dots, A_3, \dots$

Def: D_3 - 3-vertex domain

x_1, x_2, x_3 - 3 points in D_3
in an anticlockwise triangle



$B_1 B_2 W_3 = \begin{cases} \text{there are vertex disjoint paths } \gamma_1, \gamma_2, \gamma_3. \\ \gamma_i \text{ links } x_i \text{ with } A_i \\ \gamma_1, \gamma_2 \text{ are black, } \gamma_3 \text{ is white.} \end{cases}$
This is one event



Event $B_1 B_2 W_3$
(gray hexagons are irrelevant)

Analogously, $B_1 W_2 B_3, W_1 W_2 B_3, \dots$

Rem: Since $p = \frac{1}{2}$, $P(W_1 W_2 B_3) = P(B_1 B_2 W_3)$.

(10.1) Lemma: (colour switching)

$P(B_1 B_2 W_3) = P(B_1 W_2 B_3) = P(W_1 B_2 B_3)$
 $(= P(W_1 W_2 B_3) = P(W_1 B_2 W_3) = P(B_1 W_2 W_3))$
Vertical inequalities are trivial because we're working with $p = \frac{1}{2}$ so swapping colours does not affect probability.

Rem: In general $P(W_1 W_2 W_3) \neq P(W_1 W_2 B_3)$.

Proof: We show $P(B_1 W_2 B_3) = P(B_1 W_2 W_3)$

the other guys follow analogously.
(this is sufficient)

For this it suffices

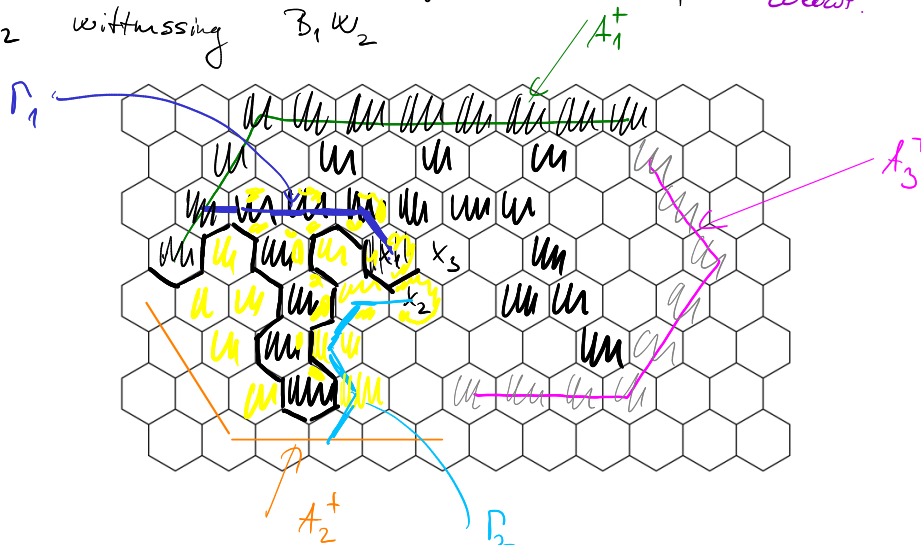
(*)

$$P(B_1 W_2 B_3 | B_1 W_2) = P(B_1 W_2 W_3 | B_1 W_2)$$

first two do not change!

it is also important
that the event
we're conditioning
on has two
different colours.

If $B_1 W_2$ occurs one can find "innocent" paths Γ_1, Γ_2 witnessing $B_1 W_2$



- For f_1, f_2 deterministic:

The event $\{\Gamma_1 = f_1, \Gamma_2 = f_2\}$ depend only on hexagons on and inbetween of f_1, f_2 - yellow hexagons

- the black/white connection of x_3 A_3 cannot cross Γ_1, Γ_2
 $\Rightarrow$ it depends on non-yellow hexagons

$\Rightarrow \forall f_1, f_2$:

$$P(x_3 \xrightarrow{\text{white}} A_3 \mid \Gamma_1 = f_1, \Gamma_2 = f_2)$$

$$= P(x_3 \xrightarrow{\text{black}} A_3 \mid \Gamma_1 = f_1, \Gamma_2 = f_2)$$

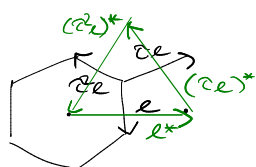
- Sum over all f_1, f_2 to show (*).

□

Framework of the proof

Notation:

•



$$\zeta = e^{\frac{2\pi i}{3}}$$

"Rotation by 120° "

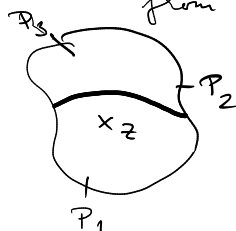
$$e^* + \zeta(ee^*)^* + \zeta^2(ee^*)^* = 0$$

($\leftarrow 1 + \zeta^2 + \zeta^4 = 0$)

• $z \in H \cap D_\delta$



$E_{1,\delta}(z) = \exists$ simple black path separating z, P_1^δ from P_2^δ, P_3^δ



$E_{2,\delta}(z), E_{3,\delta}(z)$ - analogous (by just permutating indices)

Rem: $P \left(\begin{matrix} P_4 \\ \delta_4 \\ P_1, P_2, P_3 \end{matrix} \right) = P(E_{1,\delta}(P_4^\delta))$

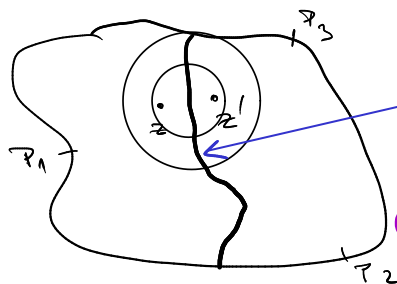
• $H_{1,\delta}(z) = P(E_{1,\delta}(z))$, extended continuously to D (by interpolation)

Claim: (Hölder continuity) $\exists k < \infty, \varepsilon > 0$

$\forall \delta < 1 \quad \forall z, z' \in D$

$$|H_{1,\delta}(z') - H_{1,\delta}(z)| \leq k |z - z'|^\varepsilon$$

Proof sketch



there is annulus crossing, proba

$$\Rightarrow \left(\frac{r_-}{r_+} \right)^\alpha \approx |z - z'|^\alpha$$

$P(\text{crossing of annulus})$

□

By Arzela-Ascoli: $\{H_{1,\delta} : \delta > 0\}$ is relatively compact

$\Rightarrow$ Every H_{1,δ_n} , $\delta_n \downarrow 0$, has a converging subsequence.

Goal: All limits of converging subsequences ~~are the same~~.
have the same limit

Let $\delta_n \downarrow 0$ be such that

$$H_{1,\delta_n} \xrightarrow{\|\cdot\|_\infty} h_i, \quad h_i: \bar{D} \rightarrow [0,1].$$

Set:

real valued functions.

$$H_{\delta_n} = H_{1,\delta_n} + \varepsilon H_{2,\delta_n} + \varepsilon^2 H_{3,\delta_n} \xrightarrow{\|\cdot\|_\infty} h = h_1 + \varepsilon h_2 + \varepsilon^2 h_3$$

$$S_{\delta_n} = H_{1,\delta_n} + H_{2,\delta_n} + H_{3,\delta_n} \rightarrow S = h_1 + h_2 + h_3.$$

Rem: h and S determine h_1, h_2, h_3 .

Discrete integration:

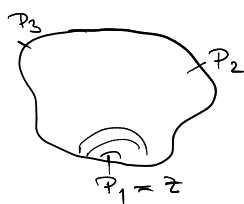
Claim: h & S are holomorphic on D

(that is $\Delta \operatorname{Re} h = \Delta \operatorname{Im} h = 0$, Cauchy-Riemann
ditto for S)

$$\begin{aligned} z = x + iy \\ \frac{\partial \operatorname{Re} h}{\partial x} &= \frac{\partial \operatorname{Im} h}{\partial y} \\ \frac{\partial \operatorname{Re} h}{\partial x} &= -\frac{\partial \operatorname{Im} h}{\partial y} \end{aligned}$$

Cor: $S \equiv 1$

Proof: S is holomorphic, real valued
 $\xRightarrow{CR}$ S is constant.



Almost obvious:

$$h_2(P_1) = 0 = h_3(P_1)$$

$$h_1(P_1) = 1$$

"
probability that P_1 and P_2 are
separated from the other points

Proof of the claim:

Theorem: (Morera) $f: D \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ is holomorphic $\iff$

$$\forall \gamma \text{ smooth loop in } D \quad \oint_{\gamma} f(z) dz = 0.$$

- Fix γ a smooth loop.
 - Discretise γ along $\delta^4 \mathbb{H} \rightarrow \gamma_\delta$
 - $N(\delta) = \# \text{ vertices of } \gamma_\delta \lesssim \delta^{-1}$, $\gamma_\delta = (x_1, \dots, x_{N(\delta)} = x_0)$
 - Discrete contour integral:
- $$I_\delta(\gamma) = \sum_{i=0}^{N(\delta)-1} \frac{1}{2} (H_\delta(x_i) + H_\delta(x_{i+1})) (x_{i+1} - x_i)$$

It holds $I_{\delta_n}(\gamma) \rightarrow \oint_\gamma h(z) dz$.
Goal: $R_{\delta_n}(\gamma) \rightarrow 0$.

Notation: We omit δ sometimes.

$$e = \{x, y\} \quad H(e) = \frac{1}{2}(H(x) + H(y))$$

$$\partial_e H = H(y) - H(x).$$

$$I(\gamma) = \sum_{e \in \gamma_\delta} H(e) e = \sum_{f \in \text{int } \gamma_\delta} \sum_{e \in \partial f} H(e) e$$

$\uparrow$
oriented edges $e = \vec{e}$
 $\nwarrow$
all hexagons inside of γ

- Easy calculation yields:

$$\sum_{e \in \partial f} H(e) e = \sum_{e = \{x, y\} \in \partial f} \partial_e H \left(\frac{x+y}{2} - c(f) \right)$$

$\nwarrow$ center of f .

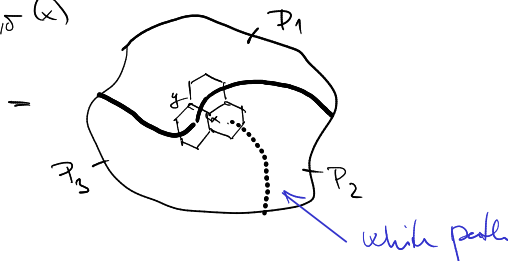
$$\Rightarrow I(\gamma) = \sum_{f \in \text{int } \gamma} \sum_{e = \{x, y\} \in \partial f} \partial_e H \left(\frac{x+y}{2} - c(f) \right)$$

$$= \sum_{f \in \text{int } \gamma} \partial_e H \cdot e^* + \text{boundary term}$$

$\nwarrow O(\delta^4 \cdot \delta^{1+\varepsilon}) \rightarrow 0$

- $\partial_e H = \partial_e H_1 + \partial_e \partial_e H_2 + \partial_e^2 \partial_e H_3$
- $\partial_e H_{1,\delta} = \partial_e P(E_{1,\delta}) = P(E_{1,\delta}(y) \setminus E_{1,\delta}(x)) - P(E_{1,\delta}(x) \setminus E_{1,\delta}(y))$ $e = (x, y)$
 $=: f_{1,\delta}(e) + f_{1,\delta}(-e)$

- $E_{1,5}(y) \setminus E_{1,5}(x)$



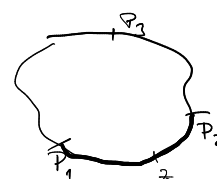
color switch

$$\rightarrow f_{1,5}(e) = f_{2,5}(\partial e) = f_{3,5}(\partial^2 e)$$

- Putting all together $\Rightarrow I_{\partial_n}(f) \rightarrow 0$ as required. $\square$.

Determining h To prove that the limit h is unique we need to find boundary conditions for h .

- If z is on $P_1 P_2$, then
 - $h_3 = 0$ ($h_3 = \lim P(E_{3,5}(z))$)
 - $h_1 + h_2 = 1$ (exploration started from P_3)
 - $\Rightarrow h(z) = h_1(z) + z h_2(z) + z^2 h_3(z)$
 - $\in [1, z] \leftarrow$ complex segment.



- Similarly: z on $P_2 P_3 \Rightarrow h(z) \in [z, z^2]$
 on $P_3 P_1 \Rightarrow h(z) \in [z^2, 1]$

Further complex analysis implies that

h is the conformal map from D to triangle $(1, z, z^2)$

$$s.t. \quad P_1 \xrightarrow{h} 1, P_2 \xrightarrow{h} z, P_3 \xrightarrow{h} z^2$$

$\Rightarrow h$ is unique.

...

$\square$

$$\text{Finally, } h_1(z) = \frac{2 \operatorname{Re} h + 1}{3} \quad \text{denotes } P \left(\begin{matrix} P_4 & P_3 \\ P_1 & P_2 \end{matrix} \right).$$

4 Random Walks in Random Environment

4.1 Reminders about Markov-Chains

In this section we will see several reminders on Markov-chains. We will consider Markov-chain on at most countable state spaces $(E, \mathcal{E})$, simplifying a lot of the theory.

Definition 4.1. Let $(\Omega, \mathcal{F}, (\mathcal{F}_n)_{n \in \mathbb{N}_0}, P)$ be a probability space and E an at most countable set with $\mathcal{E} := \mathcal{P}(E)$ its power set. A *Markov-Chain* in discrete time is a process $X = (X_n)_{n \in \mathbb{N}_0}$ which takes values in E such that

1. X is $\mathcal{F}_n$ adapted and
2. The Markov-property holds, that is for any $n \in \mathbb{N}_0$ and $A \subseteq E$,

$$P(X_{n+1} \in A \mid \mathcal{F}_n) = P(X_{n+1} \in A \mid \sigma(X_n)).$$

Remark. Typically $\mathcal{F}_n = \sigma(X_0, \dots, X_n)$, the natural filtration of X . The above statement is equivalent to the following statement: for any $n \in \mathbb{N}_0$ and $x_0, \dots, x_{n+1} \in E$ we have

$$P(X_{n+1} = x_{n+1} \mid X_0 = x_0, \dots, X_n = x_n) = P(X_{n+1} = x_{n+1} \mid X_n = x_n).$$

Definition 4.2. A Markov chain X is time homogenous if

$$P(X_{n+1} = y \mid X_n = x) =: p_{x,y}$$

does not depend on n .

Remark. The map p from above can be identified with a kernel from E to E by

$$p(x, A) = \sum_{y \in A} P(x, y).$$

Definition 4.3. A Markov-Chain X is *time-homogenous* if there is $p : E^2 \rightarrow [0, 1]$ such that for any $n \in \mathbb{N}_0$

$$P(X_{n+1} = y \mid X_n = x) = p(x, y) \stackrel{\text{Notation}}{=} p_{x,y}.$$

Remark. Note that p can be identified with a kernel from E to E by

$$p(x, A) = \sum_{y \in A} P(x, y).$$

Example 4.4. Let ξ_i be i.i.d. uniformly distributed on $[0, 1]$. Let $f : E \times [0, 1] \rightarrow E$ be a measurable function and X_0 be a given random variable. The process defined by $X_{n+1} = f(X_n, \xi_n)$ is a Markov-chain.

We introduce the following notation: Given $x \in E$ and $p : E \times E \rightarrow [0, 1]$ we write P_x for the law of X given X_0 , that is $P_x(\cdot) = P(\cdot \mid X_0 = x)$.

In the following we list some elementary facts about Markov chains, whose proof we leave as an exercise to the reader. Let X be a time homogenous Markov-chain. Then:

- For any $x, y \in E$ and $m, n \in \mathbb{N}_0$ we have that the *Chapman–Kolmogorov equation* holds:

$$p_{x,y}^{m+n} = \sum_z p_{x,z}^n p_{z,y}^m,$$

where $p_{x,y}^n = P_x(X_n = y)$.

- We have the *(weak) Markov-property*: For any $f : E^{\mathbb{N}} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ bounded and measurable and $n \in \mathbb{N}_0$ we have that

$$\begin{aligned} E[f(X_n, X_{n+1}, \dots) \mid \mathcal{F}_n] &= E[f(X_n, X_{n+1}, \dots) \mid \sigma(X_n)] \\ &= E_{X_n}[f(X_0, X_1, \dots)] \end{aligned}$$

- We have the *strong Markov-property*: For any stopping time $T : \Omega \rightarrow \mathbb{N}_0 \cup \{+\infty\}$ we have

$$\begin{aligned} E[f(X_T, X_{T+1}, \dots) \mid \mathcal{F}_T] &= E[f(X_T, X_{T+1}, \dots) \mid \sigma(X_T)] \\ &= E_{X_T}[f(X_0, X_1, \dots)] \end{aligned}$$

Definition 4.5. A Markov chain is *irreducible* if for any $x, y \in E$ there exists $n = n(x, y)$ such that $P_x(X_n = y) > 0$.

With Markov-chains one is often interested if the chain returns to a point and how often. To this end, we define the *hitting time* of X as

$$H_x = \inf\{n \geq 0 \mid X_n = x\}$$

and the *entrance time* of x as

$$\tilde{H}_x := \inf\{n \geq 1 \mid X_n = x\}.$$

The number of visits in x is denoted by N_x and given by

$$N_x = \sum_{n \geq 0} \mathbf{1}_{X_n = x}.$$

Definition 4.6. Let $x \in E$. The point x is *recurrent* if

$$P_x(\tilde{H}_x < +\infty) = 1 \iff N_x \stackrel{\text{a.s.}}{=} +\infty$$

If x is not recurrent we call x *transient*.

The following proposition is sometimes useful. Its proof can be found in the lecture notes for the course **Probability Theory**.

Proposition 4.7. (a) X is transient iff $N_x \sim \text{Geom}(P_x(\tilde{H}_x = +\infty))$ iff

$$\sum_{n \geq 0} p^n(x, x) < +\infty.$$

(b) If X is irreducible and there exists a $x \in E$ that is recurrent/transient then all $y \in E$ are recurrent/transient.

As we saw, the standard random walk on $\mathbb{Z}^d$ is recurrent if $d = 1, 2$ and transient if $d \geq 3$.

Generators and harmonic functions. We introduce the operator $L : B(E) \rightarrow B(E)$ ¹, $L = \text{Id} - p$, mapping bounded functions on E to bounded functions on E that is,

$$(Lf)(x) = f(x) - \sum_{y \in E} p(x, y)f(y)$$

and call L *Generator* of X .

Definition 4.8. Let $f : E \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$. We call f *harmonic* on $A \subseteq E$ if for any $x \in A$ we have $(Lf)(x) = 0$. This is equivalent to saying for any $x \in A$ we have $E_x[f(X_1)] = f(x)$.

If f is harmonic on A , then $M_n = f(X_{n \wedge H_{A^c}})$ is a discrete-time martingale, where H_{A^c} denotes the hitting time of the complement of A .

¹With $B(E)$ we denote the set of all measurable and bounded functions $f : E \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$. Since our σ -algebra is $\mathcal{E} = \mathcal{P}(E)$, every function $E \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ is measurable.

Definition 4.9. The Markov-chain X is *reversible* if there exists $\pi : E \rightarrow \mathbb{R}_{\geq 0}$ such that

$$\pi(x)p(x, y) = \pi(y)p(y, x). \quad (4.1)$$

Example 4.10. • The standard random walk on $\mathbb{Z}^d$ reversible (take e.g., $\pi \equiv 1$).

- If π satisfies (4.1), then it is "invariant" that is

$$\pi(x) = \sum_{y \in E} p(y, x)\pi(y).$$

(Exercise: Show this).

4.2 Introduction to Random Walks in Random Environment

The practical goal of this section is to understand stochastic processes on $E = \mathbb{Z}^d$ that are not "spatially homogenous" as standard random walk i.e., the rule how X moves may depend on the position $x \in \mathbb{Z}^d$.

Environment. Let ω denote the collection of those rules:

- In full generality, $\omega = (\omega_x)_{x \in \mathbb{Z}^d}$ where for every x , ω_x is a probability measure on $\mathbb{Z}^d$, $\omega_x(y) = P_x(X_1 = x + y)$.
- In the following we will first consider the *nearest neighbour case*: ω_x is a probability measure on neighbours of $x \in \mathbb{Z}^d$; or better: $\omega(x)$ is a measure on $\{\pm e_i\}_{i=1}^d := \mathcal{E}_d$, where e_i denotes the i -th standard basis vector. Then

$$\omega_x \in S_{2d-1} = \left\{ (p_e)_{e \in \mathcal{E}_d} \in [0, 1]^{\mathcal{E}_d} \mid \sum_{e \in \mathcal{E}_d} p_e = 1 \right\}.$$

so $\omega \in \Omega := S_{2d-1}^{\mathbb{Z}^d}$.

A *random walk in environment* ω is a $\mathbb{Z}^d$ valued Markov-chain such that

$$P(X_{n+1} = x + e \mid X_n = x) = \omega_x(e), \quad x \in \mathbb{Z}^d, e \in \mathcal{E}_d.$$

We will introduce the following notation: Let P_x^ω denote the distribution of the above random walk started at x in ω . If $x = 0$ we denote $P_0^\omega = P^\omega$.

In general selecting "interesting" non-constant environments is hard, so we will consider a *random environment*. To this end, let $\mathcal{A}$ denote the cylinder σ -algebra on Ω (where Ω is given by the above) and let $\mathbb{P}$ be a probability measure on $(\Omega, \mathcal{A})$.

There are many possible choices for such $\mathbb{P}$, however a quite standard requirement is that $\mathbb{P}$ is *stationary*, that is

$$\text{for any } x \in \mathbb{Z}^d, \quad (\omega_{y+x} : y \in \mathbb{Z}^d) \stackrel{\text{law}}{=} (\omega_y : y \in \mathbb{Z}^d).$$

Example 4.11. (a) *Product measure:* Fix μ a probability measure on S_{2d-1} and take $\mathbb{P} = \mu^{\otimes \mathbb{Z}^d}$, or equivalently, $(\omega_x : x \in \mathbb{Z}^d)$ is an i.i.d. sequence with $\omega_x \sim \mu$ for all x . If we take $d = 1$, then $\omega(x) = (\omega(x-e), \omega(x+e))$ and taking e.g.,

$$\mu = p\delta_{(\frac{1}{4}, \frac{3}{4})} + (1-p)\delta_{(\frac{2}{3}, \frac{1}{3})}$$

we have the following picture [todo: Bild]

(b) *Random connectedness:* Let E_d denote the set of edges of $\mathbb{Z}^d$. To each edge we associate a number c_e which we call the *conductance of the edge* e . [todo: Finish this example see comment for link to page]

(c) *Random walk on the percolation cluster (the ant in a labyrinth):* Pick

$$e_x = \begin{cases} 0 & \text{with probability } (1-p) \\ 1 & \text{with probability } p \end{cases}$$

[todo: finish example]

We now consider a random walk X in a random environment $\omega \in \Omega$.

Definition 4.12. • For a fixed realisation ω of the random environment, the law $\mathbb{P}^\omega$ of X is called *quenched law*.

- Taking ω randomly with distribution $\mathbb{P}$ we define the *averaged/annealed* law of X by the "semidirect product" $\mathbb{P}$, that is for any $A \in \mathcal{A}$, $B \in \mathcal{F} = \sigma(X_0, X_1, \dots)$ and $x \in \mathbb{Z}^d$ we define

$$\mathbb{P}_x(A \times B) = \int_A \mathbb{P}_x^\omega(B) \mathbb{P}(d\omega),$$

again with the convention that $\mathbb{P} := \mathbb{P}_0$.

Note that this above procedure corresponds to defining the process in two steps:

- (1) pick ω randomly according to $\mathbb{P}$ and
- (2) then run X in the environment ω according to $\mathbb{P}_x^\omega$.

Remark. • Under the quenched law, X is a Markov-chain (quite a simple process) but its transition rules are x dependent, making it complicated.

- Under the averaged measure, X is *not* a Markov-chain but its transition rules are stationary.

Example 4.13. [todo: Example in Lecture 11 Page 6]

Definition 4.14. The random environment is called *elliptic* resp. satisfies the *ellipticity assumption*, if

$$\text{for all } x \in \mathbb{Z}^d \text{ and } e \in \mathcal{E}_d, \quad \mathbb{P}(\omega_x(e) > 0) = 1. \quad (\mathbf{E})$$

We say that it is *uniformly elliptic* if

$$\text{there exists } \varepsilon_0 > 0 \text{ s.t. for all } x \in \mathbb{Z}^d \text{ and } e \in \mathcal{E}_d, \quad \mathbb{P}(\omega_x(e) \geq \varepsilon_0) = 1. \quad (\mathbf{UE})$$

In the following we always assume:

Assumption 1. Considering a nearest neighbour walk on $\mathbb{Z}$ ($d = 1$) we will assume that

- $(\omega_x : x \in \mathbb{Z})$ are i.i.d. under $\mathbb{P}$ and
- the environment $\omega \in \Omega$ is uniformly elliptic (satisfies $(\mathbf{UE})$).

Exercise 4.15. Show that $(\mathbf{UE})$ implies that X is irreducible under $\mathbb{P}^\omega$ for $\mathbb{P}$ -a.e. $\omega \in \Omega$.

Since $\omega_x(-e) = 1 - \omega_x(e)$ we can abuse notation and define $\omega_x := \omega_x(e)$ the probability of going to the right and view it as an element of $[0, 1]^\mathbb{Z}$ (or $[\varepsilon, 1 - \varepsilon]^\mathbb{Z}$, using $(\mathbf{UE})$).

Harmonic functions. It is useful to know harmonic functions for X (under $\mathbb{P}^\omega$). Here, f is harmonic iff

$$\text{for all } x \in \mathbb{Z}, \quad f(x) = \omega_x f(x+1) + (1 - \omega_x) f(x-1) = \mathbb{E}_x^\omega[f(X_1)]. \quad (4.2)$$

Introducing

$$\rho_x = \frac{1 - \omega_x}{\omega_x} \quad \text{and} \quad \Delta f(x) = f(x) - f(x-1),$$

(4.2) is equivalent to

$$\Delta f(x+1) = \rho_x \Delta f(x). \quad (4.3)$$

Note that so far we have worked with $\omega \in \Omega$ fixed. If a deterministic function is harmonic might change if we vary ω . Equation (4.3) determines harmonic function up to two constants as proved in the next lemma:

Lemma 4.16. A function $f : \mathbb{Z} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ is harmonic under $\mathbb{P}_y^\omega$ if and only if for some

$A, B \in \mathbb{R}$ we have

$$f(x) = A + \begin{cases} B \sum_{i=1}^x \prod_{j=1}^{i-1} \rho_j, & x > 0 \\ (-B) \sum_{i=x+1}^0 \prod_{j=i+1}^0 \rho_j^{-1}, & x \leq 0; \end{cases} \quad (4.4)$$

that is, the space of all harmonic function is isomorphic to $\mathbb{R}^2$.

Proof. It is an easy exercise to check that if f is given by (4.4) is harmonic. Suppose now that f is a harmonic function. Then by using a telescoping sum and (4.3) inductively we get

$$\begin{aligned} f(x) - f(0) &= \sum_{i=1}^x \Delta f(i) = \sum_{i=1}^x \Delta f(1) \prod_{j=1}^{i-1} \rho_j & \text{for } x \geq 1 \text{ and} \\ f(0) - f(x) &= \sum_{i=x+1}^0 \Delta f(i) = \sum_{i=x+1}^0 \Delta f(1) \prod_{j=i+1}^0 \rho_j^{-1} & \text{for } x \leq 0. \end{aligned}$$

Set $A = f(0)$ and $B = \Delta f(1)$ and (4.4) follows by the above calculation. To write the products, we used that (UE) implies that $\rho_x, \rho_x^{-1} \neq 0$ for all $x \in \mathbb{Z}$, $\mathbb{P}$ -a.s.. This concludes the proof. $\square$

Remark. Consider the previously constructed RWRE X on $\mathbb{Z}$ and suppose that $f : \mathbb{Z} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ is harmonic. Then, under $\mathbb{P}_x^\omega$ one has, using the Markov-property at the first equality and the fact that f is harmonic at the second one,

$$\mathbb{E}_x^\omega [f(X_{n+1}) \mid \sigma(X_0, \dots, X_n)] = \mathbb{E}_{X_n}^\omega [f(X_1)] \stackrel{(4.2)}{=} f(X_n).$$

That is, $M_n = f(X_n)$ is a discrete-time martingale under $\mathbb{P}_x^\omega$.

Recurrence/Transience. Consider the mean drift of the RWRE X at 0, given by

$$d := \mathbb{E}[\omega_0 \cdot 1 + (1 - \omega_0) \cdot (-1)] = 2\mathbb{E}[\omega_0] - 1.$$

Intuitively, one could believe that X is recurrent under $\mathbb{P}^\omega$ for $\mathbb{P}$ -a.e. $\omega \in \Omega$ iff $d = 0$. However, this guess is *false* as the next theorem shows.

Theorem 4.17 (Solomon, 1975). Under the assumption 1 we have the following:

(a) If $\mathbb{E}[\log \rho_0] = 0$ then

$$\limsup_{n \rightarrow +\infty} X_n = -\liminf_{n \rightarrow -\infty} X_n = +\infty,$$

that is, X is $\mathbb{P}$ -a.s. recurrent.

(b) If $\mathbb{E}[\log \rho_0] < 0$ then $\lim X_n = +\infty$ and if $\mathbb{E}[\log \rho_0] > 0$ we have $\lim X_n = -\infty$. In both cases X is $\mathbb{P}$ -a.s. transient.

Remark. • The assumption (UE) is in fact not necessary. One only needs that $\mathbb{E}[\log \rho_0] \in [-\infty, \infty]$ is well-defined.

• The assumption of $(\omega_x)_{x \in \mathbb{Z}}$ being i.i.d. can be weakened to $(\omega_x)_{x \in \mathbb{Z}}$ being *ergodic*.

Proof. Consider f as in (4.4) with $A = 0$, $B = 1$. Then define $V(x)$ by

$$V_x = \log(\Delta f(x)) = \begin{cases} \sum_{i=0}^{x-1} \log \rho_i, & \text{if } x \geq 0, \\ -\sum_{i=x}^{-1} \log \rho_i, & \text{if } x < 0, \end{cases}$$

(careful, V_x depends on ω and is thus a random function!) which leads to

$$f(x) = \begin{cases} 0, & x = 0; \\ \sum_{i=1}^x e^{V_i}, & x > 0; \\ -\sum_{i=x+1}^0 e^{-V_i}, & x < 0. \end{cases} \quad (4.5)$$

Then note that f is increasing and for any $x \in \mathbb{Z}$, $\Delta f(x) > 0$. Since f is harmonic for P^ω , $M(n) = f(X_n)$ is a non-negative martingale (in discrete time) under P^ω (see the remark above the theorem).

(b): $\mathbb{E}[\log \rho_i] > 0$. By the strong law of large numbers, $\mathbb{P}$ -a.s.,

$$V_x = x(\mathbb{E}[\log \rho_i] + o(1)), \quad \text{as } x \rightarrow \pm\infty,$$

hence

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow +\infty} f(x) = +\infty, \quad \text{and} \quad \lim_{x \rightarrow -\infty} f(x) = c(\omega) > -\infty, \quad \mathbb{P}\text{-a.s.}$$

By monotone convergence the limit $\lim_{n \rightarrow +\infty} M(n)$ exists P^ω -a.s. and is finite. That is only possible if $\lim_{n \rightarrow +\infty} M(n) = -c(\omega)$, that is $\lim_{n \rightarrow +\infty} X_n = -\infty$.

(b): $\mathbb{E}[\log \rho_i] < 0$. This case follows by the previous one by reversing left and right.

(a): $\mathbb{E}[\log \rho_i] = 0$. In this case we have $\lim_{x \rightarrow +\infty} f(x) = +\infty$ and $\lim_{x \rightarrow -\infty} f(x)$ so $M(n)$ does not necessarily converge. We thus fix $A \in \mathbb{N}$ and consider

$$M^+(n) := M(n \wedge H_A), \quad \text{and} \quad M^-(n) = M(n \wedge H_{-A}).$$

Then M^+ (resp. M^-) is a martingale bounded from above (resp. from below). Hence $M^\pm$ converge as $n \rightarrow +\infty$, P^ω -a.s. The only possible value for the limit is A (resp. $-A$), so

$$P^\omega [H_A < +\infty, H_{-A} < +\infty] = 1$$

implying the claim. $\square$

Law of large numbers. We now wish to establish a law of large numbers, that is to understand

$$v = \lim_{n \rightarrow +\infty} \frac{X_n}{n},$$

the "asymptotic speed of X ".

The questions are:

- Does this limit exist?
- In which sense, under which measure ($\mathbb{P}$, $\mathbb{P}^\omega$) does it exist (a.s.)?
- Does it (and if yes, how) depend on the environment ω ?

Theorem 4.18 (Solomon, 1975). Under Assumption 1 the limit $v = \lim_{n \rightarrow +\infty} \frac{X_n}{n}$ exists $\mathbb{P}$ -a.s. with

$$v = \begin{cases} \frac{1-\mathbb{E}(\rho_0)}{1+\mathbb{E}(\rho_0)} > 0 & \text{if } \mathbb{E}(\rho_0) < 1; \\ 0 & \text{if } \frac{1}{\mathbb{E}(1/\rho_0)} \leq 1 \leq \mathbb{E}(\rho_0) \\ \frac{\mathbb{E}(1/\rho_0)-1}{1+\mathbb{E}(1/\rho_0)} < 0 & \text{if } 1 < \frac{1}{\mathbb{E}(1/\rho_0)} \end{cases}$$

Remark. (1) This above law of large number uses the averaged measure $\mathbb{P}$. However, as v is $\mathbb{P}$ -a.s. constant, it also implies

$$\text{for } \mathbb{P}\text{-a.s. } \omega, \quad \lim_{n \rightarrow +\infty} \frac{X_n}{n} = v \quad \mathbb{P}^\omega\text{-a.s..}$$

(2) By Jensen's inequality,

$$\frac{1}{\mathbb{E}[1/\rho_0]} \leq \mathbb{E}[\rho_0],$$

so the above cases cover all the possibilities.

(3) Jensen's inequality also implies

$$\mathbb{E}[\log \rho_0] \leq \log \mathbb{E}[\rho_0]$$

with a strict inequality whenever $\mathbb{P}$ is non-degenerate. Hence there are examples when

$$\mathbb{E}[\log \rho_0] < 0 \text{ that is } \lim_{n \rightarrow +\infty} X_n = +\infty,$$

$$\mathbb{E}[\rho_0] \geq 1 \text{ that is } \lim_{n \rightarrow +\infty} \frac{X_n}{n} = 0.$$

(4) Another application of Jensen's inequality implies that

$$\mathbb{E}[\rho_0] = \mathbb{E} \left[\frac{1}{\omega_0} - 1 \right] = \mathbb{E}[\omega_0^{-1}] - 1 \geq \frac{1}{\mathbb{E}[\omega_0]} - 1.$$

Since $0 < u \mapsto \frac{1-u}{1+u}$ is decreasing, in the first case,

$$0 < v = \frac{1 - \mathbb{E}[\rho_0]}{1 + \mathbb{E}[\rho_0]} \leq \frac{2 - \frac{1}{\mathbb{E}[\rho_0]}}{\frac{1}{\mathbb{E}[\rho_0]}} = 2\mathbb{E}[\rho_0] - 1 = d$$

with inequality being strict if $\mathbb{P}$ is non-degenerate.

We now start to prepare for the proof of Theorem 4.18. We concentrate on the first two cases, the third follows by left-right flip.

Lemma 4.19. Suppose that $\limsup_{n \rightarrow +\infty} X_n = +\infty$ (that is $\mathbb{E}[\rho_0] \leq 0$). Then

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow +\infty} \frac{H_n}{n} = c \in [1, +\infty] \implies \lim_{n \rightarrow +\infty} \frac{X_n}{n} = \frac{1}{c} \in [0, 1].$$

Proof. Set $X_n^* = \max_{k=0, \dots, n} X_k$. Suppose that $c < +\infty$ (the other case is left as an exercise to the reader). By definition $H_{X_n^*} \leq n \leq H_{X_n^*+1}$ so

$$c \xleftarrow{n \rightarrow +\infty} \frac{H_{X_n^*}}{X_n^*} \leq \frac{n}{X_n^*} \leq \frac{H_{X_n^*+1}}{X_n^*+1} \cdot \frac{X_n^*+1}{X_n^*} \xrightarrow{n \rightarrow +\infty} c \cdot 1$$

as $X_n^* \rightarrow +\infty$ by assumption. Since we consider the nearest neighbour random walk,

$$X_n^* - X_n \leq n - H_{X_n^*},$$

thus,

$$0 \leq \limsup_{n \rightarrow +\infty} \frac{X_n^* - X_n}{n} \leq 1 - \liminf_{n \rightarrow +\infty} \frac{H_{X_n^*}}{X_n^*} \cdot \frac{X_n^*}{n} = 0. \quad \square$$

We now set

$$\tau_k = H_k - H_{k-1}, \quad \text{for } k \geq 1 \quad (4.6)$$

and write $H_n = \sum_{k=1}^n \tau_k$. We would like to use some sort of law of large numbers but the τ_k 's are

- identically distributed but not independent under $\mathbb{P}$ and
- independent but not identically distributed under $\mathbb{P}^\omega$.

So what to do?

4.3 More Ergodic Theory

Definition 4.20. A sequence of random variables $(X_n)_{n \in \mathbb{N}}$ of S -valued random variables,

where S is some arbitrary state space is called *stationary* if for all $k \in \mathbb{N}$,

$$(X_{k+n})_{n \in \mathbb{N}_0} \stackrel{(d)}{=} (X_n)_{n \in \mathbb{N}_0}$$

The goal is to show that for $f : S \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ such that $E|f(X_0)| < +\infty$ the value

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow +\infty} \frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=0}^{n-1} f(X_i) \quad \text{exists a.s.}$$

Example 4.21. The following sequences are stationary:

- (a) $(X_n)_{n \geq 0}$ is an i.i.d. sequence.
- (b) $X = (X_n)_{n \in \mathbb{N}_0}$ a Markov chain with transition probability $p(x, A)$ and stationary distribution π , that is

$$P(X_{n+1} \in A \mid X_n = x) = p(x, A), \quad \int p(x, A) \pi(dx) = \pi(A)$$

and X_0 is π -distributed (one can show that $X_i \sim \pi$ for all $i \in \mathbb{N}$, using Markov-property).

- (c) *Rotations of circle:* Take $\Omega = [0, 1)$ equipped with the Borel σ -algebra and P the Lebesgue measure. Fix $\theta \in S$ and $X_0(\omega) = \omega \sim P$ and

$$X_{n+1}(\omega) = X_n(\omega) + \theta \pmod{1}$$

This is a Markov chain. It should be intuitively clear why this is stationary.

- (d) $\mathbf{1}_{\{k \cdot e_1 \text{ is a trifurcation}\}}$.
- (e) The random variables τ_i given by (4.6) form a stationary sequence.

All the above instances are described by the following: Take $(\Omega, \mathcal{A}, P)$ a probability space and $\varphi : \Omega \rightarrow \Omega$ measurable and measure preserving, that is $P(\varphi^{-1}A) = P(A)$ for all $A \in \mathcal{A}$. Let $\varphi^n = \varphi \circ \varphi^{n-1}$ with $\varphi^0 = \text{Id}$. Let X be a random variable. Set

$$X_n(\omega) = X(\varphi^n(\omega)). \tag{4.7}$$

Exercise 4.22. Show that X_n defined by (4.7) is stationary.

This encompasses all examples from Example 4.21 by taking $\Omega = S^{\mathbb{N}_0}$, $\mathcal{A} = \mathcal{S}^{\otimes \mathbb{N}_0}$, P the law of $(X_0, X_1, \dots)$ where $X_i(\omega) = \omega_i$ and let φ the shift to the left, that is

$$\varphi(\omega_0, \omega_1, \dots) = (\omega_1, \omega_2, \dots)$$

Definition 4.23. A set $A \in \mathcal{A}$ is invariant if $P(A \Delta \varphi^{-1}(A)) = 0$ or in slightly sloppy notation: $\varphi^{-1}(A) \stackrel{\text{a.s.}}{=} A$. Define

$$\mathcal{I} := \{A \in \mathcal{A} \mid A \text{ is invariant}\},$$

which is a σ -algebra. A function $f : \Omega \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ is invariant if $f \circ \varphi = f$ ($\Leftrightarrow f$ is $\mathcal{I}$ measurable). The system $(\Omega, \mathcal{A}, P, \varphi)$ is called *ergodic* if $\mathcal{I}$ is P -trivial in the sense that $P(A) \in \{0, 1\}$ for all $A \in \mathcal{I}$.

Exercise 4.24. On a probability space $(\Omega, \mathcal{A}, P)$ we define the following relation: For two sets $A, B \in \mathcal{A}$ we write

$$A \approx B \quad \text{if} \quad P(A \Delta B) = 0.$$

Show that $\approx$ is an equivalence relation on $\mathcal{A}$.

Hint: Show and use the equality $A \Delta C = (A \Delta B) \Delta (B \Delta C)$.

The concepts of ergodicity and irreducibility are related in the sense that if φ is not ergodic there exists A such that $P(A) \in (0, 1)$ such that $\varphi(A) \subseteq A$ and $\varphi(A^c) \subseteq A^c$.

Example 4.25. • Let X be an i.i.d. sequence, where $\Omega = S^{\mathbb{N}_0}$ and φ is the shift map. If A is an invariant set, then $A \in \bigcap_{n \geq 0} \sigma(X_n, X_{n+1}, \dots)$ - the tail σ -algebra so $(\Omega, \mathcal{A}, P, \varphi)$ is ergodic by Kolmogorov's 0-1 law.

- Consider Example 4.21 (3). If $\theta = \frac{p}{q} \in \mathbb{Q}$, then φ is not ergodic because any set $\bigcup_{i=0}^{q-1} \varphi^i A$ is invariant. If θ is irrational, then φ is ergodic.

Exercise 4.26. Prove that the Markov-chain from Example 4.21 is ergodic if and only if its irreducible.

Theorem 4.27 (Birkhoff's pointwise Ergodic Theorem, 1931). If $(\Omega, \mathcal{A}, P, \varphi)$ is a measure preserving system (that is, φ is measure preserving) and $X : \Omega \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ is in $L^1(P)$. Then

$$\frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=0}^{n-1} f((X \circ \varphi^i)(\omega)) \xrightarrow[n \rightarrow +\infty]{\text{a.s., } L^1} E[X \mid \mathcal{I}](\omega).$$

Remark. • Note that if the system $(\Omega, \mathcal{A}, P, \varphi)$ is ergodic, then $E[X \mid \mathcal{I}] = E[X]$ a.s.. This means that this result implies the strong law of large numbers.

- If $(X_n)_{n \in \mathbb{N}_0}$ is an irreducible Markov-chain started from π and $f \in L^1(\pi)$, then this

theorem implies that

$$\frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^n f(X_i) \xrightarrow{n \rightarrow +\infty} \int_S f(x) d\pi(x).$$

- If θ is irrational and $f = \mathbf{1}_A$ then

$$\frac{1}{n} \sum_{k=1}^n \mathbf{1}_A((\omega + k\theta) \bmod 1) \xrightarrow[n \rightarrow +\infty]{a.s., L^1} P(A)$$

this is similar to Weyl's equidistribution theorem.

Proof (Not done in the lecture!) see Peterson 2000 (very simple proof of ergodic theorem, see Adam [todo:]) $\square$

Definition 4.28. The measure preserving map $\varphi : \Omega \rightarrow \Omega$ is *strongly mixing* if for any $A, B \in \mathcal{A}$

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow +\infty} P(A \cap \varphi^{-n}B) = P(A)P(B),$$

where $\varphi^{-n}B$ denotes the preimage of B under the n -fold composition of φ .

Analogous to the proof of Theorem 1.30 we get the following:

Theorem 4.29. If $\varphi : \Omega \rightarrow \Omega$ is strongly mixing, then $(\Omega, \mathcal{A}, P, \varphi)$ is ergodic.

Proof. Suppose that φ is strongly mixing and let $A \in \mathcal{I}$. Then by inductively using Exercise 4.24 and the fact that φ is measure-preserving we obtain

$$P(A \Delta \varphi^{-k}A) = 0, \quad \text{for any } k \in \mathbb{N}_0.$$

Then, since φ is strongly mixing,

$$P(A) = \lim_{k \rightarrow +\infty} \left(P(A \cap \varphi^{-k}A) + \underbrace{P(A \Delta \varphi^{-k}A)}_{=0} \right) = P(A)^2,$$

which implies that $\mathcal{I}$ is trivial, that is, $(\Omega, \mathcal{A}, P, \varphi)$ is ergodic. $\square$

Lemma 4.30. If $\limsup_{n \rightarrow +\infty} X_n = +\infty$ P-a.s., that is if $\mathbb{E}[\log \rho_0] \leq 0$ then $(\tau_i)_{i \geq 1}$ is a stationary strong mixing (and thus ergodic system) under $P = P_0$ (the anihilated measure).

Proof. The *stationarity* follows directly from the stationarity of the random environment (ω is i.i.d.) and the Markov-property under P^ω .

We now show *strong mixing*: To this end, we start with “cylinder events”,

$$A = \bigcap_{i=1}^k \{\tau_i \in A_i\}, \quad B = \bigcap_{i=1}^\ell \{\tau_i \in B_i\}, \quad A_i, B_i \subseteq \mathbb{N}.$$

We know that $\limsup X_n = +\infty$ so $P(\tau_i > M) \searrow 0$ as $M \nearrow +\infty$. So for given $\varepsilon > 0$ we can fix $M = M(\varepsilon)$ such that

$$B^{m,M} = \bigcap_{i=1}^\ell \{\tau_{i+m} \in B_i^M\}, \quad \text{where } B_i^M := B_i \cap [0, M]$$

satisfies $P(B^n \setminus B^{m,M}) \leq \varepsilon$. One has that $B^{m,M}$ depends on $\omega_{m-M}, \dots, \omega_{m+\ell-1}$ whereas A depends only on $\omega_{k-1}, \omega_{k-2}, \dots$ i.e., for $m \geq M + k$ the events $B^{m,M}$ and A depend on different ω_i 's. Since we choose ω_i to be i.i.d. we have that $B^{m,M}$ and A are then independent i.e.,

$$P(A \cap B^{m,M}) = P(A)P(B^{m,M}) = P(A)P(B^{0,M})$$

this implies the lemma for cylindrical events. By Lemma 1.29 any event can be approximated by cylinders which implies the strong mixing. $\square$

Lemma 4.31. If $\mathbb{E}[\log \rho_0] \leq 0$, then

$$\mathbb{E}^\omega(\tau_1) = \frac{1}{\omega_0} + \sum_{k=1}^{+\infty} \frac{1}{\omega_{-k}} \rho_{-k+1} \dots \rho_0 = 1 + 2 \sum_{k=0}^{+\infty} \rho_{-k} \rho_{-k+1} \dots \rho_0. \quad (4.8)$$

Proof. Under the assumption that the following manipulations are ok, that is, the following expectations are finite, we have

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbb{E}_0^\omega(\tau_1) &= \mathbb{E}_0^\omega(H_1) = \omega_0 \cdot 1 + (1 - \omega_0)(1 + \mathbb{E}_{-1}^\omega(H_1)) \\ &= 1 + (1 - \omega_0)(\mathbb{E}_{-1}^\omega(H_0) + \mathbb{E}_0^\omega(H_1)), \end{aligned}$$

so

$$\mathbb{E}_0^\omega[\tau_1] = \frac{1}{\omega_0} + \rho_0 \mathbb{E}_{-1}^\omega[\tau_0].$$

Thus iterating the above procedure one obtains that

$$\mathbb{E}_0^\omega[\tau_1] = \frac{1}{\omega_0} + \sum_{k=1}^n \frac{1}{\omega_{-k}} \rho_{-k+1} \dots \rho_0 + \rho_{-n} \dots \rho_0 \mathbb{E}_{-n-1}^\omega[\tau_{-n}]. \quad (4.9)$$

For both we truncate. Fix $M < +\infty$. Then,

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbb{E}_0^\omega[\tau_1 \wedge M] &= 1 + (1 - \omega_0) \mathbb{E}_{-1}^\omega[(1 + H_1) \wedge M] \\ &\leq 1 + (1 - \omega_0)(\mathbb{E}_{-1}^\omega[\tau_0 \wedge M] + \mathbb{E}_0^\omega(\tau_1 \wedge M)) \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} & \vdots \\ & \leq \frac{1}{\omega_0} + \sum_{k=1}^n \frac{1}{\omega_{-k}} \rho_{-k+1} \cdots \rho_0 + \rho_{-n} \cdots \rho_0 \underbrace{\mathbb{E}_{-n-1}^\omega[\tau_{-n} \wedge M]}_{\leq M}. \end{aligned}$$

Case 1: $\lim_{n \rightarrow +\infty} \rho_{-n} \cdots \rho_0 = 0$ $\mathbb{P}$ -a.s. This case is equivalent to saying that $\mathbb{E}[\log \rho_0] < 0$. In this case there is nothing more to do; we can just send $n \rightarrow +\infty$ and then $M \rightarrow +\infty$, using monotone convergence. For a lower bound we can just forget the last term $\rho_{-n} \cdots \rho_0 \mathbb{E}_{-n-1}^\omega[\tau_{-n} \wedge M]$ in (4.9).

Case 2: *The RHS of (4.8) is infinite.* If the RHS of (4.8) is infinite, one can easily show that $\mathbb{E}_0^\omega(\tau_1) = +\infty$ by contradiction, using the above. This concludes the proof. $\square$

Remark. • For the proof of Theorem 4.18 we only consider the case $\limsup_{n \rightarrow +\infty} X_n = +\infty \iff \mathbb{E}[\log \rho_0] \leq 0$.

- By Lemma 4.19, $\frac{X_n}{n} \rightarrow v \in [0, 1]$ is equivalent to $\frac{H_n}{n} \rightarrow \frac{1}{v} \in [1, +\infty]$, where

$$H_n = \inf \{k \geq 0 \mid H_k = n\}.$$

- We wrote

$$H_n = \sum_{i=1}^n \tau_i, \quad \text{where } \tau_i = H_i - H_{i-1}, \quad H_0 \equiv 0.$$

The random variables τ_i are stationary and ergodic under $\mathbb{P}$ by Lemma 4.30. By Birkhoff's ergodic theorem 4.27,

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow +\infty} \frac{1}{n} H_n = \lim_{n \rightarrow +\infty} \frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^n \tau_i = \mathbb{E}(\tau_1) \in [1, +\infty].$$

Proof of Theorem 4.18. We only consider the case $\limsup_{n \rightarrow +\infty} X_n = +\infty$ which is equivalent to $\mathbb{E}[\log \rho_0] \leq 0$ and we only need to check the formula for v . By Jensen we have

$$\log \mathbb{E} \left[\frac{1}{\rho_0} \right] \geq \mathbb{E} \left[\log \frac{1}{\rho_0} \right] = -\mathbb{E}[\log \rho_0] \geq 0$$

which implies that $\mathbb{E} \left[\frac{1}{\rho_0} \right] \geq 1$, so we only need to verify the first two lines in Theorem (4.18). By Assumption 1 and previous remarks

$$\begin{aligned} v &= \frac{1}{\mathbb{E}_0(\tau_1)} = \frac{1}{\mathbb{E}[\mathbb{E}_0^\omega(\tau_1)]} \\ &= \left(1 + \mathbb{E} \left[2 \sum_{k \geq 0} \rho_{-k} \cdots \rho_0 \right] \right)^{-1} \\ &= \left(1 + \sum_{k \geq 0} 2 \mathbb{E}[\rho_0]^{k+1} \right)^{-1} \end{aligned}$$

$$= \begin{cases} 0, & \text{if } \mathbb{E}[\rho_0] \geq 1 \text{ and} \\ \left(1 + 2 \cdot \frac{\mathbb{E}[\rho_0]}{1 - \mathbb{E}[\rho_0]}\right)^{-1} = \frac{1 - \mathbb{E}[\rho_0]}{1 + \mathbb{E}[\rho_0]}, & \text{if } \mathbb{E}[\rho_0] < 1, \end{cases}$$

where we used Lemma 4.31 and the fact that ρ_i 's are i.i.d. $\square$

Remark. • This law of large numbers also holds without the i.i.d. assumption on the environment. Ergodicity is sufficient but the formula for v is less explicit.

• One can prove more results:

- averaged CLT: If $\mathbb{E}[\rho_0^2] < 1$, then $\frac{X_n - vn}{\sigma \sqrt{n}} \xrightarrow{P} \mathcal{N}(0, 1)$, where σ depends on $\mathbb{P}$.
- quenched CLT: If $\mathbb{E}[\rho_0^2] < 1$, then $\frac{X_n - vn + Z_n(\omega)}{n \sqrt{n}} \xrightarrow{P^\omega} \mathcal{N}(0, 1)$.

4.4 Sinai's model: non standard limit laws

We now want to understand the situation when X is recurrent. Note that this section is about very advanced maths thus it will be higher level than usual in this lecture.

Assumption 2. We assume that $\mathbb{E}[\log \rho_0] = 0$, (UE), i.e., $\log \rho_0$ is bounded and that $(\omega_x)_{x \in \mathbb{Z}}$ is an i.i.d. sequence of random variables.

Recall that the harmonic function f given by (4.5). Here $V(x)$ is a sum of centered i.i.d. random variable, so one can use Donsker's theorem to understand its behaviour.

Claim 4.32. Let

$$W^n(t) = \frac{1}{\log n} V(\lfloor t \log^2 n \rfloor), \quad t \in \mathbb{R}. \quad (4.10)$$

Then

$$(W^n(t))_{t \in \mathbb{R}} \xrightarrow{d} (\sigma B_t)_{t \in \mathbb{R}}$$

where $\sigma^2 = \mathbb{E}[\log(\rho_0)^2]$ and $(B_t)_{t \in \mathbb{R}}$ is a two sided Brownian motion, that is $(B_t)_{t \geq 0}$ and $(B_{-t})_{t \geq 0}$ are two independent Brownian motion.

Proof. Use Donsker's theorem. $\square$

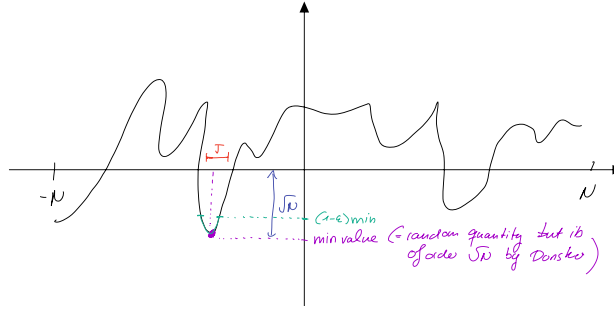
Remark. The role of the potential V is more visible when one studies the invariant measures of X under P^ω .

From the exercises we know that if the measure is invariant, then X is reversible. That is, there exists some function $\pi : \mathbb{Z} \rightarrow [0, +\infty)$ such that $\pi(x)\omega_x = \pi(x+1)(1 - \omega_{x+1})$. Setting $\pi(0) = 1$ (note here, that we are not looking for an invariant probability measure

but for an invariant measure) we get by iterating

$$\begin{aligned} \pi(x) &= \begin{cases} \prod_{i=0}^{x-1} \frac{\omega_i}{1-\omega_{i+1}}, & x > 0 \\ 1, & x = 0 \\ \prod_{i=x}^{-1} \frac{1-\omega_{i+1}}{\omega_i}, & x < 0 \end{cases} \\ &= \begin{cases} \frac{1-\omega_0}{1-\omega_x} \cdot \prod_{i=0}^{x-1} \frac{1}{\rho_i} = \frac{1-\omega_0}{1-\omega_x} e^{-V(x)}, & x > 0 \\ 1, & x = 0 \\ \frac{1-\omega_0}{1-\omega_x} \prod_{i=x}^{-1} \rho_i = \frac{1-\omega_0}{1-\omega_x} e^{-V(x)}, & x < 0 \end{cases}. \end{aligned}$$

Note that the random variable $\frac{1-\omega_0}{1-\omega_x}$ is $\mathbb{P}$ -a.s. bounded by (UE). Imagine now that we restrict our random walk X to the interval $[-N, N]$ by setting $\omega_N = 0$, $\omega_{-N} = 1$ (reflecting boundary conditions). For any "typical realisation of $V(x)$ ", by Donsker, the minimum is of order $\sqrt{N}$. Define J be the picture below:



If $x \notin J$ then² $\frac{\pi(x)}{\pi(\min)} \cong \frac{e^{-V(x)}}{e^{-V(\min)}} \asymp e^{-\varepsilon\sqrt{N}}$, ($\cong$ means ignoring constants) thus

$$\frac{\pi(J^c)}{\pi(J)} \leq \frac{\pi(J^c)}{\pi(\min)} \leq 2Ne^{-\varepsilon\sqrt{N}} \xrightarrow{N \rightarrow +\infty} 0,$$

using that there are at most $2N + 1$ points in $[-N, N]$, our restricted domain of the random walk X . Hence π is very far from being a uniform distribution, that is X (the restricted version of it) concentrates around the minimal value, i.e., spends most of its time in J .

Now we want to look at the random walk X at fixed times and introduce the notion of *valley*.

Definition 4.33. Suppose that W^n is given by (4.10). A triple (a, b, c) with $a < b < c$ is a *valley* of W^n if $W^n(b) = \min_{a \leq t \leq c} W^n(t)$ and

$$W^n(a) = \max_{a \leq t \leq b} W^n(t) \quad \text{and} \quad W^n(c) = \max_{b \leq t \leq c} W^n(t).$$

²Here we are using that $V(x) - V(\min) \geq \varepsilon\sqrt{N}$.

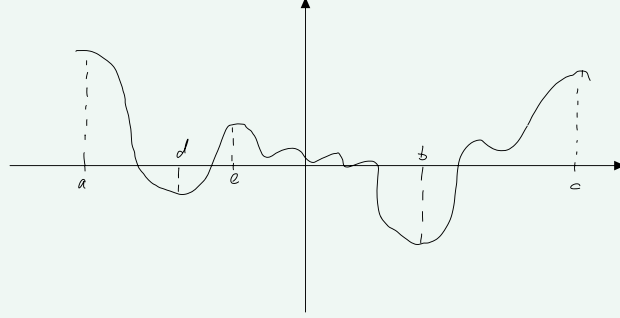
We denote the *depth* of the valley by

$$d(a, b, c) = \min\{W^n(a) - W^n(b), W^n(c) - W^n(b)\}.$$

If $a < d < e < b$ are such that

$$W^n(e) - W^n(d) = \max_{a \leq x < y \leq b} W^n(y) - W^n(x)$$

(the maximal increase), then (a, d, e) and (e, b, c) are again valleys. This procedure is called *left refinement* of (a, b, c) (left because $d, e \in (a, b)$ rather than in (b, c)).



Right refinement is defined analogously.

By left/right refinement one splits the valey in two new valleys. We now construct a very “specific” valley. Let

$$\begin{aligned} c_0^n &= \min\{t \geq 0 : W^n(t) \geq 1\} \\ a_0^n &= \max\{t < 0 : W^n(t) \geq 1\} \\ b_0^n &= \text{the position of the global minimum of } W^n \text{ in } [a_0^n, c_0^n]. \end{aligned}$$

Note that b_0^n is not well defined as there might be multiple minima. However with probability tending to 1 as $n \rightarrow +\infty$ there is only one minimum, so we will ignore this case. By refining this valley one can construct the “smallest” valley $(a_n^\delta, b_n^\delta, c_n^\delta)$ such that $d(a_n^\delta, b_n^\delta, c_n^\delta) \geq 1 + \delta$, $\delta \geq 0$ and the origin is contained in the valley. For $\delta = 0$ we just write $(a_n^\delta, b_n^\delta, c_n^\delta) = (a_n, b_n, c_n)$.

Theorem 4.34 (Sinai, 1982). It holds that

$$\frac{X_n}{\log^2 n} - b_n \xrightarrow[n \rightarrow +\infty]{P_0} 0.$$

where, as usual, P_0 denotes the annihilated measure of X started at 0.

Remark. • As b_n is of order 1, typically, this implies that $|X_n| \approx \log^2 n$. Compare it with the usual symmetric random walk with $|X_n| \approx \sqrt{n}$ (in the RWRE-case we

have a much slower growth rate).

- The theorem implies that given ω , X_n is “essentially deterministic” and located (with high probability) at $b_n \cdot \log^2 n + o(\log^2 n)$.

Proof. We will only sketch the proof as it is quite long. Let $(a_n, b_n, c_n) = (a_n^1, b_n^1, c_n^1)$ denote the smallest valley such that $d(a_n, b_n, c_n) \geq 1$ such that $a_n < 0 < c_n$.

Step 1 (a_n, b_n, c_n) is with high probability (w.h.p.) non-degenerate. We first need to define the collection of ω 's such that (a, b, c) is non-degenerate. To this end, let $A_n^{J,\delta}$ be the collection of all $\omega \in \Omega$ such that

- $b_n = b_n^\delta$
- any refinement of $(a_n^\delta, b_n^\delta, c_n^\delta)$ has depth $< 1 - \delta$.
- $|a_n^\delta| + |c_n^\delta| < J$, that is, the valley should not be too broad, and
- we have

$$\min_{t \in [a_n, c_n] \setminus [b_n - \delta, b_n + \delta]} W^n(t) - W^n(b_n) \geq \delta^3,$$

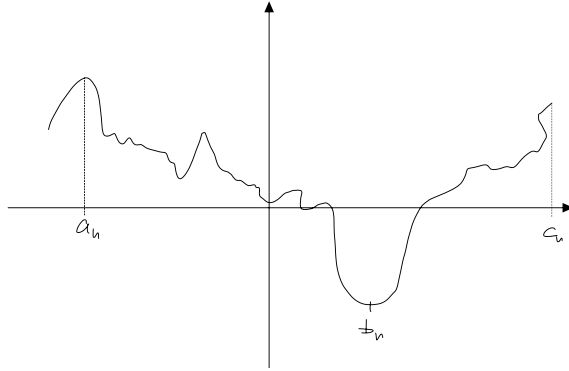
i.e., outside of a neighbourhood of the minimum, W^n is significantly greater than the minimum.

Using the properties of Brownian motion (actually one needs to work quite a bit to achieve that, using reflection principle etc.) one checks that

$$\lim_{\delta \searrow 0} \lim_{J \rightarrow +\infty} \lim_{n \rightarrow +\infty} P(A_n^{J,\delta}) = 1.$$

This shows the first step.

For simplicity from now on we assume that $A_n^{J,\delta}$ holds and $b_n \geq 0$.



We set $A_n^\delta = \lfloor (\log^2 n) a_n^\delta \rfloor$, $B_n^\delta = \lfloor (\log^2 n) b_n^\delta \rfloor$, $C_n^\delta = \lfloor (\log^2 n) c_n^\delta \rfloor$ and suppress the δ if $\delta = 0$, as above.

Step 2 $P_0^\omega[H_{B_n} \leq n] \xrightarrow{n \rightarrow +\infty} 1$. We show that, with high probability, the random walk hits the bottom before having done n steps.

Since f is harmonic, $f(X_n)$ is a martingale under P_0^ω and thus by optional stopping,

$$f(0) = E_0^\omega \left[f \left(X_{H_b}^{H_a} \right) \right] = f(a)P_0^\omega(H_a \leq H_b) + (1 - P_0^\omega(H_a \leq H_b))f(b)$$

and thus

$$P_0^\omega(H_{A_n^\delta} \leq H_{B_n}) = \frac{f(B_n) - f(0)}{f(B_n) - f(A_n^\delta)} = \frac{\sum_{x=1}^{B_n} e^{V(x)}}{\sum_{x=A+1}^{B_n} e^{V(x)}}.$$

Due to the second property of $A_n^{J,\delta}$ the sum in the denominator contains a term $e^{V(x_0)}$ such that $V(x_0) \geq \delta \log(n) + V(y)$ for all $y \in [1, B_n]$. Hence

$$P_0^\omega(H_{A_n^\delta} \leq H_{B_n}) \leq \frac{\overbrace{\sum_{y \in [1, B_n]} e^{V(y)}}^{\leq J \log^2 n}}{e^{V(x_0)}} \leq J \log^2(n) e^{-\delta \log n} \leq (J \log^2 n) n^{-\delta} \xrightarrow{n \rightarrow +\infty} 0. \quad (4.11)$$

Consider now RWRE “reflected at A_n^δ ”. Then as in Lemma 4.31,

$$E_0^\omega[\tau_1] = \frac{1}{\omega_0} + \cdots + \frac{1}{\omega_{A_n^\delta+1}} \rho_{A_n^\delta+2} \cdots \rho_0 + \rho_{A_n^\delta+1} \cdots \rho_0.$$

Since the reflection does not change the law of $H_{\{A_n^\delta, B_n\}} := \overline{H_n}$,

$$\begin{aligned} E_0^\omega[\overline{H_n}] &= \overbrace{E_0^\omega}^{\text{reflection}}[\overline{H_n}] \leq \widetilde{E}_0^\omega[H_{B_n}] = \widetilde{E}_0^\omega \left[\sum_{i=1}^{B_n} \tau_i \right] \\ &= \sum_{i=1}^{B_n} \sum_{x=A_n^\delta}^{i-1} \underbrace{\frac{1}{\omega_x}}_{\leq c} \underbrace{\rho_{x+1} \cdots \rho_{i-1}}_{e^{V(i)-V(x)}} \\ &\leq c \sum_{i=1}^{B_n} \sum_{x=A_n^\delta}^{i-1} e^{\log n \left(W^n \left(\frac{i}{\log^2 n} \right) - W^n \left(\frac{x}{\log^2 n} \right) \right)} \\ &\leq C(J \log^2 n)^2 n^{(1-\delta)} \leq n^{1-\frac{\delta}{2}}, \end{aligned}$$

where we used that $W^n \left(\frac{i}{\log^2 n} \right) - W^n \left(\frac{x}{\log^2 n} \right) \leq 1 - \delta$ due to the second property of $A_n^{J,\delta}$. By Markov inequality,

$$P(\overline{H_n} > n) \xrightarrow{n \rightarrow +\infty} 0, \quad (4.12)$$

hence combining (4.11) and (4.12) one deduces

$$P(\overline{H_n} < n, X_{H_n} = B_n) \xrightarrow{n \rightarrow +\infty} 1,$$

proving the claim.

Step 3 . Similarly to the proof of (4.11) one proves

$$P_{B_n-1}^\omega[H_{B_n} < H_{A_n^\delta}] \geq 1 - n^{-(1+\frac{\delta}{2})},$$

$$P_{B_n+1}^\omega[H_{B_n} < H_{C_n^\delta}] \geq 1 - n^{-(1+\frac{\delta}{2})},$$

that is the probability of how likely it is to reach the bottom of the valley before leaving the valley. We omit this proof here as it is quite similar to the proof of (4.11).

Step 4 Conclusion. Steps 2 and 3 imply that on $A_n^{J,\delta}$ with high probability,

- X reaches B_n before time n
- After reaching B_n , X will need at least $n^{1+\frac{\delta}{2}}$ steps to exit $[A_n^\delta, C_n^\delta]$.

So instead of looking at X we may look at its reversion that is reflected at A_n^δ and C_n^δ (i.e., $\omega_{A_n^\delta} = 1$ and $\omega_{C_n^\delta} = 0$). We use $\tilde{E}^\omega, \tilde{P}^\omega$ for this reversion. Its advantage is that it is a “finite state space” Markov chain, which is reversible. $\square$

5 Random Walks on Weighted Graphs

In the following few section we will be following the book of Barlow [todo: Literature]. This field has a lot of similarities with the analysis of parabolic PDEs. It is easier than RWRE so we will also cover $d \geq 2$. This will be the last big part of the lecture.

Example 5.1. Consider the random walk among random conductivity, that is let $G = (\mathbb{Z}^d, E_d)$ and let $\mu = (\mu_e)_{e \in E_d}$ the conductances which we assume to be independent under $\mathbb{P}$. We assume ellipticity, that is there exists some $\varepsilon > 0$ such that

$$\mathbb{P}\left(\varepsilon \leq \mu_e \leq \frac{1}{\varepsilon}\right) = 1 \quad \text{for all } e \in E_d.$$

Consider a random walk X such that, given μ ,

$$P^\mu(x, y) = \mathbb{P}^\mu(X_1 = y \mid X_0 = x) = \frac{\mu_{x,y}}{\sum_{z \sim x} \mu_{x,z}}.$$

This is always reversible.

Fact. The random walk in random environment in the recurrent situation grows really slowly,

$$\frac{X_n}{\log^2 n} \sim b_n$$

RWRC is always recurrent and

$$\frac{X_{nt}}{\sqrt{n}} \rightarrow B_t,$$

where B is a Brownian motion. Compared to RWRE where we had $\pi(x) \asymp e^{V(x)}$ and $V(x)$ is a random walk again, the invariant measure of RWRC is $\pi(x) = \mu_{x,x+1} + \mu_{x,x-1}$.

Notation 1. The notation will at some times be slightly different than in the previous lectures. Here $G = (V, E)$ will denote a graph (which will often be infinite) and we will write $x \sim y$ iff $\{x, y\} \in E$. Here we will use the word path for a finite sequence $x_0, \dots, x_n \in V$ with $x_i \sim x_{i-1}$ (note that a path does not need to be self avoiding here!). Moreover we define the degree of a vertex $v \in V$ by

$$\deg(v) := \#\{z \in V \mid z \sim v\}.$$

The ball of radius $r > 0$ with center $x \in V$ is given by

$$B_r(x) = \{y \in V \mid d(x, y) \leq r\}$$

where

$$d(x, y) = \inf \{n = \text{length}(\pi) \mid \pi = x_0, \dots, x_n \text{ is a path from } x \text{ to } y\}$$

We say that G has *bounded geometry* iff

$$\sup\{\deg(x) \mid x \in V\} < +\infty.$$

Assumption. We assume that our graph $G = (V, E)$ is *locally finite*.

Definition 5.2. A weight (conductance) is a function $\mu : V \times V \rightarrow \mathbb{R}_{\geq 0}$, $(x, y) \mapsto \mu_{x,y}$ with the following properties:

- μ is symmetric, that is $\mu_{x,y} = \mu_{y,x}$.
- If $x \neq y$, $\mu_{x,y} > 0$ if and only if $x \sim y$, that is $\{x, y\} \in E$.

Moreover we define

$$\pi(x) := \sum_{z \in V} \mu_{x,z} = \sum_{z \sim x} \mu_{x,z} + \mu_{x,x}.$$

We call the pair (G, μ) *weighted graph*.

Remark. A natural choice for a weight would be $\mu_{x,y} = \mathbf{1}_{x \sim y}$. If we do not specify a weight function we implicitly use this.

Definition 5.3. A weighted graph (G, μ) has bounded weights if there exists $C \in \mathbb{R}_{\geq 0}$ such that

$$\text{for any } e \in E, \quad \mu_e \in [C^{-1}, C].$$

We say that (G, μ) has controlled weights if there exists $C > 0$ such that

$$\text{for any } x \sim y \quad \frac{\mu_{x,y}}{\pi(x)} \geq C.$$

At last we define $P(x, y) = \frac{\mu_{x,y}}{\pi(x)}$, where $P(x, y) > 0$ implies that either $x \sim y$ or $x = y$.

Exercise 5.4. If we have controlled weights then G has bounded geometry.

Let $(X_n)_{n \in \mathbb{N}_0}$ be a random walk on (G, μ) with transition matrix P (it is only a matrix if G is finite). Moreover we denote by P_x the law of X given $X_0 = x$.

Lemma 5.5. • X is reversible and π is its reversible measure.

- For any $x_0, \dots, x_n \in V$ we have

$$\pi(x_0)P_{x_0}(X_1 = x_1, \dots, X_n = x_n) = \pi(x_n)P_{x_n}(X_1 = x_n, \dots, X_n = x_0).$$

Proof. The easy proof is left as an exercise to the reader. $\square$

Remark. Every reversible chain is RWRC.

[todo: 16.7]

We know that the Random Walk on $\mathbb{Z}^d$ is recurrent if and only if $d \leq 2$.

Question 5.6. • Is RW on a triangular/hexagonal lattice in $d = 2$ recurrent?

- Is RW on $(\mathbb{Z}^d, \mu)$ where μ are bounded weights recurrent if $d \leq 2$?
- Do the above Random Walks have a Brownian motion limit?

We will look at the so-called *heat kernel bound*:

$$p_n(x, y) \asymp \frac{c_1}{n^{d/2}} e^{-c_2 \frac{|x-y|^2}{n}}.$$

We define the *transition densities* by

$$p_n(x, y) = \frac{1}{\pi(y)} P^n(x, y) = \frac{1}{\pi(y)} P_x(X_n = y).$$

Lemma 5.7. • The Chapman Kolmogorov-equation holds:

$$p_{n+m}(x, y) = \sum_{z \in V} p_n(x, z) p_m(z, y) \pi(z) = \int_V p_n(x, z) p_m(z, y) \pi(dz).$$

- It holds that $p_n(x, y) = p_n(y, x)$ for any $n \in \mathbb{N}_0$ and $x, y \in V$.
- The p_n 's are normalized in the sense that

$$\int_V p_n(x, z) \pi(dz) = 1.$$

Definition 5.8. Denote $C(V) = \{f : V \rightarrow \mathbb{R}\}$ (C because all functions $V \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ are continuous if we equip V with the discrete topology). Denote $C_0(V)$ the set of all functions with finite support. and denote $L^p = L^p(V, \pi)$. As usual L^2 is a Hilbert space and we denote

$$\langle f, g \rangle := \langle f, g \rangle_\pi := \langle f, g \rangle_{L^2(\pi)} = \sum_{x \in V} f(x) g(x) \pi(x).$$

The transition densities can be viewed as an operator given by

$$P_n f(x) = \sum_{y \in V} P^n(x, y) f(y) = \mathbb{E}_x[f(X_n)].$$

Definition 5.9. We define the *probabilistic Laplace operator* by $\Delta = P - \text{Id}$ i.e.,

$$\begin{aligned} \Delta f(x) &= (Pf)(x) - f(x) = \mathbb{E}_x[f(X_1)] - f(x) \\ &= \sum_{y \in V} p(x, y)(f(y) - f(x))\pi(y) \\ &= \frac{1}{\pi(x)} \sum_{y \in V} \mu_{x,y}(f(x) - f(y)). \end{aligned}$$

This is the “generator” of the Markov-chain X .

We have the following elementary properties of P and Δ whose proof are left as an exercise to their reader.

Lemma 5.10. (a) The function $f \equiv 1$ is an eigenfunction of P i.e., $\Delta 1 = 0$.

(b) P and Δ are self-adjoint in $L^2(\pi)$ that is for any $f, g \in L^2$,

$$\langle f, Pg \rangle = \langle Pf, g \rangle, \quad \langle f, \Delta g \rangle = \langle \Delta f, g \rangle,$$

(c) The operator-norms of P and Δ satisfy

$$\|P\|_{L^p \rightarrow L^p} \leq 1, \quad \|\Delta\|_{L^p \rightarrow L^p} \leq 2.$$

5.1 Dirichlet (Energy)-form

Definition 5.11. Let $f, g \in C(V)$. The quadratic form

$$\mathcal{E}(f, g) = \frac{1}{2} \sum_{x, y \in V} \mu_{x,y}(f(x) - f(y))(g(x) - g(y)) \quad (5.1)$$

is defined if the above series is absolutely convergent and in this case we call $\mathcal{E}$ the *Dirichlet (Energy)-form*.

Remark. To see why it is called Dirichlet-Energy, compare it with the expression

$$\int_{\Omega} \nabla f(x) \cdot \nabla g(x) \, dx.$$

where the discrete gradients are given by $f(x) - f(x-1)$. We will see later why we named it that way. At this point in time the name is random.

Definition 5.12. We define the space

$$H^2 = H^2(G, \mu) = \{f \in C(V) \mid f \text{ is such that (5.1) converges absolutely}\}.$$

The norm on H^2 is given by

$$\|f\|_{H^2}^2 = \mathcal{E}(f, f) + f(o)^2,$$

where o is a base point of the graph (like an arbitrarily fixed origin).

Lemma 5.13. (a) If $x \sim y$ we have

$$|f(x) - f(y)| \leq \sqrt{\frac{\mathcal{E}(f, f)}{\mu_{x,y}}}.$$

(b) $\mathcal{E}(f, f) = 0$ if and only if $f \equiv \text{const.}$

(c) For $f \in L^2$ we have that $\mathcal{E}(f, f) \leq 2\|f\|_{L^2}^2$, so $L^2 \subseteq H^2$.

(d) The space H^2 is a Hilbert space with the scalar product

$$\langle f, g \rangle_{H^2} = \mathcal{E}(f, g) + f(o)g(o).$$

(e) Convergence in H^2 implies convergence pointwise convergene *everywhere*.

Proof. We have that

$$\mathcal{E}(f, f) = \frac{1}{2} \sum_{x,y} \mu_{x,y} (f(x) - f(y))^2 \leq 2 \sum_x f(x)^2 \sum_y \mu_{x,y} = 2\|f\|_{L^2}^2,$$

which shows (c). The rest of the points are left as an exercise to the reader. $\square$

Remark. Point (b) in Lemma 5.13 explains why we needed to add $f^2(o)$ in the definition of $\|\cdot\|_{H^2}^2$.

In the following we will establish an analogon of the famous Green-Gauss theorem from analysis.

Theorem 5.14 (Green, Gauss). If $f, g \in C(V)$ are such that

$$\sum_{x,y \in V} |g(x)| \cdot |f(x) - f(y)| \mu_{x,y} < +\infty, \quad (5.2)$$

then

$$\mathcal{E}(f, g) = -\langle \Delta f, g \rangle_{L^2(\pi)}.$$

Proof. Note that (5.2) ensures that all the series used in the following proof converge absolutely. Using that $\mu_{x,y} = \mu_{y,x}$

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{E}(f, g) &= \frac{1}{2} \sum_{x,y} (f(y) - f(x))g(y)\mu_{x,y} - \frac{1}{2} \sum_{x,y} (f(y) - f(x))g(x)\mu_{x,y} \\ &= \frac{1}{2} \sum_{x,y} (f(x) - f(y))g(x)\mu_{x,y} - \frac{1}{2} \sum_{x,y} (f(y) - f(x))g(x)\mu_{x,y} \\ &= - \sum_x g(x) \underbrace{\sum_y (f(y) - f(x)) \frac{\mu_{x,y}}{\pi(x)}}_{=\Delta f} \pi(x) \\ &= - \langle g, \Delta f \rangle_\pi. \end{aligned}$$

□

Proposition 5.15. Suppose that $\pi(V) < +\infty$. Then the random walk X on the weighted graph (G, μ) is recurrent.

Proof. Fix $z \in G$ and define $\varphi(x) := P_x(H_z = +\infty)$. Note that φ is bounded and since $\pi(V) < +\infty$ $\varphi \in L^2 \subseteq H^2$. For $x \neq z$,

$$\varphi(x) = \sum_{y \in V} P_x(X_n = y, H_z = +\infty) = \sum_{y \in V} p(x, y)\varphi(y),$$

that is, φ is harmonic on $V \setminus \{z\}$ with $\varphi(z) = 0$. Since φ is bounded we can apply discrete Green Gauss Theorem ([todo: todo numbering]):

$$\mathcal{E}(\varphi, \varphi) = -\langle \varphi, \Delta \varphi \rangle_\pi = \underbrace{\varphi(z)}_{=0} \Delta \varphi(z) \pi(z) = 0$$

which implies by (??) that φ must be constant, i.e., $\varphi \equiv 0$.

□

Killed process. Given a graph $G = (V, E)$ with weights μ let $A \subseteq V$. We set

$$T_A = \inf\{n \in \mathbb{N}_0 \mid X_n \notin A\}$$

the exit time of A and

$$p_n^A(x, y) = \frac{1}{\pi(y)} P_x(X_n = y, T_A > n)$$

the transition density of X killed on exiting A . We define the following operators:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Id}_A f(x) &= f(x) \mathbf{1}_A(x) \\ P_n^A f(x) &= \sum_{y \in A} p_n^A(x, y) \pi(y) f(y) \stackrel{\text{if } x \in A}{=} E_x[f(X_1) \mathbf{1}_{T_A > 1}], \quad n \geq 1 \\ \Delta_A &= P^A - \text{Id}_A. \end{aligned}$$

Remark. In general P^A is a “sub-Markovian” operator, i.e., Mass can disappear for example when X hits A .

P^A has many properties similar to P .

Lemma 5.16. The following statements hold:

1. $p_n^A(x, y) = 0$ if $x \notin A$ or $y \notin A$ and $p_n^A(x, y) = p_1(y, x)$ for all $x, y \in A$.
2. We have that

$$p_{n+m}^A(x, y) = \sum_{z \in V \text{ or } z \in A} p_n^A(x, z) p_m^A(z, y) \pi(z)$$

$$p_{n+1}^A(x, y) - p_n^A(x, y) = \Delta_y p_n^A(x, y),$$

the discrete heat equation (second line).

3. $P_n^A = (P^A)^{\circ n}$ and $P_A f = \text{Id}_A P \text{Id}_A f$, $\Delta_A f = \text{Id}_A \Delta \text{Id}_A f$.

Proof. Similar to the case where $A = V$. □

Green's function. Analogous to Stochastic Analysis we define Green's function.

Definition 5.17. The function $g_A : V \times V \rightarrow \mathbb{R}_{\geq 0} \cup \{+\infty\}$ given by

$$g_A(x, y) = \sum_{n=0}^{+\infty} p_n^A(x, y)$$

is called *Green's function* or *Green's density*. As a convention: $g := g_V$.

We record some elementary properties of Green's function whose proofs are left as an exercise to the reader.

- g_A is symmetric, that is $g_A(x, y) = g_A(y, x)$ for all $x, y \in V$.
- We have

$$g_A(x, y) = \frac{1}{\pi(y)} \mathbb{E}_x \left[\sum_{n=0}^{+\infty} \mathbf{1}_{X_n=y, n < T_A} \right]$$

where the sum in the expectation is the number of visits to y before exiting A .

- If (G, μ) is recurrent, $g(x, y) = +\infty$ for all $x, y \in V$. If (G, μ) is transient, $g(x, y) < +\infty$ for all $x, y \in V$.
- If $A \neq V$, then $g_A(x, y) < +\infty$.

Next is a useful identity for g_A

Theorem 5.18. Suppose that either $A \neq V$ or X is transient, that is, $g(x, y) < +\infty$ for all $x, y \in V$. Then

1. $g_A(x, y) = P_x(H_y < T_A)g_A(y, y)$ for all $x, y \in V$ and
2. $\pi(y)g_A(y, y) = \frac{1}{P_y(T_A < \tilde{H}_y)} = \frac{1}{P_y(T_A \leq \tilde{H}_y)}$ for $y \in A$.

Proof. [todo: See notes] □

Exercise 5.19. The formulas of the above theorem are very intuitive, explain why.

Theorem 5.20. If $x, y \in A$ then

$$\Delta_y g_A(x, y) = -\frac{\delta_{x,y}}{\pi(x)},$$

where δ denotes the Kronecker-Delta and Δ_y denotes the Laplacian applied in the y -argument of the function.

Proof. Note that

$$\begin{aligned} P g_A(x, y) &= \sum_{z \in V} \overbrace{p(y, z)\pi(z)}^{P_y(X_1=z)} g_A(x, z) \\ &= \sum_{z \in V} \sum_{n \in \mathbb{N}_0} p(y, z)\pi(z)p_n^A(x, z) \\ &\stackrel{!}{=} \sum_{n \in \mathbb{N}_0} p_{n+1}^A(x, y) \\ &= g_A(x, y) - p_0^A(x, y) = g_A(x, y) - \frac{\delta_{x,y}}{\pi(y)}, \end{aligned}$$

where we used at ! that every term in the above sums is positive, that is we can use monotone convergence to swap sums and also the Chapman-Kolmogorov-equality. The claim follows by using $\Delta = P - \text{Id}$. □

Definition 5.21. Let $A \subseteq V$ and $f : \bar{A} = A \cup \partial A \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$. f is *harmonic* on A if $\Delta f(x) = 0$ for all $x \in A$. We call f *superharmonic* if $-\Delta f(x) \geq 0$ for all $x \in V$ and *subharmonic* if $-\Delta f(x) \leq 0$ for all $x \in V$.

Theorem 5.22 (Maximum principle). Let $A \subseteq V$ be connected and $h : \bar{A} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ subharmonic on A .

- (1) If there exists some $x \in A$ such that $h(x) = \max_{\bar{A}} h$ then h is constant.
- (2) If A is finite then h attains its maximum on $\bar{A}$ and the maximum is attained on the boundary ∂A .

Proof. (1): Let x be the value where the maximum is attained. Let $B = \{y \in V \mid h(y) = h(x)\}$. Then for $y \in B \cap A$ we have for all $z \sim y$ that $h(z) \leq h(y)$. Also,

$$\begin{aligned} 0 &\leq \pi(y) \Delta(y) \\ &= \sum_{z \sim y} \mu_{y,z} \underbrace{(h(z) - h(y))}_{\leq 0} \leq 0 \end{aligned}$$

that is $h(z) = h(y)$ for all $z \sim y$. This means we can repeat the above argument with all neighbouring points. Since A is connected, h must be constant on A , that is $B = A$.

(2): [todo:] □

Theorem 5.23. Assume that (G, μ) is recurrent. If f is a nonnegative function that is superharmonic on V , then f is constant.

Proof. Since f is superharmonic and nonnegative, $M_n = f(X_n)$ is a non-negative supermartingale, hence the limit

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow +\infty} f(X_n) \tag{5.3}$$

exists and is finite P_x -a.s. On the other hand X visits every point infinitely often P_x -a.s. so f must be constant (otherwise the limit (5.3) does not exist). □

Theorem 5.24 (Forster's criterion). (G, μ) is recurrent if and only if there exists some $A \subseteq V$ finite and $h : V \rightarrow [0, +\infty)$ such that h is superharmonic on $V \setminus A$ and for any $M < +\infty$ the sublevel set

$$\{x \in V \mid h(x) \leq M\}$$

is finite.

Proof. $\Leftarrow$: Suppose we have found such A and h as in the theorem. Then $M_n = h(X_{n \wedge H_A})$ is a non-negative supermartingale, hence the limit $\lim_{n \rightarrow +\infty} M_n \in [0, +\infty)$ exists P_x -a.s. for all $x \in V$. Suppose by contradiction that X is transient. Then there exists $x \in V$ such that $P_x(H_A < +\infty) < 1$. But then $P_x(\lim M_n = +\infty) > 0$ because the sublevel set of h is finite (since you hit every point a.s. finitely many times the limit has to be infinite).

$\Rightarrow$: Let $B_n = B(A, n)$ the ball of size n around A . Let

$$h_n(x) = P_x(T_{B_n} < H_A).$$

Then h is superharmonic on $V \setminus A$ and $h \equiv 1$ on $B_n^{\mathbb{G}}$ and $h_n(x) \searrow 0$ as $n \rightarrow +\infty$ by recurrence (exercise: fill in the details). Let h_{n_k} be a subsequence such that $h_{n_k}(x) \leq 2^{-k}$ for all $x \in B_k$. Let

$$h = \sum_{k \geq 0} h_{n_k}.$$

Then h is superharmonic on $V \setminus A$ and $h \geq 0$ and $h(x) < +\infty$ for all $x \in V$, $h(x) \geq M$ for all $x \in B_{n_k}^{\mathbb{G}}$, that is h has the required properties. $\square$

6 Random walks and electrical resistance

Note: This section is based on the lecture notes of Barlow; see ADAM. [todo: Bild 29]

Electrical Current. We have Ohm's law, that is there exists some $U : V \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ such that for any x, y , the resistance of $\{x, y\}$ is given by

$$U(y) - U(x) = \frac{I_{x,y}}{\mu_{x,y}}$$

(by reversing the electrical flow, replacing $I_{x,y}$ with $-I_{x,y}$ is possible, this is just a convention). We further assume Kirchhoff's law (marked with '!'),

$$\sum_{y \in V} I_{x,y} = \sum_{x \sim y} I_{x,y} \stackrel{!}{=} 0 \quad \text{for all } x \notin \{x_1, x_0\}.$$

Note that Ohm's law gives

$$0 = \sum_y I_{x,y} \stackrel{\text{Ohm}}{=} \sum_y \mu_{x,y} (U(y) - U(x)) = \pi(x) \Delta U(x),$$

i.e., U is harmonic. We want to solve the following discrete *Dirichlet problem*:

$$\begin{cases} \Delta U(x) &= 0 & \text{on } \{x_0, x_1\}^c \\ U(x_0) &= 0, \quad U(x_1) = 1 \end{cases}. \quad (6.1)$$

Lemma 6.1. If the graph G is finite, (6.1) has a unique solution given by

$$U(x) = P_x(H_{x_1} < H_{x_0}).$$

Remark. By finiteness of G one could use linear algebra to prove this. We will, however, use a different proof.

Proof. Set $\varphi(x) = P_x(H_{x_1} < H_{x_0})$. Then $\varphi(x_i) = i$ for $i = 0, 1$. Also by (??) we have that φ is harmonic on $\{x_1, x_0\}^c$. Suppose that U_1, U_2 are solutions to (6.1). Then $u = U_1 - U_2$ satisfies (6.1) with homogenous boundary conditions. Using discrete Green Gauss (Theorem 5.14, which we can use because we are on a *finite* graph) we have

$$\mathcal{E}(u, u) = - \langle u, \Delta u \rangle = \sum_{x \in V} \pi(x) u(x) \Delta u(x)$$

$$\begin{aligned}
 &= \sum_{x \in V \setminus \{x_0, x_1\}} \pi(x) u(x) \Delta u(x) + \sum_{x \in \{x_0, x_1\}} \pi(x) u(x) \Delta u(x) \\
 &= 0,
 \end{aligned}$$

which implies that u is constant. Using the initial condition $u(x_0) = 0$ we obtain $u \equiv 0$. $\square$

Remark. If (G, μ) is transient, the function

$$h^B(x) = P_x(H_B = +\infty) \not\equiv 0, \quad \text{where } B = \{x_0, x_1\}.$$

Also h^B is harmonic on B^c and $h^B(x_0) = h^B(x_1) = 0$, that is $\varphi + \lambda h^B$ solves (6.1) for all $\lambda \in \mathbb{R}$, so we cannot guarantee the uniqueness of a solution of (6.1).

Definition 6.2. Define

$$F(I, x_0) := \sum_{y \sim x_0} I_{x_0, y} = \sum_{y \in V} I_{x_0, y}$$

the *total current from x_0* . This is also the total current in the circuit. Also define the *effective resistance between x_0 and x_1* by

$$R_{\text{eff}}(x_0, x_1) = R(x_0, x_1) = \frac{U}{I} = \frac{1}{F(I, x_0)}$$

and

$$C_{\text{eff}}(x_0, x_1) = C(x_0, x_1) = \frac{1}{R_{\text{eff}}(x_0, x_1)} = F(I, x_0).$$

Exercise 6.3. • Prove that if G is finite $F(I, x_0) = -F(I, x_1)$.

- Show that $R_{\text{eff}}(x_0, x_1) = R_{\text{eff}}(x_1, x_0)$ that is resistance is independent of direction (obvious from a physical perspective).

Theorem 6.4. Suppose that G is finite. For any $x_0, x_1 \in V$, $x_1 \neq x_0$ it holds that

$$\pi(x_0) \underbrace{P_{x_0}(H_{x_1} < \tilde{H}_{x_0})}_{\text{"escape probability"}} = C_{\text{eff}}(x_0, x_1).$$

Proof. Can be checked by next calculation.

$$\begin{aligned}
 C_{\text{eff}}(x_0, x_1) &= \sum_{y \in V} I_{x_0, y} \stackrel{\text{Ohm}}{=} \sum_y \mu_{x_0, y} (U(y) - U(x_0)) \\
 &\stackrel{\text{Lemma}}{=} \pi(x_0) \sum_y \underbrace{\frac{\mu_{x_0, y}}{\pi(x_0)}}_{=P(x_0, y)} P_y(H_{x_1} < H_{x_0}) \stackrel{\text{Markov property}}{=} \pi(x_0) P_{x_0}(H_{x_1} < \tilde{H}_{x_0}). \quad \square
 \end{aligned}$$

Remark. This will be helpful because C_{eff} is monotone but it is a priori very hard to make any claims about monotonicity of the probability.

Theorem 6.5 (Commute time identity). Consider G finite and $x_0 \neq x_1$. Then the commute time (LHS) satisfies

$$E_{x_0}[H_{x_1}] + E_{x_1}[H_{x_0}] = R_{\text{eff}}(x_0, x_1)\pi(V).$$

Corollary 6.6. Under the assumptions of Theorem 6.5 the map $(x, y) \mapsto R_{\text{eff}}(x, y)$ is a metric on V , if one defines $R_{\text{eff}}(x, x) = 0$.

Proof. Clearly we have $R_{\text{eff}}(x, x) = 0$ by definition (exercise: prove that $R_{\text{eff}}(x, y) = 0$ implies $x = y$). Symmetry follows from the above exercise. Lastly, for x, y, z we have

$$\begin{aligned} E_x[H_z] &\leq E_x[H_y] + E_y[H_z] \\ E_z[H_x] &\leq E_y[H_x] + E_z[H_y]. \end{aligned}$$

Summing these two equations and using Theorem 6.5 yields

$$R_{\text{eff}}(x, z) \leq R_{\text{eff}}(x, y) + R_{\text{eff}}(y, z).$$

□

Proof of Theorem 6.5. Set $R = R_{\text{eff}}(x_0, x_1)$ and

$$\varphi_1(x) = P_x(H_{x_1} < H_{x_0}) = 1 - \varphi_0(x)$$

and $f(x) = E_x[H_{x_0}]$. Then applying Green-Gauss twice gives us $\langle \varphi_1, -\Delta f \rangle_\pi = \langle -\Delta \varphi_1, f \rangle_\pi$. Also $f(x_0) = 0$, $\Delta f(x) = -1$ for any $x \neq x_0$, φ_1 satisfies (6.1) and

$$R^{-1} = \pi(x_0)\Delta\varphi_1(x_0) = -\pi(x_1)\Delta\varphi_1(x_1).$$

Thus we have

$$\langle \varphi_1, -\Delta f \rangle_\pi = \sum_{x \neq x_0} \pi(x)\varphi_1(x) = \sum_x \pi(x)\varphi_1(x)$$

and

$$\langle -\Delta \varphi_1, f \rangle_\pi = -\Delta \varphi_1(x_1)\pi(x_1)f(x_1) = \frac{1}{R} \cdot E_{x_1}[H_0]$$

By interchanging 0 and 1 the resistance does not change and we can use the above to arrive at the conclusion (by using $\varphi_1 + \varphi_0 \equiv 1$). □

Given a set $A \subseteq V$ we can obtain a new set by collapsing A : (G', μ') is defined by

$$V' = (V \setminus A) \cup \{a\},$$

$$E' = \{\{x, y\} \in E \mid x, y \notin A\} \cup \{\{a, x\} \mid \exists y \in A : \{x, y\} \in E, x \neq a\}$$

and the weights are given by

$$\mu'_{x,y} = \begin{cases} \mu_{x,y} & x, y \in A \\ \sum_{z \in A} \mu_{z,y} & x = a, y \notin A \end{cases}.$$

Definition 6.7. • $R_{\text{eff}}(B_0, B_1) = R'_{\text{eff}}(x_0, x_1)$ is defined to be the resistance between x_0, x_1 in G' , obtained by collapsing B_0 to x_0 , B_1 to x_1 .

- If G is infinite and B_0 finite we take $A_n \nearrow V$, A_n finite and set

$$R_{\text{eff}}(B_0, +\infty) := \lim_{n \rightarrow +\infty} R_{\text{eff}}(B_0, A_n^c).$$

The limit exists because the sequence on the RHS is increasing.

Theorem 6.8. Let (G, μ) be infinite and $x_0 \in V$. Then

$$\pi(x_0)P_{x_0}(\tilde{H}_x = +\infty) = R_{\text{eff}}^{-1}(x_0, +\infty) = C(x_0, +\infty)$$

The theorem has a useful corollary:

Corollary 6.9. x_0 is recurrent (that is, X is recurrent) if and only if $C(x_0, +\infty) = 0$.

Proof of Theorem 6.8. Let $A_n = B_n(x_0)$. Collapse A_n^c to x_1 . Then

$$\pi(x_0)P_{x_0}(\tilde{H}_{x_0} = +\infty) \xleftarrow{n \rightarrow +\infty} \pi(x_0)P_{x_0}(H_{x_1} < \tilde{H}_{x_0}) = \frac{1}{R_{\text{eff}}(x_0, x_1)} \xrightarrow{n \rightarrow +\infty} \frac{1}{R(x_0, +\infty)}.$$

This proves the formula. $\square$

Exercise 6.10. Prove Corollary 6.9.

Variational methods to estimate $C(x_0, +\infty)$. Calculating the resistances on a huge graph can be quite cumbersome. [todo: Write this better] Let (G, μ) be a finite weighted graph and let $B_0, B_1 \subseteq V$ non-empty and disjoint. Define

$$\mathcal{F}(B_0, B_1) := \{f \in H^2 \mid f|_{B_i} \equiv i\}.$$

Moreover, set

$$\bar{C}_{\text{eff}}(B_0, B_1) = \min\{\mathcal{E}(f, f) : f \in \mathcal{F}(B_0, B_1)\}.$$

Theorem 6.11. Suppose G is finite and take B_0 and B_1 as above

$$\bar{C}_{\text{eff}}(B_0, B_1) = C_{\text{eff}}(B_0, B_1) \quad \left(= \frac{1}{R_{\text{eff}}(B_0, B_1)} \right)$$

Proof. Set $\varphi(x) = P_x(H_{B_1} < H_{B_0})$ and $I_{x,y} = \mu_{x,y}(\varphi(y) - \varphi(x))$. Then

$$\begin{aligned} R_{\text{eff}}(B_0, B_1) &= F(I, B_0) := \sum_{x \in B_0} \sum_{y \in V} I_{x,y} \quad (\text{justify this by collapsing}) \\ &= \sum_{x \in B_0} \sum_y \mu_{x,y}(\varphi(y) - \varphi(x)) = \sum_{x \in B_0} \pi(x) \Delta \varphi(x). \end{aligned}$$

Also, using discrete Green-Gauss (Theorem 5.14),

$$\mathcal{E}(\varphi, \varphi) = \mathcal{E}(1 - \varphi, 1 - \varphi) = \langle -\Delta \varphi, f - \varphi \rangle_\pi = \sum_{x \in B_0} \pi(x) \Delta \varphi(x),$$

where the last equality comes from the fact that φ is harmonic outside of $B_0 \cup B_1$ and $\varphi \equiv 0$ on B_1 . Hence $\mathcal{E}(\varphi, \varphi) = R_{\text{eff}}(B_0, B_1)^{-1}$. Now, if $f \in \mathcal{F}(B_0, B_1)$, Then

$$\mathcal{E}(\varphi, f - \varphi) = \langle -\Delta \varphi, \varphi - \varphi \rangle = 0,$$

again using that $\Delta \varphi \equiv 0$ outside of $B_0 \cup B_1$ and $f - \varphi \equiv 0$ on $B_0 \cup B_1$. We have thus shown that $\mathcal{E}(\varphi, \varphi) = -\mathcal{E}(\varphi, f)$ and so

$$0 \leq \mathcal{E}(f - \varphi, f - \varphi) = \mathcal{E}(f, f) - \mathcal{E}(\varphi, \varphi) \quad \text{i.e.,} \quad \mathcal{E}(f, f) \geq \mathcal{E}(\varphi, \varphi).$$

Using that $\varphi \in \mathcal{F}(B_0, B_1)$ we can take infimum over all such f and obtain the desired equality. $\square$

Note that $E = UI \stackrel{\text{Ohm}}{=} \frac{U^2}{R} = U^2 \cdot C \stackrel{\text{Ohm}}{=} I^2 R$ (from physics). This translates to

$$\mathcal{E}(f, f) = \frac{1}{2} \sum_{x,y} \underbrace{\mu_{x,y}}_C \underbrace{(f(y) - f(x))^2}_{U^2}.$$

In the following we want to minimize the energy and this intuition helps understanding things.

Definition 6.12. $J = (J_{x,y})_{x,y \in V}$ is called *flow from B_0 to B_1* if

1. $\sum_{y \in V} J_{x,y} = 0$ if $x \notin B_1 \cup B_0$
2. $J_{x,y} = -J_{y,x}$
3. $J_{x,y} = 0$ if $x \approx y$.

The *total flow out of* B_0 is given by

$$F(J, B_0) = \sum_{x \in B_0} \sum_{y \sim x} J_{x,y},$$

sometimes also called the flux of J .

Exercise 6.13. Show that if G is finite then $F(J, B_0) = -F(J, B_1)$. Show that it does not hold in general when G is infinite (then one can “move things to infinity”).

What is the difference between flow and current? [todo: Write something here]

Definition 6.14. We define

$$E(I, J) = \frac{1}{2} \sum_x \sum_{y \sim x} I_{x,y} J_{x,y} \frac{1}{\mu_{x,y}}$$

We’d like to study the problem:

$$R_{\text{eff}}(B_0, B_1) = \inf \{E(J, J) : J \text{ is flow from } B_0 \text{ to } B_1 \text{ with } F(J, B_0) = 1\}. \quad (6.2)$$

Theorem 6.15 (Thompson’s principle). If (G, μ) is finite, then $R_{\text{eff}}(B_0, B_1)$ is indeed the resistance between B_0 and B_1 .

Proof. Let G be finite and let J be as in (6.2) and $f \in \mathcal{F}(B_0, B_1)$. Then

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{1}{2} \sum_x \sum_y J_{x,y} (f(y) - f(x)) &= \frac{1}{2} \sum_{x,y} -J_{x,y} f(x) - \frac{1}{2} \sum_{x,y} J_{x,y} f(x) \\ &= - \sum_x \underbrace{f(x)}_{\in \mathcal{F}(B_0, B_1)} \sum_{y \sim x} J_{x,y} \\ &= - \sum_{x \in B_1} \underbrace{f(x)}_{\equiv 1} \sum_{y \sim x} J_{x,y} \\ &= -F(J, B_1) \stackrel{\text{Exercise}}{=} F(J, B_0) = 1. \end{aligned}$$

Hence if $\varphi(x) = P_x(H_{B_1} < H_{B_0}) = U(x)$ solves (6.1) and $I_{x,y} = \mu_{x,y}(\varphi(y) - \varphi(x))$, then

$$E(I, J) = \frac{1}{2} \sum_x \sum_y \frac{1}{\mu_{x,y}} I_{x,y} J_{x,y} = \frac{1}{2} \sum_{x,y} J_{x,y} \overbrace{(\varphi(y) - \varphi(x))}^{\in \mathcal{F}(B_0, B_1)} = 1.$$

I is not feasible for (6.2) since $F(B_0, I) = C_{\text{eff}}(B_0, B_1)$ so we set $I' = R_{\text{eff}}(B_0, B_1)I$. Then

$$E(I', J) = R(B_0, B_1) \quad \text{and thus also} \quad E(I', I') = R_{\text{eff}}(B_0, B_1),$$

hence for any J as in (6.2),

$$0 \leq E(J - I', J - I') = \dots = E(J, J) - E(I', I'),$$

proving the statement. $\square$

Example 6.16. [todo: See notes] in the picture every edge between x_0 and x_1 has resistance 1 hence $R(x_0, x_1) = 3$ and $C(x_0, x_1) = \frac{1}{3}$. On binary tree we then have resistance $\left(\frac{1}{2}\right)^{d(x_0, \cdot)}$ or something like this. [todo: make this understandable].

Corollary 6.17. Let (G, μ) be finite and B_0, B_1 as usual.

1. $\mu \mapsto C(B_0, B_1)$ is coordinate wise increasing in μ .
2. "Cutting". Deleting an edge (i.e., setting its conductance to zero) decreases the conductance.
3. "Shorting". Identifying vertices x, y (that is, formally, setting $\mu_{x,y} = +\infty$) increases the conductance.

Proof. [todo:] $\square$

Example 6.18. SRW on $\mathbb{Z}^2$ is recurrent if and only if $C_{\text{eff}}(0, +\infty) = 0$. Short $\partial\Lambda_n$ to one vertex (for all $n \in \mathbb{N}$) but then [todo: $R = \frac{1}{4}, R = \frac{1}{12}, R = \frac{1}{20}$ on $\partial\Lambda_1, \partial\Lambda_2, \partial\Lambda_3$ we obtain $R_{\text{eff}} = +\infty$ hence the conductance is 0.]

[todo: Rest of lecture 19]

6.0.1 Transience, Recurrence and rough isometries

How does the "long time behaviour" of RW relate to the "large scale geometry" of the graph? If two graphs G_i , $i = 1, 2$ are similar, do the random walks on G_1, G_2 have similar properties?

To explain what "similar" means we need the concept of rough isometries which is one of the simplest kinds of similarity. First we introduce a similar notion:

Definition 6.19. Let (G, μ) be a weighted graph. Then (G', μ') is obtained from (G, μ) by bounded perturbation of weights if $G = G'$ and there exists $C \in (0, +\infty)$ such that

$$\text{for any } x, y \in V, \quad \frac{1}{C} \mu_{x,y} \leq \mu'_{x,y} \leq C \mu_{x,y}.$$

Often we also want to modify G itself. Recall, G can be viewed as a metric space (G, d) , where G is the natural distance on G .

Definition 6.20. Let (X_1, d_1) , (X_2, d_2) be metric spaces. A map $\varphi : X_1 \rightarrow X_2$ is called *rough isometry* if there exist some $C_1, C_2 \in (0, \infty)$ such that

(a) for all $x, y \in X_1$ we have

$$\frac{1}{C_1}(d_1(x, y) - C_2) \leq d_2(\varphi(x), \varphi(y)) \leq C_1(d_1(x, y) + C_2)$$

and

(b)

$$\bigcup_{x \in X_1} B_{d_2}(\varphi(x), C_2) = X_2.$$

We say that X_1, X_2 are *roughly isometric* if such a map φ exists.

Exercise 6.21. Using the axiom of choice, show that rough isometry is an equivalence relation.

For weighted graph it is suitable to "combine" these two definitions. [todo: Continue typing this lecture]